



INTERNATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY



Olympic Studies



31st

INTERNATIONAL SEMINAR
ON OLYMPIC STUDIES FOR POSTGRADUATE STUDENTS

ANCIENT OLYMPIA



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FOREWORD

In its thirty-one years of operation, the Olympic Studies Seminar is, in the spirit of Pierre de Coubertin, an essential “Olympic factory” of Olympism and Olympic Education.

Since 1993, the Seminar has supported young scientists in Olympic Studies and they, in turn, have spread their knowledge and promoted the educational values of Olympism worldwide. To date we have trained 889 postgraduate students, many of whom are now in key positions as professors in the global academic community or hold senior positions in world sport and the Olympic Movement. The aim of the programme is:

- a) To encourage global comprehension of Olympism,
- b) To transmit the educational, moral and international goals of the Olympic Movement,
- c) To educate future professors on Olympism.

The 31st International Seminar on Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students was organised from 20 September to 12 October 2024 at the IOA premises in Ancient Olympia. This year, for the first time since it has been established, 16 students, 2 PhD holders, 9 PhD candidates and 5 Master’s students participated.

As every year, the students attended courses on the history and philosophy of the Olympic Games as well as on ethics and integrity concerning sport. In addition, the students discussed and presented topics on the future of the Olympic Games, such as which sports and events should be added or removed from the Olympics and why, how advanced technology will change the Olympics, how the Winter Olympics will survive climate change, whether money will be more and more important in the Olympics or not, the proposal for permanent sites for the Olympics, one in each continent, to be created given the fact that almost everyone is watching the Games on TV or online, etc.

The Seminar was evaluated by the participants. What stood out from the

evaluation results was the high rating of the innovative lectures, the administration staff and the accommodation.

The absolute majority of the students of the Seminar indicate their general satisfaction with their participation in the Seminar.

The positive aspects of the Seminar are the high participation of women 72.2% and 27.8% of men and the high academic level of the participants.

We should also stress that all the participants of the Seminar come from developed countries where they or their universities or their Olympic Committees can cover the costs of their participation in the Seminar.

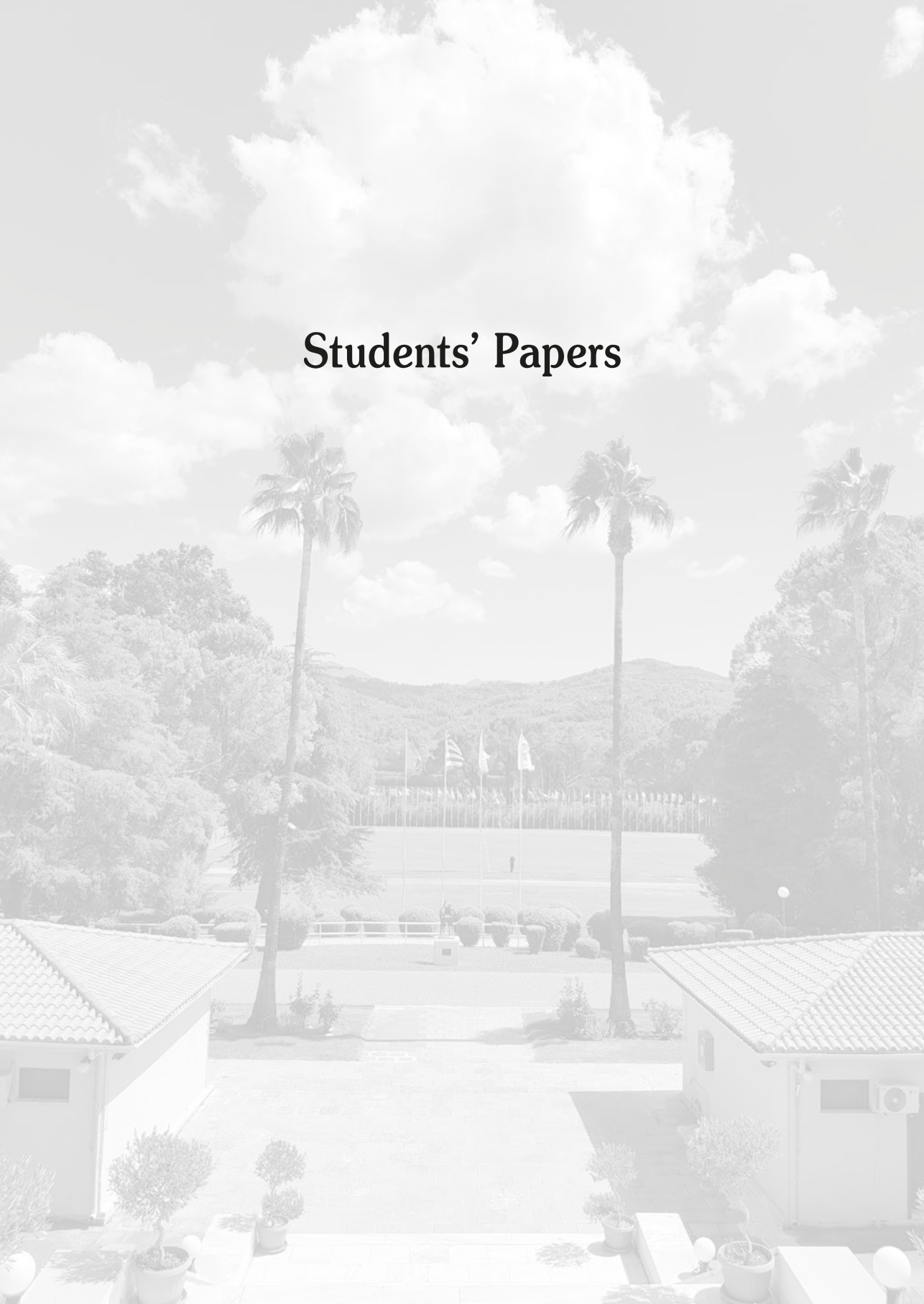
The Postgraduate Seminar implements the following educational objectives: to fill “the gap in scientific research” on Olympic issues at the universities, to enhance cooperation with the academic community and to develop the Olympic Studies worldwide in all continents.

The IOA should work together with the IOC, Olympic Solidarity and the Olympic Studies Centre to support the participation of young academics from Africa, South America and Asia.

Concluding, we would like to point out that the students of this Postgraduate Seminar, in the context of educational visits, were guided around the archaeological sites of the Panhellenic Games. Furthermore, they had the opportunity to connect with other young people from around the world and broaden their cooperation network around the Olympic Movement and Olympism.

Prof. Konstantinos GEORGIADIS
University of the Peloponnese
IOA Dean

Students' Papers



Extracts from Pierre de Coubertin Writings

“The Altis itself was like a sanctuary reserved for the consecrated, purified athlete only, the athlete admitted to the main competitions and who became, in this way, a sort of priest, an officiating priest in the religion of the muscles. Similarly, I see modern Olympism as having at its core a sort of moral Altis, a sacred Altis, a sacred Fortress where the competitors in the manly sports for excellence are gathered to pit their strength against each other. The objectives of these sports are to defend man and to achieve self-mastery, to master danger, the elements, the animal, life”.

“The philosophic foundation of modern Olympism”, in *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31, August 7, 1935, pp. 1-2 (*Pierre de Coubertin (1863-1937), Olympism, Selected Writings*, Norbert Müller (ed.), IOC, Lau-sanne, 2000, pp. 582-3).



“L’Altis même était comme le sanctuaire réservé au seul athlète consacré, purifié, admis aux épreuves principales et devenu ainsi une sorte de prêtre, d’officiant de la religion musculaire. De même, je conçois l’olympisme moderne comme constitué en son centre par une sorte d’Altis morale, de Burg sacré où sont réunis pour affronter leurs forces les concurrents des sports virils par excellence, des sports qui visent la défense de l’homme et sa maîtrise sur lui-même, sur le péril, sur les éléments, sur l’animal, sur la vie”.

«Les assises philosophiques de l’Olympisme moderne», in *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31, August 7, 1935, pp. 1-2.

The opinions of the students do not necessarily reflect those of the International Olympic Academy. Out of respect for multiculturalism and diversity of scientific research, we do not intervene in each student’s way of presenting his/her bibliography and footnotes.

ANCIENT MOVEMENT PEDAGOGY

A KINETIC-INTERACTIONIST READING OF PLATO

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Faculty of Environmental, Regional and Educational Science

Department of Human Movement Science, Sport and Health

1. Introduction

As early as the Archaic period in Greek antiquity¹, a structured educational programme for aristocratic youth developed, gradually becoming more differentiated and including sports² alongside music and literature³. The growing importance of

1. Discussing “antiquity” often risks oversimplifying the distinctions between Greek, Roman, and other Mediterranean or Near Eastern cultures. The term “Greek” used in the following is only a broad category that actually covers a range of regional cultures which can be highly diverse or even reflect specific local attitudes at a given time. It would also be erroneous to assume that views on the same topic remained constant across different periods of Greek history. While brevity in this paper necessitates some generalisation, it is important to recognise that the interpretation of these terms should always be seen as relative.
2. In the context of the above mentioned “antiquity”, the term “sports” – strictly speaking – is an anachronism, as sports as such only became globally widespread in the twentieth century. Ancient Greece, however, knew a large number of words that we today would summarise under sports, but can also mean more than that (e.g. *agon*, *gymnastike*, *athlon*). Therefore, when I speak of ancient sports here and in the following, I interpret this term rather broadly and acknowledge that there was a specific cultural phenomenon in antiquity that we can make tangible with the modern term “sports”. See e.g. Christian Wacker, “Antike Sportgeschichte versus Geschichte des Agon”, in *Jahrbuch 2005 der Deutschen Gesellschaft für Geschichte der Sportwissenschaft e.V.*, ed. Jürgen Court (Münster: Lit, 2006), 39-43; Richard D. Mandell, *Sport: A Cultural History* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1984), XVI; Stephen G. Miller, *Ancient Greek Athletics* (New Haven and London: Yale University Press, 2004), 11-3; Allen Guttmann, *Vom Ritual zum Rekord: Das Wesen des modernen Sports* (Schorndorf: Hofmann, 1979).
3. Ingomar Weiler, “Gymnastik und Agonistik im hellenistischen Gymnasion”, in *Das*

educational sports in Greek *poleis* is especially evident in the fourth century BCE when the *gymnasia*, previously located on the outskirts, moved architecturally closer to the *agora*, the political centre of the city-states⁴. This institutionalisation in an educational system, which was widespread especially by the Hellenistic period, underscores that sports were a central part of public life, closely linked with urbanity, identity, socialisation, and enculturation⁵. At the same time, from the Classical period onwards, there was an increase in intellectual criticism of sports which can be interpreted as a reaction to a prevailing societal normative ideal tied to sports and the public display of corporeality⁶. A symptom of this development is the ancient belief that an athletic body, idealised through statues, victory songs, and honorary inscriptions, conveyed good and virtuous characteristics which is expressed on a visual, performative, and normative-discursive level⁷. Thus, the athletic (male) body became – even as early as Homer’s epics or in the epinician odes of Pindar – a cultural symbol: “Meanings

hellenistische Gymnasion, ed. Daniel Kah and Peter Scholz (Berlin: Akademie, 2004), 25-46; Hans-Joachim Gehrke, “Eine Bilanz: Die Entwicklung des Gymnasiums zur Institution der Sozialisierung der Polis”, in *Das hellenistische Gymnasion*, ed. Daniel Kah and Peter Scholz (Berlin: Akademie, 2004), 413-9; Dirk Fonfara, “Pädagogik”, in *Platon-Handbuch: Leben – Werk – Wirkung*, 2nd ed., ed. Christoph Horn, Jörn Müller, and Joachim Söder (Stuttgart: Metzler, 2017), 246-50.

4. Fikret Yegül, *Baths and Bathing in Classical Antiquity* (Boston: MIT Press, 1992), 9.
5. Weiler, “Gymnastik und Agonistik”, 28; Gehrke, ‘Bilanz’, 414-6; Zinon Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity in Ancient Greece* (London and New York: Routledge, 2019), 126; David M. Pritchard, “Athletic Participation, Training, and Adolescent Education”, in *The Oxford Handbook Sport and Spectacle in the Ancient World*, ed. Alison Futrell and Thomas F. Scanlon (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2021), 629-49.
6. Charles H. Stocking, “Minds, Bodies, and Identities”, in *A Cultural History of Sport in Antiquity*, ed. Paul Christesen and Charles H. Stocking (London: Bloomsbury, 2021), 163. In the following, I will focus solely on educational sports, rather than professional sports, which were often the subject of ancient criticism. This differentiation also pertains to the problematic mythological narrative of a “well-rounded elite athlete-scholar”. David C. Young, “Mens Sana in Corpore Sano? Body and Mind in Ancient Greece”, *The International Journal of the History of Sport* 22, no. 1 (2005): 22-41. For ancient high-performance sports see: Reyes Bertolín Cebrián, *The Athlete in the Ancient Greek World* (Norman: University of Oklahoma Press, 2020), 11-119.
7. Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity*, 121; Lukas Thommen, *Antike Körpergeschichte* (Zürich: vdf, 2007), 35; Georgios Mouratidis and Heather L. Reid, “From Euxia to Eupraxia: Gymnastic Education and Moral Performance”, in *Paideia and Performance*,

and identities generated by sport were literally evinced on bodies, through bodies and between bodies”⁸.

This connection between corporeality and (cap)ability with character and civic good brings to the fore the question of which ancient body- and movement-related ideals an appropriate social and educational practice could be measured⁹. The following builds on recent studies on corporeality in Greek antiquity and particularly addresses the question of specific movement qualities in ancient physical education. Certainly, gaining insight into the lived-bodily and sensory dimension of movement in antiquity is exceedingly difficult and only approximately possible¹⁰. This contribution, however, by focusing on the philosophical discourse on the relation of body and soul¹¹ as well as movement

ed. Henry C. Curcio, Mark Ralkowski, and Heather L. Reid (Syracusa and Dakota Dunes: Parnassos Press, 2023), 209-27. Even in the *Odyssey*, it becomes clear how the assessment of moral virtues was linked to corporeality and physical ability. Numerous examples from epigraphy and various genres of ancient literature – such as those of Pindar, Chariton, Lucian, Isocrates, and others – illustrate this connection. These examples can also be understood as a form of socially significant memory culture in antiquity but must not be reproduced uncritically and without question today. See in similar terms and with a perspective of disability studies e.g. Martin Giese, “Inklusive Sportpädagogik: Kritische Überlegungen zu einer anthropologischen Fundierung”, *German Journal of Exercise and Sport Research* 46, no. 2 (2016): 105.

8. Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity*, 124. See also on this primarily visual perception of virtuous bodies in the context of Greco-Roman physical education Heather L. Reid, “Athletic Beauty as *Mimesis* of Virtue: The Case of the Beautiful Boxer”, in *Looking at Beauty to Kalon in Western Greece*, ed. Heather L. Reid and Tony Leyh (Sioux City: Parnassos Press, 2019), 80-4.
9. In the following, I will limit my discussion to an analysis of Plato. However, this issue could also be addressed through Aristotle’s concept of *eutrapelia* in the *Nicomachean Ethics* 1128a. For some further details, see Matthew W. Dickie, “Παλαιστρίτης/‘palaestra’: Callisthenics in the Greek and Roman Gymnasium”, *Nikephoros* 6 (1993): 105-51.
10. Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity*, 124.
11. Pindar once referred to *nous* (νοῦς) and Xenophanes to *sophia* (σοφία), while Plato (and, incidentally, also Isocrates who lived around the same time) used *psyche* (ψυχή) as the semantic counterpart to the body or *soma* (σῶμα). The word *psyche* is often translated as “soul”, or “mind”, or even “soul/mind”. See e.g. Young, “Mens Sana in Corpore Sano”, 28-9. In the following, I only use “soul” to translate Plato’s *psyche*.

qualities in Plato's works, is intended as a first step upon which further sensory approaches should follow.

2. Body, Movement, and Soul in Plato's Philosophical Dialogues

In antiquity, the term *paideia*, which we might translate as *general pedagogy*, referred to the education of children, adolescents, and adults, beginning in the fifth century BCE¹². It was considered a strong social marker of the elite, although participation in sports became increasingly democratised during the Classical period through the development of the hoplite phalanx and the *gymnasium*¹³. Due to the institutionalisation of sports in the ancient school system, physical education and training became not only an early subject of scientific literature on training¹⁴, but also particularly philosophical-pedagogical (ideal) concepts that dealt with the relationship between physical and intellectual education. This includes the works of Plato, who in the past has been accused of a certain animosity towards the body¹⁵.

2.1. The Problem of a Dualist Reading of Plato's Body and Soul

Plato's anthropology has so far been characterised by a numerical substance

12. Fonfara, "Pädagogik", 246.

13. Heather L. Reid, "Philostratus's Gymnasticus: The Ethics of an Athletic Aesthetic", *Memoirs of the American Academy in Rome* 61 (2016): 78; Henri W. Pleket, "Zur Soziologie des antiken Sports", *Nikephoros* 14 (2001): 181-5.

14. Reid, "Philostratus's Gymnasticus", 77-9.

15. Thommen, *Antike Körpergeschichte*, 9; Jörn Müller, "Dualismus (Leib-Seele-Relation)", in *Platon-Handbuch: Leben – Werk – Wirkung*, 2nd ed., ed. Christoph Horn, Jörn Müller, and Joachim Söder (Stuttgart: Metzler, 2017), 268-72; Coleen P. Zoller, *Plato and the Body: Reconsidering Socratic Asceticism* (Albany: State University of New York Press, 2018), 170-4. In Plato's works, a wide range of topics is addressed; however, while subjects such as knowledge in the *Theaetetus* or issues of law and justice in the *Republic* are explored, the concept of body is not treated as a major *topos* in any of the dialogues. Helen Lang, "The Challenge of Body for Plato" in *ΣΩΜΑ: Körperkonzepte und körperliche Existenz in der antiken Philosophie und Literatur*, ed. Thomas Buchheim, David Meißner, and Nora Wachsmann (Hamburg: Felix Meiner, 2016), 267. It should also be noted here, that Bertolín Cebrián highlights the discrepancy in perception between epigraphic and literary sources concerning a mind-body dualism. Bertolín Cebrián, *Athlete*, 133.

dualism¹⁶. This trend includes works by scholars such as Landmann¹⁷, Rappe¹⁸, or receptions in the context of ancient sports like those of Bertolín Cebrián¹⁹. Against the backdrop of an archaic understanding of the body in Homer, these works, which can only be mentioned here *pars pro multis*, primarily rely on passages in the *Phaedo* or *Alcibiades Maior*²⁰, i.e., mainly the middle²¹ dialogues, but also seek to prove an anthropologically oriented ontological and ethical dualism of body and soul in Plato's later works²². However, Schmitz already considered that Plato's entire work contains indications of a changing engagement with the corporeality of humans, and that especially the dialogue *Timaeus* offers a new chance "für die Würdigung der Leiblichen Anteile des Erlebens"²³. Indeed, bodily impulses are addressed much more precisely in the natural-philosophical and cosmological writings²⁴, where

16. Jörn Müller, "Leib-Seele-Dualismus? Zur Anthropologie beim späten Platon" in *Anthropologie in Antike und Gegenwart: Biologische und philosophische Entwürfe vom Menschen*, ed. Diego De Brasi and Sabine Föllinger (Freiburg and München: Karl Alber, 2015), 59f.; Walter Mesch, "War Platon Substanzdualist? Ein geistphilosophisches Thema und seine Implikationen für den Körper", in *ΣΩΜΑ: Körperkonzepte und körperliche Existenz in der antiken Philosophie und Literatur*, ed. Thomas Buchheim, David Meißner, and Nora Wachsmann (Hamburg: Felix Meiner, 2016), 227. For an overview of research on Platonic anthropology, see: Jörn Müller, "Anthropologie", in *Platon-Handbuch: Leben – Werk – Wirkung*, 2nd ed., ed. Christoph Horn, Jörn Müller, and Joachim Söder (Stuttgart: Metzler, 2017), 196-205.
17. Michael Landmann, "Die Griechen", in *De homine: Der Mensch im Spiegel seines Gedankens*, ed. Michael Landmann (Freiburg and München: Karl Alber, 1962), 71-3.
18. Guido Rappe, *Archaische Leiberfahrung: Der Leib in der frühgriechischen Philosophie und in außereuropäischen Kulturen* (Berlin: Akademie, 1995), 258.
19. Bertolín Cebrián, *Athlete*, 124-35.
20. The authenticity of the *Alcibiades Maior* is, however, quite contested. Joachim Söder, "Zu Platons Werken", in *Platon-Handbuch: Leben – Werk – Wirkung*, 2nd ed., ed. Christoph Horn, Jörn Müller, and Joachim Söder (Stuttgart: Metzler, 2017), 21.
21. It should be noted that a strict distinction between early, middle, and later works of Plato is difficult. Only the *Laws* can be dated with a certain degree of accuracy. Söder, "Zu Platons Werken", 23-7.
22. Müller, "Leib-Seele-Dualismus", 60. According to Landmann, the Platonic conception of the human being is viewed as a "homo duplex", thus positioning Plato as a predecessor of a Cartesian substance dualism. Landmann, "Die Griechen", 71-3.
23. Hermann Schmitz, *Der Leib* (Bonn: Bouvier, 1965), 484; see also Rappe, *Archaische Leiberfahrung*, 258.
24. This includes, in particular, the dialogue *Timaeus*. Thomas K. Johansen, "Body, Soul, and Tripartition in Plato's *Timaeus*", *Oxford Studies in Ancient Philosophy* 19 (2000): 87-111.

Plato reconsiders the relation of body and soul in both micro and macro frames²⁵. In Johansen's words, here "the body is designed with a view to increasing our rationality"²⁶. The crucial point is that if Plato views the body in his later works as an instance that can bring reason, he must assume a fundamental connection between body and soul that does not justify a mere equation of his anthropology and psychology with Cartesian dualism²⁷.

2.2. Kinetic-Interactionist View

Recent research²⁸ into a revised and multi-layered understanding of body and soul in Plato has been presented by scholars such as Carone²⁹, Johansen³⁰, Kamtekar³¹, Müller³², Ostenfeld³³, and Zoller³⁴. I would like to summarise some of these interpretations to challenge the prevailing dualism with passages from *Timaeus* and *Laws* due to the decisive role that movement is playing here.

The philosophical theory of movement is specifically described in *Timaeus* 57d-8c, according to which movement represents a relational structure: Movement exists only when there is (1) a passive element that is moved

25. Müller, "Dualismus (Leib-Seele-Relation)", 269. Even in the early dialogues, various forms of dualism can be identified, demonstrating that Plato himself is not consistent in his treatment of the body-soul relation throughout his entire oeuvre. Thomas M. Robinson, "The Defining Features of Mind-Body Dualism in the Writings of Plato" in *Psyche and Soma*, ed. John P. Wright and Paul Potter (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2000), 37-55.

26. Johansen, "Body, Soul, and Tripartition", 109.

27. Examples supporting this will be given in the next paragraph.

28. See also the collection of essays in Thomas Buchheim, David Meißner, and Nora Wachsmann, eds., *ΣΩΜΑ: Körperkonzepte und körperliche Existenz in der antiken Philosophie und Literatur* (Hamburg: Felix Meiner, 2016).

29. Gabriela R. Carone, "Mind and Body in Late Plato", *Archiv für Geschichte der Philosophie* 87, no. 3 (2005): 227-69.

30. Johansen, "Body, Soul, and Tripartition", 87-111.

31. Rachana Kamtekar, "Psychology and the Inculcation of Virtue in Plato's *Laws*", in: *Plato's Laws: A Critical Guide*, ed. Christopher Bobonich (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010), 127-48.

32. Müller, 'Leib-Seele-Dualismus', 59-96.

33. Erik N. Ostenfeld, *Ancient Greek Psychology And the Modern Mind-Body Debate*, 2nd ed. (Baden-Baden: Academia, 2018).

34. Zoller, *Plato and the Body*, 169-88. This study, however, does not directly talk about sports.

(κινησόμενον) and (2) an active element *to* move (κινῆσον; *Timaeus* 57e). Notably, all movements within the cosmos are contingent upon the soul of the cosmos. Thus, according to *Laws* 896e–7a, the soul is fundamentally considered as a cosmic principle of movement, because it can move itself (τὴν δυναμένην αὐτὴν αὐτὴν κινεῖν κίνησιν). This aligns with the explanations in the *Timaeus*, where this cosmic self-movement is conceived as circular (αὐτὴ τε ἀνακυκλουμένη πρὸς αὐτή; *Timaeus* 37a-c)³⁵. However, the circular self-movements of the soul are disrupted, hindered, or confused at the moment when the immortal soul is bound to (or embodied into) a mortal human body, i.e., at the moment of world creation (ἀτάκτως καὶ ἀλόγως; *Timaeus* 43a-4b, 69c-e)³⁶.

The consequences of this binding are crucial and show that the human body and soul, although ontologically different, should not be understood as dualistic according to Müller³⁷. An example from *Laws* 790d-e illustrates this, where the practice of rocking distressed babies to calm them is described:³⁸

*“When mothers want to lull children who have difficulty falling asleep, they do not rely on stillness, but – in contrary – on motion, always rocking them in their arms; they do not rely on silence, but on singing, and they enchant the children as if with the sound of flutes, [...] using this combination of movements of dance and music as a remedy”*³⁹.

35. Raphael Demos, ‘Plato’s Doctrine of the Psyche as Self-Moving Motion’, *Journal of the History of Philosophy* 6, no. 2 (1968): 133–45. According to *Phaedrus* 245c–6a, this self-movement is only possible if the soul itself is considered immortal. Wolfgang Scheffel, *Aspekte der platonischen Kosmologie: Untersuchungen zum Dialog ‘Timaios’* (Leiden: Brill, 1976), 92–8.

36. Müller, ‘Leib-Seele-Dualismus’, 69; Kamtekar, ‘Inculcation of Virtue’, 127–48. See also Camille Guigon, ‘Explaining Embodiment in Plato’s Philosophy: The Hypothesis of the Mirror’, in *Body and Soul in Ancient Greece and Rome* (Siracusa and Dakota Dunes: Parnassos Press, 2024), 93–109.

37. Müller, ‘Leib-Seele-Dualismus’, 59–96.

38. Further passages that support an interactionist reading include: *Laws* 644d–54e, 791c, *Timaeus* 43a–4b, 86d–e.

39. If not otherwise stated, translations are my own. For the connection of sports and music in moral education see Heather L. Reid and Georgios Mouratidis, “Did *Gymnastike* Train the Body or the Mind?”, in *Body and Soul in Ancient Greece and Rome*, ed. Jurgen R. Gatt, Samatha Newington, and Michaela Senkova (Siracusa and Dakota Dunes: Parnassos Press, 2024), 159–74.

The explanation follows shortly afterward in *Laws* 791a:

“The external motion overpowers the inner fearful and frenzy motion, and once it has conquered this inner motion by bringing calm to the soul and relieving the heavy heartbeat that typically occurs in such situations – an outcome that is wholly desirable – it allows the children to find sleep”.

Here, the body with its feelings and inclinations is clearly dependent on a rational soul⁴⁰, but corporeal sensations – *vice versa* – can also influence mental processes⁴¹. The causal connection in the differentiation between soul and body, therefore, determines that through the medium of movement⁴², physical sensations translate directly into mental movements⁴³.

Thus, according to Müller, the human body and soul are interwoven in a kinetic causal interactionism that does not exclude reciprocal influence between soul and body, while presupposing an ontological difference between them⁴⁴. Movement functions as the mediator between body and soul in these interactions, from which Plato also derives pedagogical implications for physical education⁴⁵.

3. Implications for Plato’s Movement Pedagogy

Having talked about non-intentional movement or the application of passive motion to human bodies with *Laws* 790d-e in the previous chapter, we can assume that the consequences of the Platonic movement philosophy and kinanthropology are educationally relevant, especially when we now look at sports as intentional and active self-movement. Since we have seen in principle

40. Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 64.

41. Ibid., 65. This even affects the golden thread of reason from *Laws* 645a. See in particular the Puppet Analogy in *Laws* 644d-54e, which is situated in the context of the idea of self-control, and also more generally *Timaeus* 43a-4b.

42. In this case, motion is applied from outside. In the following chapter, active movement will be discussed.

43. Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 67.

44. As this is further differentiated by the soul and movement conception in *Timaeus*, the eschatology in *Phaedrus*, and the movement categories of *Laws*, it can even be argued that Plato is developing a kinanthropology. Ibid., 63-79.

45. Ibid., 66.

that educational work can also be done for the soul through the physical, the body and its implicit sensations should not be suppressed but can even be functional in its very own effects⁴⁶.

3.1. General Telos

The ethical telos and highest aim of Platonic physical education, as described in several passages including *Timaeus* 90b-d, is alignment with the divine:⁴⁷ “When mortals excel at sport, they gain a taste of what it would be like to be a deity”⁴⁸. However, as argued above, the physical is not an obstacle to human perfection but rather a necessary condition for its realisation⁴⁹. It becomes evident that overcoming the antagonism between reason and emotion is a significant educational moment for Plato⁵⁰. In this context, the soul’s rationality refers to circular, orderly movement, while physical affect and emotion relate to rectilinear, disorderly movement (*Laws* 898a-b; *Timaeus* 37a-c, 43a-d). Plato derives the central importance of movement learning from this philosophy of movement: A child who is born with uncoordinated movements and a strong physical urge to move should be introduced to proper movements as early as possible⁵¹.

The human soul, which, through its interactionist connection to the human body, has the primary drive to align with the divine, cosmic soul while simultaneously being overwhelmed by the physical, is shaped in its

46. Ibid.; Zoller, *Plato and the Body*, 185.

47. Michael Bordt, “Angleichung an Gott”, in *Platon-Handbuch: Leben – Werk – Wirkung*, 2nd ed., ed. Christoph Horn, Jörn Müller, and Joachim Söder (Stuttgart: Metzler, 2017), 258-72.

48. Nigel Spivey, “Representation”, in *A Cultural History of Sport in Antiquity*, ed. Paul Christesen and Charles H. Stocking (London: Bloomsbury, 2021), 190. For professional sport see: Heather L. Reid, “The ecstasy of Arete: Flow as self-transcendence in ancient athletics”, *Studies in Sport Humanities* 15 (2014): 6-12.

49. Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 69-70; Elena Bartolini, “Moving the Body to Elevate the Soul”, in *Body and Soul in Ancient Greece and Rome*, ed. Jürgen R. Gatt, Samatha Newington, and Michaela Senkova (Siracusa and Dakota Dunes: Parnassos Press, 2024), 79-91. Also, there is simply no way for humans to escape embodiment.

50. This arises from a cosmological necessity: “Immortal souls must be embodied in mortal bodies if the cosmos is to have mortal as well as immortal species in it, and thereby to be as perfect as possible (39e-40a)”. Kamtekar, “Inculcation of Virtue”, 132; see also Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 63, 70.

51. Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 68.

inner movements by bodily movement⁵². Physical education, then, is about dealing with this overwhelming circular channelling of the physical in order to produce harmonious and rhythmic soul movements (*Laws* 664e-5d; 673c-d). All movements are seen as a continuum and, thus, are relevant to human development depending on the degree of their agency, i.e., the proportion of the soul's self-movement (*Timaeus* 89a):⁵³

“Concerning movements [viz. of the body], the best is movement in itself by itself, for it is most akin to the motion of thought and the universe, but the movement through something else is worse, but the worst is the movement of the body lying down and at rest through other forces that move it part by part. Therefore, of the means of purifying the body and bringing it into good form, gymnastic exercises are the best, and the second best is rocking on ships or wherever journeys take place that do not cause fatigue”.

The educational potential of sport arises from the fact that the desired self-movements of the soul are physically imitated in their original action and in the sense of *katharsis* (κάθαρσις): Sport, therefore, does not merely serve physical training that brings about strength, speed, stamina, etc., but directly contributes to the ethical telos of Platonic teaching. In the words of Gehrke, one could also speak of an education towards appropriateness⁵⁴. In the hierarchy of physical movements, sports hold the highest place because, as self-movement, it is most closely related to the movement of the greater cosmos⁵⁵. In doing sports, soul and body are brought into symmetry and mental and physical movements are synchronised (*Timaeus* 88b):

“There is only one means of salvation for both, namely neither to move the soul without the body, nor the body without the soul, so that they come into balance and become healthy”.

Thus, Plato elevates movement to a valuable principle of his *paideia* (*Republic* 410b-11e), which applies even before birth (*Laws* 789a-93e) and

52. Ibid.

53. Ibid., 66-7; Kamtekar, “Inculcation of Virtue”, 143-9. See also the example of dance in *Laws* 652a-4a which will be discussed later.

54. Gehrke, “Bilanz”, 415.

55. Müller, “Leib-Seele-Dualismus”, 69.

consequently to all age groups (*Laws* 653d, 664c, 665a, 666b, 670b, 812b-c, 814e-6e)⁵⁶. Consequently, according to this reading, Plato views humans as in need of physical education⁵⁷.

3.2. Ancient Pedagogic Principles of Physical Education

It is well-documented that specific qualitative movement ideals were relevant in ancient physical education and sports training. For example, there were competitions in the *gymnasion* for *eutaxia* (εὐταξία), *philoponia* (φιλοπονία), and *euexia* (εὐεξία), which can be compared to today's fitness contests⁵⁸. Plato also identifies programmatic educational goals of the *gymnasion* in the *Laws* and the *Republic*, which can be traced back to his previously explained kinanthropology (*Republic* 400c-d): namely the closely related (movement) aesthetic goals of *eurhythmia* (εὐρυθμία) and *euschemosyne* (εὐσχημοσύνη)⁵⁹. *Euschemosyne*, which is particularly associated with wrestling in *Laws* 795d-6a, refers to "good form"⁶⁰, and with the accompanying term *katastasis* (κατάστασις) is primarily targeting the body at rest. *Eurhythmia*, on the other hand, which is especially attributed to dance as part of gymnastics, refers to the ability for "grace of movement"⁶¹, including the completion of a movement radius, agility, and aesthetics in the sense of normative athletic beauty⁶². The fact that these aesthetic categories are applied implies that a person, who, according to Plato, has a natural drive for movement due to the soul, can differentiate qualitatively

56. Seth Bernadete, *Plato's Laws: The Discovery of Being* (Chicago and London: University of Chicago Press, 2000), 190-231. According to Plato, physical education is especially relevant for the class of guardians (*Republic* 397a-412a). See Bartolini, "Moving the Body", 87-90.

57. Kamptekar, "Inculcation of Virtue", 143; similar the conclusion on which is best for body and soul in *Theaetetus* 153c.

58. Gehrke, "Bilanz", 415; Mouratidis and Reid, "From Euexia to Eupraxia", 209-27; Nigel B. Crowther, "Euexia, Eutaxia, Philoponia: Three Contests of the Greek Gymnasium", *Zeitschrift für Papyrologie und Epigraphik* 85 (1991): 301-4. Euexia is also a term used by Plato (*Laws* 789c).

59. Dickie, "Callisthenics", 112.

60. Ibid.

61. Ibid.

62. Dickie, "Callisthenics", 105-51. Here, the ideal of *kalokagathia* would also be applicable. See Irena Martínková, "Kalokagathia. How to Understand Harmony of a Human Being", *Nikephoros* 14 (2001): 21-8.

and aesthetically regarding rhythmic and harmonious movement qualities (*Laws* 652a-4a).⁶³

*“While other animals do not have perception of order or disorder in motions, which are named rhythm and harmony, the gods have given to us, as companions in dance, perception with pleasure of what is rhythmic and harmonious, by which we both move and lead choruses, connecting with one another by means of songs and dances”*⁶⁴.

When Plato places his physical education in the context of the *Republic* and *Laws*, eurhythmic differentiation becomes both a pedagogical moment and a social normative (*Laws* 795d-6a)⁶⁵. It is difficult to determine to what extent this programmatic approach was reflected in the actual reality of the Greek *gymnasia*, but it becomes evident that those who excelled particularly in these qualities, as opposed to professional heavy-weight athletes, were honoured as *palaistrites* (παλαιστίτης)⁶⁶. This aesthetic body ideal became influential especially from the Hellenistic period and in Roman times and was probably derived from Plato’s philosophy of movement⁶⁷. Therefore, it can be assumed that within the context of physical education, a social process took place, which, between athletic/social agency⁶⁸, the multisensory nature of fellowship experiences⁶⁹, and embodied encounters with the sensory site of the *gymnasion* performatively produced, reproduced, and actualised these normative movement-aesthetic ideals⁷⁰. At

63. For rhythmic perception see e.g. Jonna K. Vuoskoskia and Dee Reynolds, “Music, rowing, and the aesthetics of rhythm”, *The Senses and Society* 14, no. 1 (2019): 1-14.

64. Translation of *Laws* 653d-4a by Kamtekar, “Inculcation of Virtue”, 128.

65. See also *Philebus* 17c-e.

66. *Ibid.*, 127-8.

67. *Ibid.*, 132-46.

68. See for a similar approach to a performative practice Jessica Fiala and Suparna Banerjee, “Performative Somaesthetics: Interconnections of Dancers, Audiences, and Sites”, *The Journal of Somaesthetics* 6, no. 1: 91-111; John Toner and Barbara Montero, “The value of aesthetic judgements in athletic performance”, *The Journal of Somaesthetics* 6, no. 1 (2020): 112-26; Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity*, 137.

69. Since the primary concern is on an educational context, here, it would be an oversimplification to refer to an audience in the narrower sense. Instead, I would argue that normativity arises through direct social interaction in the *gymnasium*.

70. Yannis Hamilakis, Mark Pluciennik, and Sarah Tarlow, “Introduction: Thinking Through the Body”, in *Thinking through the Body: Archaeologies of Corporeality* (New

least in Plato's ideal state, the concept of *eurhythmia* becomes an ideological marker of social order (*Laws* 798a-9b)⁷¹.

4. Conclusion

The Platonic dialogues *Laws* and *Timaeus* inform us about the educational value of movement, based on the philosophical concept of (self-)movement of the soul, which Plato conceptualises concerning the body. However, recent research in classical philology and philosophy questions the prevalent dualistic interpretation of Plato's body-soul-concept. Building on Müller's reading of a kinetic interactionism⁷², this paper emphasised the relevance of bodily perception and action for Plato's pedagogy. According to *Republic* 400d, the primary educational goals of physical training included *eurhythmia* and *euschemosyne*⁷³. These ideals were fundamental objectives that could be said to have defined the educational programme in ancient *gymnasia* as early as the fourth century BCE, making movement and sports fundamental educational principles. Hence, having argued that Plato can be considered one of the first sports educators, it has been posited that a kinetic interactionist view of the relation of body and soul regarding these ancient educational movement ideals enhances the understanding of programmatic in ancient *gymnasia*. Not only did corporeality and bodily performance define social elites and "retrospectively

York: Springer, 2002), 1-21; David Howes, "Digging up the sensorium: On the sensory revolution in archaeology", in: *The Routledge Handbook of Sensory Archaeology*, ed. Robin Skeates and Jo Day (London and New York: Routledge, 2020), 21-34; Elk Franke, "Körperliche Erkenntnis – die andere Vernunft", in *Bildungstheoretische Grundlagen der Bewegungs- und Sportpädagogik*, ed. Jörg Bietz, Ralf Laging, and Monika Roscher (Baltmannsweiler: Schneider, 2005), 180-201; Thomas F. Carter, Sean Heath, Sarah Jacobs, and Jasmijn Rana, "Sensory ecologies: the refinement of movement and the senses in sport", *The Senses and Society* 17, no. 3 (2022): 241-251; Phillip Vannini, Dennis Waskul, and Simon Gottschalk, *The Senses in Self, Society, and Culture: A Sociology of the Senses* (New York: Routledge, 2012).

71. See also Fonfara, "Pädagogik", 250. At this point, due to the brevity of this article, it should be noted that the connection between *eurhythmia* and wrestling should be investigated more carefully in future studies.

72. Müller, "Leib-Seele Dualismus", 59-96.

73. Dickie, "Callisthenics", 105-51.

justified their positions of social and political ascendancy”⁷⁴, but also movement-related rhythmic ideals shaped an education for a greater civic good.

This critique of substance dualism in ancient movement pedagogy invites further studies into the social processes involved in the reproduction and actualisation of aesthetic movement ideals, particularly in sensory and performative terms. Especially successful moments during learning processes in sports by ancient athletes might play a central role, as it can be assumed that in these moments, the fulfilment of ideals becomes most vividly embodied, experienced, and perceived⁷⁵. This includes examining to what extent specific ancient disciplines might have particular rhythmic characteristics or what *eurhythmia* means in a given discipline⁷⁶. Again, this can only be determined from the perspective of concrete action and a performative perspective⁷⁷. The focus of such investigations, therefore, must be on actual movement⁷⁸, since:

τὸ μὲν ἄρα ἀγαθὸν κίνησις κατὰ τε ψυχὴν καὶ κατὰ σῶμα⁷⁹.
– *Theaetetus* 153c

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74. Papakonstantinou, *Sport and Identity*, 139.

75. Or experiences of flow. See e.g. Reid, *Ecstasy of Areté*, 6-12.

76. This applies, e.g., to questions of flute playing in the ancient long jump or *eurhythmia* in combat sports.

77. A first proposal for such an approach has been made in M. Tarik Orliczek, “Ästhetiken des Antiken: Eine experimentalarchäologisch-leibästhetische Auseinandersetzung mit der platonischen Bewegungspädagogik” (State Examination thesis, Philipps-University of Marburg, 2022).

78. M. Tarik Orliczek, “Archaeokinetics. A New Methodological Approach to Reconstructing Ancient Athletics” (paper presented at the 16th Annual Conference of the International Society for Cultural History, Potsdam, Germany, September 4-6, 2024).

79. Translation: “Consequently, movement is the good for both the soul and the body”.

THE DEVELOPMENT AND EVOLUTION OF OLYMPIC EDUCATION FROM A HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE

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Abstract

Education was not only the original intention of the founder of the modern Olympic Movement but also the heading marker, which guided the Olympic Movement. Olympic education is an educational activity that has been carried out to meet the demand of international society to promote the balanced overall development of human beings, enhance the harmonious progress of society and advance world peace. It takes the athletic sports as the basic vehicle and the environment in a native country as the condition. Exploring the evolution of Olympic education from a historical perspective, re-examining the past of the Olympic Movement, diagnosing its current state, and analysing its future are of significant practical relevance to the ongoing Olympic reforms.

1. The Birth of Olympic Education

The ancient Olympic Games emphasised the value of harmonious development of body and mind, a concept with profound influence. Between the 14th and 18th centuries, Europe experienced the Renaissance, the Reformation, and the Enlightenment. These three major intellectual and cultural movements praised the humanistic spirit of ancient Greece by promoting the idea of the harmonious development of body and mind. This not only cleared the ideological obstacles for modern sports but also sparked interest in ancient Greek sports and the Olympic Games. Furthermore, the educational reforms of the bourgeoisie established the

humanistic concept of harmonious development as the core value of education, positioning sports within the educational system and affirming the educational and social value of competitive sports. After France's defeat in the Franco-Prussian War in 1870, the shortcomings of the French education system and its outdated content became evident. Pierre de Coubertin, who experienced the war during his childhood, was inspired by a patriotic zeal to revive France and committed himself to educational reform. He sought to use sports as a vehicle to educate the world's youth by organising the modern Olympic Games and reviving the ancient Greek concept of harmonious development. The successful hosting of the 1896 Athens Olympic Games not only marked the international debut of the modern Olympic Movement but also signified the true birth of Olympic education, which uses sports as a fundamental means and aims at the harmonious development of individuals.

1.1 Olympic Education During the Formation of Nation-States (From 1896 to the Second World War)

In the 19th century, nation-states were gradually formed across Europe and North America. The competition among these nations for influence and power led to constant friction and ultimately resulted in the outbreak of the First World War. As people endured the suffering brought by the war, their need for sports grew during the reconstruction period, along with a stronger desire for world peace. In this context, Olympic education gradually took shape after difficult explorations, evolving into an educational format centered around the Olympic Games. It brought together young people from around the world to engage in cultural exchange, with the aim of achieving peace among nations. This not only significantly enhanced the educational value of competitive sports but also integrated Olympic education with sports, moral education, and aesthetic education by combining it with various forms of art. The main organising body of Olympic education is the International Olympic Committee (IOC), with its primary educational focus on outstanding amateur athletes, who serve as role models, creating a demonstrative effect and extending the influence of Olympic education.

1.2 Olympic Education During the Cold War (From the Post-World War II Period to the Mid-1980s)

After World War II, the international community entered a bipolar Cold War era. The two major blocs, led by the United States and the Soviet Union,

engaged in fierce competition in political, economic, and military arenas, with ideological conflicts becoming increasingly evident. However, in the ongoing struggle between the forces of peace and conflict, peace remained the dominant trend. This created a favorable international environment for the development of Olympic education. Olympic education utilised sports as a fundamental means to promote the Olympic spirit and ideals of friendship and solidarity, aiming to reconcile ideological conflicts, oppose colonialism and racism, and achieve peace among nations and inclusiveness among differing ideologies. The participation of the Soviet Union and other socialist countries extended ideological conflicts into the Olympic Games, turning the Games into a tool for political struggle between the two blocs, thereby complicating Olympic education. Additionally, the politicisation of the outcomes of competitive events weakened the educational function of the Olympics itself. Consequently, during this period, Olympic education expanded beyond the framework of the Olympic Games, incorporating non-Olympic educational forms. The primary organising body of Olympic education also evolved from the International Olympic Committee (IOC) to include the International Olympic Academy, and its focus expanded from Olympic athletes to the general youth population.

1.3 Olympic Education in the Era of Globalisation (Late 1980s to the Present)

After the end of the Cold War, international political, economic, and cultural exchanges and cooperation became more closely intertwined. Ideological conflicts were no longer the focal point; instead, attention shifted to cultural differences and conflicts. At the same time, the development of globalisation brought about various global issues that negatively impacted human society. There was a growing awareness of the need for a global mindset and a cultural consensus to address the tensions and conflicts resulting from globalisation, which was driven by market logic.

As a result, the goals of Olympic education evolved from fostering inclusiveness between nations and ideologies to promoting international peace and cooperation, aiming for a deeper and broader understanding. The Olympic Games grew into the largest sports and cultural event in the world, serving both to promote Olympic education and to highlight its challenges. However, due to political and economic interference, the educational value of the Olympic Games has sometimes been difficult to fully realise, leading to a diversified

development of non-Olympic forms of Olympic education. These two forms of Olympic education – Olympic and non-Olympic – each play their respective roles, working together to fulfill the mission of Olympic education.

During this period, the main organising bodies of Olympic education expanded beyond the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the International Olympic Academy to include the Olympic Organising Committees of host countries, educational departments, and other relevant associations and organisations, promoting diversified development. The target audience of Olympic education also expanded from Olympic athletes and the general youth population to include school students.

2. Modern Olympic Education: Each Host Country's Olympic Education Programme Has Its Own Unique Characteristics

The host cities and countries of the Olympic Games, taking into account their national conditions and cultural traditions, have developed a variety of Olympic education activities targeting primarily children and youth. These activities are diverse in form and include education on Olympic knowledge, sports education, cultural and artistic education, environmental education, international understanding, and multicultural education. Whether it is environmental awareness education, international understanding, or multicultural education, all are essential components of education for sustainable development. Sustainable development is a crucial concept for survival and progress that the United Nations is actively promoting globally. In the field of education, thanks to the persistent efforts of UNESCO, education for sustainable development has been widely implemented across various countries. In the Chinese context and within China's educational system, this type of education for sustainable development can be categorised as a new form of moral education for the 21st century.

2.1 Research and Publication of Olympic Knowledge Education Materials

During the Calgary Winter Olympics, building on the foundation of the Olympic education from the 1976 Montreal Olympic cycle, a systematic and scientific Olympic education programme was developed. Among its initiatives, the Olympic knowledge education stands out as a classic example. The Calgary Organising Committee established a Youth Education Department and an

Educational Curriculum Committee, which developed three sets of Olympic education materials tailored to elementary, middle, and high school levels. The editing, publishing, and distribution of these materials greatly promoted the dissemination of Olympic knowledge and laid the groundwork for the preparation of Olympic knowledge materials in future Olympic cycles. Additionally, a variety of cultural and artistic education activities were organised, which not only emphasised the theme of the Winter Olympics but also reflected Canada's cultural and artistic traditions.

2.2 Environmental Awareness Education Becomes a Traditional Component of School Olympic Education Programmes

In the 1990s, environmental protection began to shift from a conceptual awareness to a global movement, gaining attention from governments, businesses, and the general public worldwide. The Lillehammer Olympics, recognised for its successful environmental initiatives, is considered the first "Green" Olympics in Olympic history. During this Olympic cycle, a national education programme was developed in the host country, aiming to use the Olympics as a platform for environmental education. This programme, developed by the Organising Committee, the Norwegian Olympic Committee, and other organisations, covered topics such as the environment, peace, local communities, media, Norwegian and foreign cultures, the economy, and health. Since then, environmental education has become a significant component of school Olympic education programmes.

2.3 The "One School, One Country" Programme as an Effective Path for Olympic International Understanding Education

During the Nagano Olympic cycle, the Organising Committee initiated three major Olympic education activities: distributing educational materials, establishing youth clubs, and developing the "One School, One Country" programme. The successful implementation of the "One School, One Country" programme not only broadened the international perspectives and global mindset of Japanese students but, more importantly, provided a platform for youth from around the world to participate in the Olympic Movement. This initiative marked the beginning of a new era in Olympic international understanding education.

2.4 Athens and Turin Olympic Education Reflects Rich Western Cultural and Historical Traditions

Greece, the birthplace of the Olympics, has a long-standing tradition of Olympic cultural education, a unique feature that no other host country can replicate. The Athens Olympic education programme inherited centuries of evolving sportsmanship, blending past and modern educational and cultural values to promote the harmonious development of individuals. While fully reflecting the distinctive characteristics of Greek culture, it also adopted an open approach to incorporating the essence of world cultures. This was particularly evident in the development of Olympic educational materials. The 2006 Turin Olympic education programme centered around themes of morality, society, and the natural environment, reflecting Italy's rich historical and cultural heritage. The programme was organised around five themes, symbolised by the Olympic rings, underscoring its close connection with Olympic ideals. The programme included the distribution of multimedia educational kits, the creation of a Children's Village website, organising student visits to the Olympic Museum in Lausanne, hosting Olympic math competitions, and conducting sports events.

2.5 Beijing Olympic Education Opens a New Chapter in Multicultural Education

The 2008 Beijing Olympics marked the first time the Games were held in China, a developing Eastern nation with a rich history spanning 5,000 years, home to a continuous and enduring cultural heritage. Following 30 years of reform and opening up, China experienced rapid development across political, economic, cultural, and social spheres, leading to an unprecedented period of prosperity. The Beijing Olympics became an exceptional platform for China to connect with the world and for the world to better understand China. Through this platform, China fully showcased and celebrated Eastern culture, providing a vivid contrast and complement to the predominantly Western Olympic culture, embodying the Olympic spirit of multicultural integration and mutual enrichment. Beijing Olympic education is a prime example of this multicultural exchange. Under the leadership of the Beijing Organising Committee and the Ministry of Education of China, Beijing's Olympic education focused on Olympic education demonstration schools and the "Heart-to-Heart" programme as its main activities. Educational administrative departments acted as the primary driving force, attracting widespread social participation. The Olympic education

demonstration schools allowed young people to fully learn and experience the Olympic spirit through practical participation, serving as a model that inspired other schools, rural and mountainous areas, and community residents to share in the joy and passion of the Olympics. The “Heart-to-Heart” programme facilitated cross-cultural learning and exchanges among youth worldwide through international communication. Thus, Beijing Olympic education, with its unique Chinese cultural characteristics, opened a new chapter in Olympic multicultural education and provided a model and example for developing countries to engage in Olympic education.

3. The Basic Trends in the Future Development of Olympic Education

After more than a century of development, Olympic education has shown several key trends for its future growth. Its focus has expanded from the individual level to the broader societal level, and its scope has extended from social dimensions to include ecological dimensions. The forms of Olympic education have diversified from singular approaches to a variety of methods, and its content has evolved from Western cultural perspectives to embrace multiculturalism. The organisational structure has grown in both size and complexity, transitioning from simplicity to greater intricacy. Furthermore, the target audience has broadened from elite athletes to include the general public, with a particular emphasis on school students.

3.1 The Focus of Olympic Education: From the Micro-Level of the Individual to the Macro-Level of Society

In its early stages, Olympic education emphasised the promotion of harmonious physical and mental development through Olympic competition, primarily focusing on the individual dimension. The concept of harmonious physical and mental development was a key educational philosophy consistently upheld by Pierre de Coubertin and remains an enduring theme in human development. In 1906, to restore harmony between the body and the spirit, Coubertin convened the Conference on Literature, Art, and Sport, establishing the connection between sports, literature, and art. The 1913 Conference on Sports Psychology further highlighted the value of the Olympic Games in promoting individual physical and mental harmony. Coubertin repeatedly emphasised in

various settings that the fundamental difference between the Olympic Games and other sports competitions lies in the Olympic Movement's pursuit not only of technical excellence but, more importantly, of moral values in competition. Olympic education, through various forms, cultivates morally conscious global citizens, fostering deeper mutual understanding and respect, and ultimately achieving international peace and cooperation. In the 1990s, the International Olympic Committee's proposal for a "truce agreement" received unanimous approval from the United Nations, finally realising Pierre de Coubertin's 1935 vision of incorporating the "truce concept" into the Olympic Games. The evolution of Olympic education from focusing on the individual's physical and mental harmony at the micro-level to addressing broader issues such as social democracy and international peace at the macro-level is a testament to the continuous progress towards the Olympic ideal.

3.2 The Evolution of Olympic Education: From Singular to Diverse Forms

Initially, Pierre de Coubertin applied the competitive sports education of educators like Arnold from the United Kingdom to the global stage through the Olympic Games, using them as a means to practice international and, eventually, global education. This not only greatly expanded the educational value of competitive sports but also integrated sports with literature and art, creating an Olympic education that combined physical, aesthetic, and moral education, centered around human movement and the movement of people.

However, as the Olympic Games continued to grow and develop, they began to take on international political and economic functions. Since the ultimate interests pursued by politicians and businesses often do not align with the harmonious development of individuals, the educational value of the Olympics has often been compromised in the pursuit of resources within the context of international political and economic competition. This has revealed certain vulnerabilities and inconsistencies in Olympic education.

As a result, non-Olympic forms of Olympic education, such as the International Olympic Academy and school-based Olympic education programmes, began to emerge and diversify, especially during the era of globalisation. Both Olympic and non-Olympic forms of Olympic education have developed in a complementary and mutually supportive manner, each fulfilling specific roles, and together carrying out the mission of Olympic education.

3.3 The Target Audience of Olympic Education: From Elite Athletes to the General Public

Education is an activity of cultivating people, with different educational approaches targeting different talent development needs. In the early stages, Olympic education primarily focused on the training of amateur athletes. Elite athletes are the core of the Olympic Games, where they are cultivated to develop qualities such as perseverance, fair competition, and the spirit of self-transcendence, which they then carry into their daily lives and work. However, for Pierre de Coubertin, the ultimate goal was not merely to cultivate elite athletes but to enable them to serve as role models, creating a demonstrative effect that would guide and encourage everyone to participate in sports, thereby receiving an education in harmonious development.

As Olympic education evolved, its target audience gradually expanded to include the general public. At the same time, the direct target of non-Olympic forms of Olympic education continued to grow, extending from the general youth population to school students, highlighting the importance of these educational forms. The training and research activities of the International Olympic Academy primarily target the general youth and teachers and students with athletic potential, while Olympic education programmes mainly focus on school-aged children and youth.

Children and youth are the future of a nation. Through their participation in and experience of the Olympics, they learn to respect differences, embrace diversity, and respect nature, laying a solid foundation for their future participation in international actions with a broad mind and global perspective. Additionally, public participation is a criterion in the competition to host the Olympic Games. Clearly, while Olympic education continues to focus on elite athletes, it has broadened its scope to include the general public, particularly children and youth, leading to deeper integration and wider dissemination of Olympic education. The global spread of Olympic education provides a reservoir of strength for the sustainable development of the Olympic Movement. One of the goals of hosting the Youth Olympic Games is to attract young people to participate in sports, allowing them to enjoy the fun of sports while also developing their potential athletic abilities, thus nurturing talent for future Olympic Games.

PLACE AND ROLE OF OLYMPIC EDUCATION WITHIN THE FRENCH EDUCATIONAL SYSTEM

Ali RAMDANE (FRA)

Background and purpose of the thesis:

On September 13, 2017, in Lima (Peru), the International Olympic Committee (IOC) designated Paris and Los Angeles as, the host cities of the Olympic Games, 2024 and 2028 respectively. This historic double nomination offers media exposure for each country around the world. Disappointed by France's recent failures in 2008 and 2012, and despite a few dissenting voices, this news is warmly welcomed by the French population, the political world and sporting bodies.

Buoyed by this impetus, the Olympic movement used the Olympic Charter as a basis for actions aimed at young people, with the ambition of achieving harmony between the practice of sport and the transmission of values. Baron Pierre de Coubertin defined Olympism as “the religion of energy, the cult of intensive will developed through the practice of virile sports, supported by hygiene and civic-mindedness, and surrounded by art and thought¹”. Its aim is “to build a better, more peaceful world by educating young people through a practice in keeping with Olympism and its values²”. For the renovator of the Olympic Games, Olympism is an educational tool based on a dual practice: sporting and intellectual.

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1. Müller Norbert et Schantz Otto (1986), *Pierre de Coubertin. Textes choisis*, Tome III: *Pratique sportive*, Zurich, Weidmann.
 2. Charte olympique, point 1, Composition et organisation générale du mouvement olympique.

The concept of Olympic education was only coined in the 1970s, “to enable individuals to acquire a philosophy of life through which they can make a positive contribution to their family, their community, their country and the world³”.

In 1972, the first Olympic education programme for primary and secondary schools was launched in Germany in preparation for the Munich Olympic Games. From then on, the Olympic movement encouraged the organising committees to set up educational programmes for pupils. One of the objectives was to improve the quality of the school climate and bring about a lasting change in the behavior of individual students or groups of students. The concept of “school climate” is difficult to define. Indeed, its perception is subjective and its contours are vague. However, there is a consensus on the definition of school climate as “the judgment of parents, educators and students concerning their experience of life and work in the school, and not simply the result of individual perception⁴”.

The state of the question:

In the 1970s, the concept of Olympic education emerged, and governments seized on this momentum to energise school learning and instill in schools values combining intellectual emancipation and the harmonious practice of sport. Drawing on the humanist objectives of Olympism, the school systems of many countries, notably France, are proposing actions and programmes capable of mobilising energies in schools. Under the impetus of the French National Olympic and Sports Committee (CNOSF), the French Ministries of Sports and Youth, and the Ministry of National Education in particular, are working together to implement educational programmes aimed at “social, mental, cultural, ethical and physical development⁵”.

In France, the programme to support the organisation of the Olympic and Paralympic Games in Paris in 2024, “sport at the service of society”, is creating a “Generation 2024” label for schools and universities. In addition to developing

3. Georgiadis Konstantinos, «Définition de l'éducation olympique», CIO, 2007.

4. Cohen J., McCabe E. M., Michelli N. M., Pickeral T., 2009, “School Climate: Research, Policy, Teacher Education and Practice”, Teachers College Record, vol. 111, n 1, p. 180-213.

5. Georgiadis Konstantinos, «Définition de l'éducation olympique», CIO, 2007.

sporting activities among our students, who are sometimes sedentary, we are aiming for cultural openness and participation in local Olympic and Paralympic events. These actions aim to promote the very essence of the Olympic movement through three humanist values: **friendship, respect and excellence**.

The issue:

Convinced by the humanist values of the Olympic movement, I'm aware of the dynamics involved and remain sensitive to the effects it produces within a group. But how do you implement Olympic education in a school? Does the application of an Olympic education influence the school climate? Are its effects observable? How can they be qualified or quantified? What obstacles does it encounter in the school environment, and what levers can be used?

That's why I'm looking at the behavioural impact of Olympic education on the school climate. **How can Olympic education influence the school climate?**

After defining the concepts of "Olympic education" and "school climate", this research will make an innovative contribution to current thinking. Among the hypotheses envisaged, that of the implementation of regular and relevant actions can provide some answers to this problem. Drawing on school resource people, this research project will propose explicit criteria to validate a causality between "Olympic education" and a better "school climate".

The methodology:

The research will be based on a sample of secondary schools with advanced or nascent Olympic education, in order to extract information that could corroborate a link between Olympic education and school climate. This research project will focus on three areas. Firstly, it will be based on field surveys to gather, extract and analyse significant numerical data. Secondly, I will participate in seminars and symposia to validate the effects of Olympic education on a selected sample of pupils. Finally, an in-depth documentary and bibliographical study will enable me to understand and clarify the hypotheses linked to this research. My regular participation in specialised journals will enable me to expose the elements and concepts related to this study.

Research timetable:

This research project will last three years. During this dedicated period, I will report on the progress of my research to my thesis supervisor, Mr Éric Monnin, Vice-President of the Université de Franche-Comté. Finally, I would like to point out that my professional schedule allows me to spend time travelling to the Université Bourgogne Franche-Comté and to Lausanne (Switzerland), depending on the university calendar and national or international events that are organised.

Bibliography (not exhaustive):

On the “Olympic Movement”

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TRANSITIONING BEYOND GLORY: THE PSYCHOLOGICAL TOLL OF ELITE ATHLETES AND THEIR EVOLVING IDENTITIES

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Abstract

The last decades have been characterised by a growing interest in the field of sport. Whereas athletes are setting the highest records bringing their performances to the next level, the price they need to pay for fame and glory has constantly increased. According to a recent research in sport, career development is a multifaceted, unstable and transitional process, often consisting in emotional transitional episodes that can affect performance, influence motivation and have negative implications for athletes' mental health (Stambulova et al., 2009; Wylleman et al., 2004). For many Olympians the transition process might involve the end of a four year training cycle and the beginning of another, whereas for others, this period might mark the commencement of a transition out of sport. Given the documented psychological challenges of the post-Olympics period and while transitioning out of sport, the main goal of this research project was to analyse the factors affecting athletes' mental health and their coping strategies, particularly in relation to their athletic identity in the Olympic aftermath and during their transitions out of sport. By analysing empirical evidence, this research project was built upon a systematic review on existing studies to draw overall conclusions and identify relevant patterns on the selected topics that may be useful for National Olympic Committees and International Federations. Results indicated that the field of sport is still characterised by stigmatisation, lack of knowledge and fear, limiting athletes' ability to seek help. Besides, personal characteristics of athletes themselves affect the way they react to burnout and

distress. With increased knowledge and understanding of the factors affecting athletes' psychological well being and their ability to cope with difficult transitions during their sporting career, future support and guidance can be adapted and integrated in the resources package available to every sporting professional.

Methodology

As the general topics of the research project have been identified, a review of the relevant existing literature was conducted, using material resources available at the library of German Sport University of Cologne and the University of Cologne. As well as, articles and journals published on academic platforms such as ResearchGate, Google Scholar, APA PsycNet and Taylor and Francis. In this way, a screening of all the existing resources was possible, as well as the assessment of their relevance. Among the exclusion criteria used for this research project, the English language was the most important one: only English resources were included in the analysis. Besides, the researcher considered the field of elite sport as the main focus of the study. Since the analysis of this research focused on major mega events experiences, only studies mentioning high level performance athletes, olympians, elite athletes and professional athletes were included. Moreover, the definition of a specific date range helped dealing with an updated literature. All the literature dated before 1994 was excluded, in order to work with studies no older than 30 years. This being said, this research incorporated various theories predating 1994 to elucidate certain terms and provide a deeper understanding of the historical context underlying modern theories. Overall, both qualitative and quantitative data were collected to achieve the primary goal of this project. They were crucial for this explanatory research, as they provided the researcher with a strong basis regarding the main rationale of the study, contributing to explain why and how previously studied phenomena still take place in modern sport. The study was built upon holistic perspectives according to which a multiplicity of factors interacts in human lives and phenomena cannot be understood from just one or two perspectives, but rather by looking at them in their totality. Indeed, primary data were collected from a wide variety of sources, such as academic scholars and research papers, reports and books.

Mental health in elite sports: where are we now?

Across an Olympic cycle – before, during, and after the Games – athletes can undergo a range of psychological challenges that can impact their mental health (Diment et al., 2023). During the last years, there has been an increased academic interest in the mental health of elite athletes and recent reviews have concluded that they appear to experience a broadly comparable risk of high-prevalence mental disorders (e.g., anxiety and depression) relative to the general population (Golding et al., 2020; Rice et al., 2016). The weight of failure, particularly in the public eye, can lead to stress, depression, anxiety, and other severe forms of mental illness (Taylor, 2021). Key stressors can be split into three categories: competitive stress, organisational stress and personal stress. These three groups are not exclusive and can have knock-on effects or impacts on other categories. The fact that Olympians' mental health has never been a key concern for sport governing bodies (Park, 2021) and the way the media have covered high profile sporting events in the last decade has worsened the status of the issue and the way athletes deal with it. In the past, it was as if mental health problems were not existing or the single athlete was responsible to deal with them alone (Shamard, 2019). Although there are still many roadblocks to seeking help, such as poor mental health literacy and negative past experiences, stigma is considered the most important barrier among young elite athletes (Gulliver et al., 2012). Despite the recognised need for a larger number of psychological support tools within sporting contexts, both for performance enhancement and mental health concerns, athletes often refrain from utilising such services, due to the fear of being judged from others. Factors such as culture, type of sport and gender significantly influence athletes' attitudes towards seeking psychological consultation and counselling. By shining a light on personal experiences of athletes, recent games and media reports represented an important turning point to raise awareness on the importance of dealing with mental health, encouraging athletes to talk openly about their feelings and emotions and breaking down the stigma (Keal et al., 2022). Moreover, it is crucial to consider the broader sporting environment as well when studying the characteristics of these issues. For instance, athletes' sport, its regulations, coaches, teammates and family members as well as governing bodies need to be included in the analysis of the problem. Every mental health framework should therefore consider the wider ecological factors influencing the athlete, such as bad relationships with the

coaches, family or social media abuse and the influence of the media. At the same time, intervention programmes should focus on the development of a non-athletic identity, to train all athletes in managing the life-sport balance, the end of the sporting career and mental health screenings.

What is this thing called Post-Olympic Blues?

Researchers have reported that the post-Olympic transition period, irrespective of whether an athlete retires from sport or not, is a complex, distressing period that is characterised by negative emotions, behavioral responses and social and personal struggles (Howells & Lucassen, 2018). The term Post-Olympic Blues (POB) has its origins back to the 1970s and 1980s in the context of post-natal nomenclature, as researchers, such as Edwards (1973) began to distinguish between postpartum blues and postpartum depression. In the field of elite sport, this term refers to an emotional drop in athletes' mental health which usually happens days or weeks after the games and it consists of feelings of depression, loss of purpose, resentment, and negative self worth. After years of hard work to build up to the highest goal of making it to the Olympics, athletes have not enough time to process that their dream is happening and as soon as the sporting event is over, they have to cope with the feeling of not having that goal anymore, which may completely disorient them, as many sportpersons have sacrificed their entire lives, leaving friends and family behind just to focus on their sporting success. Besides, they may experience a loss of identity as they feel that their Olympian identity is gone. Despite the increasing attention on this topic in recent years, there still is little understanding of the true extent of the problem, regarding for instance the severity, pervasiveness and duration of the symptoms and therefore no clear distinction between the blues and depression. Further research is necessary to examine the cross-cultural and international variations in experiencing POB (Diment et al. 2023).

Career transition in elite sports

Transitions are defined as “a change in assumptions about oneself” (Schlossberg, 1981, p. 5) which normally arises from one or a combination of events (Lavallee, 2000; Taylor & Ogilvie, 1994) perceived by athletes in their personal or social

equilibrium (Wapner & Craig-Bay, 1992). In the early 2000s, the holistic concept of transitions (Wylleman et al., 2004) outlined a new way to explore and study career transitions in elite sport. Different spheres of life were considered as relevant within an athlete's sport career. From this moment on, career support programmes were included among the existing services to improve athletes' well-being and their performances (Brassard et al., 2023). Academic reviews suggest that athletic retirement encompasses a drastic shift in identity, a loss of social networks, a lack of career ambitions and potential risks to physical and mental health (Voorheis et al., 2023). This specific moment can be defined as "the consequence of the termination of paid work and a shift to a new job in a different field" (Beehr & Bennett, 2015). Thanks to the scoping review conducted by Voorheis et al. (2023), researchers were able to identify general determinants and outcomes of athletic retirement affecting athletes' ability in experiencing a smooth transition in life after sport. Among the most common obstacles can be found, a strong athletic identity, high standards and perfectionism, sporting career dissatisfaction, financial problems, unexpected or involuntary reasons for retirement or a lack of coping strategies and retirement planning. The cross-national study presented by Alfermann et al. (2004) compared German, Lithuanian and Russian sport professionals and highlighted similarities and differences between athletes' retirement and their adaptation to life after sport. Psychologists and researchers have observed athletes' struggle during their retirement, not only because of the loss of their athlete role, but also with the challenge of putting together a new identity in the real world (Miller & Kerr, 2002). Many problems in retirement are often associated with the loss of identity and a diminished self-esteem (Botterill, 1982), especially as these elements are excessively tied to sport. The research conducted by Lavalée & Robinson (2007) suggested that athletes with a more flexible identity may demonstrate greater resilience during career transitions. In addition, Schmid et al. (2024), affirmed that athletes who find themselves in a more advanced stage of their athletic careers and thus closer to retirement tend to have a lower athletic identity.

Critical reflection

Although the great attention that has been given to the topics of POB, career transitions and retirement out of competitive sport, when reviewing and

discussing the results of the existing studies, it is important to mention the limitations of this process. First, only sources published in English were included and thus may have excluded potential studies published in a different language. As a consequence, a limited geographical area of the samples was considered. Despite the increasing interest in this field, the available research is still narrow, focusing mostly on European countries such as Germany, Denmark and the United Kingdom. By now, only a few comparative studies have been published examining these phenomena among athletes representing Asian countries. It is well known that cultural differences may result in mixed or even dissimilar results in athletes perception on athletic transitions and psychological burnout. Moreover, different countries may choose to manage and implement different programmes to safeguard athletes' mental health and well-being and this could increase or decrease the stigma in the national sports system.

Secondly, as the areas of study are relatively new research fields, there is a limited updated primary literature available that has been useful for the purpose of this research project. Indeed, the study was heavily reliant on secondary sources published by experts, researchers and scholars but primary sources published on National Olympic Committees (NOC) or National Federations were difficult to find and access. Overall, the sources and especially their content must be examined carefully in terms of reliability and credibility to avoid biased research results and languages. In addition, the framework of this research project did not allow for deeper research and more comprehensive data collection that could have possibly led to a broader, more credible, and more reliable data base, due to time and resource limitations.

Lastly, mental health concerns can vary widely across different sports and disciplines, and policies that work well for some athletes may not be effective for others. Generally mental health policies are implemented at the national level, no matter the sport or the discipline. These limitations highlight the need for ongoing evaluation and improvement of mental health policies by both international organisations and national federations, as well as greater transparency and data collection to better assess the effectiveness of these policies. Similarly, career transition outcomes highly depend on personal characteristics, experiences and support. The researcher was able to overall highlight factors facilitating retirement planning and identify a multitude of creative suggestions for how to better support athletes transition into life after sport. Through this study, it was made clear that a wide range of support programmes are needed by professional

athletes and their entourage to prepare for transitions, as gradual, longstanding, investments into retirement planning, for instance, may be highly advantageous for improving athlete retirement transition outcomes.

Outlook

The Tokyo 2020 Olympic and Paralympic Games represented a pivotal event in breaking down the stigma surrounding mental health among professional athletes. By highlighting athletes' personal experiences, especially after the period of isolation due to Covid19, athletes' interviews and media reports represented a crucial turning point in raising awareness on the importance of addressing mental health, encouraging athletes and their team to seek help (Keal et al., 2022). As a result, the IOC and national Olympic bodies have perceived higher responsibility to directly address the issue of mental health by creating pertinent resources to help guide and improve the clinical management of athletes, such as the IOC Expert Consensus Statement. The further trends and development that will shape the future of mental health in sport should focus on the increase of awareness and education on this topic. As more people are involved and interested in looking deeper into the topic, more research may be conducted in different countries, widening the geographical area analysed and allowing NOCs to cooperate in achieving a decent level of mental well-being and a good planning strategy for transitions in sport. This may have a spill over effect on the availability of the services provided by the NOC and the IFs, supported by partnerships between sports organisations and mental health providers.

Another important element to take into consideration is the proactive approach that is likely to dominate the future of mental health while transitioning out of sport; traditionally, both mental health in sport and athletes' transitioning strategies have been reactive, with people seeking help only after traumatic events. However, in the future, there may be more proactive approaches, such as a larger number of preventative programmes aimed at building resilience and coping skills, and early intervention strategies to address mental health issues before they become more serious. Besides, beyond measuring the strength of athletic identity, future researchers could focus on the underlying processes of identity development among athletes, so as to not only advance key practical implications to professionals working with athletes, but also to

propose further theoretical development given the unique aspects of athletic identity. This research project has shown that there is still a lot of potential for improving the support of the NOCs and ideally the IOC will take a leading role within this process as an entity which acts as a critic, consultant, supporter and motivator for all the committees around the world. However, there are many other stakeholders involved within the professional sports system who can also contribute to the successful implementation of mental health policies and transitioning strategies planning. Examples for such stakeholders would be the national and international sponsors, IFs and media organisations, fans and volunteers.

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RESEARCH ON THE ETHICAL JUSTIFICATION OF ANTI-DOPING IN COMPETITIVE SPORTS EVENTS

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Abstract

The International Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) is led by IOC and advocated by Western powers and international sports organisations. IOC establishes its authority through the support and control of WADA. Wada has been the mainstay of anti-doping since its establishment. The independence of its institutions and the scientific nature of its testing make it highly trusted by all sectors of society. By combing literature and materials, this paper probes into the reasonability and legitimacy of anti-doping in contemporary competitive sports with IOC as the core, and points out the practical problems existing in the current international anti-doping regulations and regulations.

1. Current status:

In order to maintain the fairness and justice of sports and the healthy and sustainable development of competitive sports, the International Olympic Committee has always taken a clear stand against doping, and has formulated extremely strict doping control measures for the Olympic Games. But the abuse of illegal drugs in world sports has been repeatedly banned, and the Olympic spirit has been tainted by doping. The use of doping not only damages the physical and mental health of athletes, but also violates the fairness principle of sports ethically. Therefore, doping is not only a problem in the field of sports, but also involves medicine, ethics and other fields, becoming a complex social

problem involving many factors. The problem of athletes using doping for the purpose of strengthening and improving sports performance follows closely, and has become a “stubborn disease” accompanied by the commercialisation and professionalisation of modern sports. In order to establish a fair competition environment, international sports organisations and government departments around the world have joined forces to launch a long-term and resolute “anti-doping war”.

Since the beginning of the 21st century, WADA has successively issued the World Anti-Doping Code and the Anti-Doping Code on the basis of the International Olympic Charter against Doping in Sport, the Lausanne Declaration and the Olympic Anti-Doping Code. The World Anti-Doping Code, introduced in 2003, is known as the code for the eradication of doping abuse in various countries and regions and international sports organisations around the world. The regulations establish a list of banned substances and means, a set of criteria for sanctions, and refer any sanctions-related disputes to the Court of Arbitration for Sport.

In 1999, the world Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) was established in Lausanne, Switzerland, a milestone in the history of human sport. By implementing a “zero tolerance” anti-doping policy, it has continuously strengthened the supervision and punishment of illicit drug use. However, WADA’s 2016 Anti-Doping Test Data, released in October 2017, shows that doping detection rates among athletes are still on the rise. The doping scandal has also intensified, spreading from the field of professional sports to the field of amateur sports, from the use of doping by individual athletes to the development of collective and organised doping. In particular, in December 2007, the Russian Olympic Committee was disqualified from participating in the 2018 Winter Olympics by the International Olympic Committee for “systematic manipulation of anti-doping work”. The punishment caused a strong response from the international community.

2. IOC anti-doping justification:

2.1 From the point of view of upholding sports ethics:

The IOC’s zero-tolerance stance on doping is rooted in the respect and maintenance of sports ethics. Sports is not only a kind of competitive activity, but also an expression of culture and morality. Respect, fairness and honesty

are fundamental principles in sport, and doping is a serious violation of these principles. Athletes should rely on their own hard work and talent to achieve results, rather than relying on external drugs or chemicals. Doping is not only against ethical principles, but also against the Olympic spirit. It is not only disrespectful to other athletes, but also disrespectful to oneself; It is not only a manifestation of cowardice, but also a moral defect, which is unacceptable to the Olympic spirit and despised by all sports lovers. When athletes use doping to win gold MEDALS, human dignity and mutual respect are lost in the sacred arena and on the road of life.

2.2 From the perspective of protecting athletes' health:

While enhancing sports performance, doping brings more serious damage to the life and health of athletes. In 1960 Rome Olympic Games, Danish athlete Noord Janssen suddenly fell to the ground when participating in a 100-kilometer cycling time trial, when people went to help him, he was found dead, after an autopsy found that Janssen's death was due to taking an overdose of amphetamine and alcohol mixed agent caused sudden death. As the first case of sudden death due to doping in the Olympic history, "Jensen incident" made mankind realize the seriousness and harm of doping.

2.3 From the perspective of maintaining fair competition:

The Olympic Movement takes competitive sports as its main activity content, and its most essential feature is competition and confrontation. In the direct and intense physical confrontation and competition, the athletes' body, psychology and morality have been well exercised and cultivated, and the spectators have also been mentally entertained and imperceptible educated. But all this only makes sense if it is competed on a fair and just basis. The use of doping in competitive sports, with the purpose of cheating to improve the performance of the competition or to obtain MEDALS, is in essence an act that undermines fairness and justice, violates the principle of fair competition, and is itself a blasphemy against the Olympic spirit; Relying on this disgraceful means once the purpose is achieved, it leads to a serious tilt of the balance of rights and interests, directly damages the fair competition rights and interests of other players, and seriously violates the fairness and justice of competitive sports.

2.4 From the perspective of power competition:

At the 3rd Summer Olympics in 1904, American marathon runner Thomas Hicks publicly admitted to injecting a central nervous stimulant called Strychnine. Beginning in the 1950s, government officials, medical and sports figures in various European countries began to fight drug abuse. 1967 British cyclist Tommy Simpson died during the Tour de France from heart failure caused by a high dose of amphetamine. The incident prompted the IOC to set up the Medical Commission to deal with doping in sport, and in 1968 official drug testing was introduced. Until the 1998 Tour de France scandal Belgian team doctor Vi-Forte of the Festina team was arrested at the border into France from Belgium for carrying erythropoietin (EPO), sedatives, growth hormone, testosterone and amphetamines, after which a French court investigated the team's nine riders for cheating on banned drugs. Many western powers intervene in anti-doping matters in sports events with the public power of the government, so that the sports community and its sports associations and other organisations feel that the original independent law enforcement power is threatened, and the right to self-adjudication is challenged. Matters that used to belong to the sports world became the subject of regulation and control by various countries in the form of laws and other forms, and incidents that were handled independently by sports organisations were resolved by national judicial procedures. The IOC realised that its authority was threatened, and decided to convene the World Conference on Doping in Sport again in Lausanne. The agenda of the conference was also determined by the IOC, and participants were screened and limited to have their right to speak. The establishment and regulation of the new organisational Committee are premised on ensuring the status of the IOC. Although the WADA body ultimately exists as an independent body, its power base still comes from the IOC. In order to maintain the image and majesty of the IOC, maintain the purity and advanced nature of the Olympic Movement, and do not damage the credibility and reputation of the Olympic Movement, the IOC's zero tolerance policy on doping can also be regarded as a measure to safeguard the interests and image of the sports industry.

2.5 From the perspective of the future and development of sports culture:

The use of performance-enhancing drugs can have a negative impact on the long-term development of sport. If the abuse of doping becomes a widespread

phenomenon, it may undermine people's confidence and enthusiasm for sports, leading to the decline and decline of sports. This will not only affect the development and future of individual athletes, but also damage the status and influence of sports as a cultural and social activity. Therefore, the IOC's zero-tolerance policy on doping can also be seen as a strategic consideration to safeguard the long-term development of sports.

3. Existing ethical issues in anti-doping policy:

Conflict between strict liability and anti-doping purposes:

The World Anti-Doping Code, 2003, 2009 and 2015, basically adopted a "strict liability" stance for doping violations. The code states: "Doping conduct, also known as a doping violation, refers to the use of substances or methods expressly prohibited by the World Anti-Doping Agency. Since the connotation and extension of this definition are basically clear, it has legal effect. However, under that definition, it is clear that a doping violation does not contain any subjective element. The commentary to Article 2 (1) (1) of the Regulations also openly states that the principle of liability for doping violations adopts a position of strict liability, and whether there is intentional or negligent behavior of the athlete does not affect the composition of the violation. Accidental presence of a banned substance in the body constitutes a doping violation, even if the athlete does not intend to gain a competitive advantage through the drug.

In this regard, some scholars have raised objections, they believe that since athletes have no fault for the banned substances entering their bodies, according to modern legal theory, they should not be punished, otherwise, it is "objective attribution", which is unfair. The main reasons are as follows: First, according to Article 2, the definition of doping relies heavily on the list of prohibited substances or methods established by the World Anti-Doping Agency. With the development of medicine, the content of the list will increase year by year, which leads to the definition of "doping" is constantly in motion, resulting in a certain ambiguity in the extension of doping violations, which will inevitably reduce the predictability of the application of the Regulations; Second, the list of prohibited substances developed by the World Anti-Doping Agency is highly variable, and each addition of a prohibited substance means an additional trap for athletes. Because for these prohibited substances, even experts, if they do not

rely on equipment, it is difficult to identify. Third, in many cases, these prohibited substances are in the form of non-prohibited substances (for example, in the form of food, drink or health supplements) in daily life, which makes it more difficult for athletes to identify prohibited substances. This means that athletes are obliged to identify banned substances, which is obviously difficult to impose.

Shezieja Hardy, the American record holder in the women's world 100-meter breaststroke, was accused of testing positive for a urine test. Hardy pointed out that the banned substance accidentally entered the body through the health supplements he regularly used, providing evidence that: for one thing, the label of the product did not say anything like "steroids". Second, before using the product, she had spoken to the manufacturer of the product on the phone to confirm whether it contained prohibited substances. The manufacturer told her that after independent inspections, the product was made from "high-quality raw materials" and did not contain any additives. Third, he consulted with team doctors, U.S. Olympic Committee sports psychologists and coaches who had previously used the supplement. These people answered the same as the manufacturer that the product was safe. Fourth, she bought the product directly from the manufacturer. The athlete failed despite putting so much effort into making sure he stayed away from banned substances. Based on this, the American Arbitration Association panel found that the drug in Hardy's system was accidentally ingested, neither intentionally nor negligently. As a result, Hardy's punishment was reduced from two years to one. World reaction.

The doping agency considered the punishment too light and appealed the ruling to the Court of Arbitration for Sport. Wada believes that this punishment violates the provisions of the Code for the following reasons: First, the two-year suspension is a "normal" punishment for doping violations and can only be reduced in extremely exceptional circumstances. The fact that an individual athlete went to the manufacturer of the supplement, a coach or even an official of the United States National Olympic Committee to confirm the safety or purity of the product is not sufficient to constitute an exception to this clause, that Hardy did not exercise the necessary duty of care to the supplement he used. Second, as an experienced top athlete, you should know the dangers of health care products, and you should be particularly vigilant. It not only does not doubt health care products, but blindly believes the propaganda of the manufacturer, mistakenly thinking that this health care products can promote muscle development, so it is at fault. Third, Hardy should have conducted

“further investigation” of the product before contacting the manufacturer. However, it is not clear what this “further investigation” means. The Court of Arbitration for Sport ruled that it was too much to ask a 21-year old to travel between the swimming pool, the training ground and the Olympic laboratory in his spare time, so it rejected WADA’s appeal and upheld the one-year ban. It can be seen that in the eyes of WADA, there is no difference between strict liability and fault liability, that is, the no-fault provisions in the Regulations are difficult to affect the punishment.

4. Conclusion

In fact, the Ordinance itself has already recognised the problem of unfairness caused by the application of strict liability. Therefore, in order to deter athletes from using performance-enhancing drugs, and to protect the rights of innocent athletes who accidentally use banned substances, WADA should introduce a lenient punishment regime so that athletes who accidentally ingested illegal substances can continue to shine on the field. Although there is a growing perception that the performance of today’s Games is more dependent on drugs than technology, this should not be an excuse for world sports law to distort fundamental principles of fairness. Because strict liability treats the innocent as well as the guilty, WADA should take responsibility, not stand aside and adopt the simple thinking of “heavy rules in a bad world”, ignoring the current legal philosophy and allowing accidental doping users to be punished so severely along with the real cheats.

INTEGRITY OF SPORTS IN BRAZIL: AN ANALYSIS OF NATIONAL SPORTS GOVERNING BODIES AND THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT'S ANTI-DOPING PROCEDURES

Emily KOHLER (BRA)

Introduction

This study was motivated by two significant sports incidents: the orchestrated doping scheme in Russia, and the failures in doping control at the Rio 2016 Olympic and Paralympic Games. These events raised serious questions about the ability of sports governing bodies and government institutions to ensure a doping-free environment.

In December 2014, amid the International Olympic Committee's (IOC) release of the Olympic Agenda 2020, which declared the protection of clean athletes as the heart of the IOC's philosophy (IOC, 2019), allegations surfaced regarding a sophisticated doping system involving the Russian Athletics Federation (ARAF), the Russian Anti-Doping Agency (RUSADA), and the Russian government (Oltermann, 2014; ARD, 2014). The accusations, detailed in a documentary aired by the German state channel ARD¹, promptly cast doubt on the effectiveness of anti-doping measures worldwide.

In response, the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA)² established an Independent Commission (IC) to investigate the allegations. The IC's reports

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1. ARD is the abbreviation of Arbeitsgemeinschaft der öffentlich-rechtlichen Rundfunkanstalten der Bundesrepublik Deutschland (Association of Public Broadcasters of the Federal Republic of Germany).
 2. The World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) is an independent organisation created from a collective initiative led by the IOC.

confirmed the corruptibility of the processes within a doping scheme organised by the Russian Athletics Team during the Winter Olympic Games in Sochi (McLaren, 2016). Moreover, the involvement of ARAF and RUSADA, alongside with coaches, physicians, and laboratory stakeholders, highlighted a lack of integrity in sports governing bodies and government institutions responsible for anti-doping efforts.

However, criticisms were also directed at WADA and the IOC regarding their handling of the investigations, with concerns raised about procedural integrity and conflicts of interest (Girginov & Parry, 2018; Halchin & Rollins, 2016). Both the IOC Athletes' Commission and the WADA Athletes' Committee expressed dissatisfaction with the decision not to impose a total ban on the participation of Russian athletes in the Rio 2016 Olympic and Paralympic Games (WADA, 2016a). Consequently, athletes began questioning the capacity of organisations responsible for doping control in Brazil to protect clean athletes during these Games (Halchin & Rollins, 2016).

At the same time, Brazil faced a series of political and organisational conflicts leading up to the Rio 2016 Olympic and Paralympic Games. Allegations of prioritising medal wins over fair competition within the Brazilian Olympic Committee (BOC) and pressure on the Brazilian National Anti-Doping Organization – Brazilian Control Doping Agency (ABCD) – underscored concerns about the integrity of sports in Brazil (Valesi, 2016).

During the Games, WADA identified significant deficiencies in the anti-doping operations, including tensions between the Organising Committee of the Olympic Games (OCOG) and the ABCD and a lack of coordination within the management team (WADA, 2016b). These controversies involving governmental institutions and national sports governing bodies highlighted the urgent need for a comprehensive reassessment of anti-doping practices.

Given these developments, it is imperative to examine how national sports governing bodies and government institutions responsible for anti-doping in Brazil have acted to ensure the integrity of sports. This study aims to analyse whether the anti-doping procedures adopted by national sports governing bodies and government institutions uphold the integrity of sports in Brazil. Specifically, it seeks to assess, from the perspective of representatives of these organisations, whether the guidelines and anti-doping education efforts implemented in Brazil effectively ensure sports integrity.

Theoretical Underpinning

Integrity is a multifaceted pillar of good governance, essential for maintaining the ethical principles of sport. As defined by Furrow (2005), integrity can be understood as “the extent that the various commitments form a harmonious and intact totality”, emphasising the alignment between commitments and actions (p. 205). This harmony reflects a consistent adherence to principles and values across personal, organisational, and procedural contexts, which is vital within the sports industry.

Calhoun (1995) expands on this by highlighting three core responsibilities associated with integrity. First is the responsibility to uphold core values and purposes fundamental to personal or organisational identity. Second is ensuring accountability through ongoing critical dialogue. Third is fostering shared responsibility to uphold fundamental values amidst diverse perspectives. These responsibilities require continuous dialogue and negotiation among community members to reinforce ethical standards.

From this perspective, four interrelated interpretations of integrity have been established to understand its role in sports: integrity of the sport itself, organisational integrity, procedural integrity, and personal integrity. These interpretations focus on physical and moral excellence, the reliability of sporting events, and the promotion of a positive attitude, adhering to principles such as fair play (Gardner et al., 2017; Bauman, 2013; Erhard & Jensen, 2014).

According to Ghillyer (2021), organisational integrity aligns with ethical behavior within sporting organisations. This involves attracting and retaining stakeholders committed to ethical conduct and sporting principles, which are fundamental to sustainable development and operational effectiveness.

McNamee (2008) argues that a sporting organisation’s core commitment should be to develop its disciplines and maintain the highest standards of sporting excellence. This stance prioritises ethical behavior over financial gain or power. According to McNamee, a sport that emphasises honesty, fairness, and inclusivity enjoys a higher level of trust within the community and has a substantial impact on its business operations.

Therefore, a sports manager’s primary concern must be the ability to implement sound management practices and ensure the applicability of ethical principles. These efforts are often challenged by market dynamics, a lack of organisational commitment, divergent opinions on problem management, and insufficient

information for policy formulation and implementation (Overbye, 2016; Engelberg & Skinner, 2016; Copeland & Potwarka, 2016; Phat et al., 2016).

In conclusion, integrity in sports management encompasses ethical behavior across personal, organisational, and procedural dimensions. Upholding integrity is crucial for maintaining the credibility of sports institutions, fostering trust among stakeholders, and ensuring sustainable development.

Methods

Research Design

This study employed a qualitative research design. Semi-structured interviews were used to gather insights, which were then analysed through content analysis (Bauer & Gaskell, 2011; Flick, 2009; Stake, 2010).

Recruitment

After receiving approval from the Research Ethics Board at the author's institution, participants were recruited via email. Emails were sent to all national sports governing bodies and government institutions with anti-doping responsibilities in Brazil. Individuals holding titles such as coordinator, manager, director, or anyone authorised to represent their organisation on the topic were invited to participate.

The research targeted two main groups:

1. Representatives of National Sports Governing Bodies (RNSGB):
 - *Group I – National Committee Members (NCM)*: Two participants (one president, one manager).
 - *Group II – National Federation Members (NFM)*: Eight participants, including doping control coordinators, superintendents, sports physiotherapists, and technical managers.
2. Representatives of Governmental Institutions (RGI):
 - Seven participants, including six civil servants (CS) and one service provider (SP), holding positions such as deputy president, coordinator, president, and technical director.

Data Collection

Data collection was conducted through semi-structured interviews, comprising 14

questions based on theoretical underpinnings and literature reviews. Following the guidelines by Flick (2009) and Gray (2021), the interview process included steps such as acquiring prior knowledge about the participants, scheduling interviews, ensuring confidentiality, and creating a comfortable interview environment.

Interviews were conducted online using Google Meet, and the researcher employed several measures to safeguard participants' confidentiality and privacy in the virtual setting, including password-protected calls and utilising waiting room features. Interviews were audio-recorded with participants' consent and subsequently transcribed for analysis. The number of interviews was determined by data saturation, ceasing when no new information emerged from additional interviews (Fontanella et al., 2008).

Data Analysis

The data analysis followed the recommendations of Bauer and Gaskell (2011) and Stake (2010). Data was organised into categories and coded to facilitate understanding and interpretation.

The analysis involved creating and refining categories, with quotes from interviewees systematically organised. This method allowed for data structuring, the unification of responses, and the emergence of a coherent data set.

This approach helped generate insights and construct relationships within the data. An organisational plan was developed to guide the final report, ensuring a coherent synthesis and control over data fragments.

Results

The results indicated that the ABCD, the Brazilian NADO responsible for coordinating anti-doping efforts in Brazil and representing the country before WADA (Brazil, 2016), has its authority recognised by national sports governance bodies. Most Olympic and Paralympic organisations are already aware of the role of the ABCD and understand its purpose and functions (RGI-CS1).

However, this has not always been the case. Before the establishment of ABCD, doping control was managed independently by national sports federations, acting in accordance with the requirements established by their International Sports Federations (IFs), available resources, and management

format (ABCD, 2020a). The creation of ABCD did not occur until 2011 (Brazil, 2011), due to the IOC's requirements for Brazil to host the Olympic and Paralympic Games in Rio de Janeiro. As one interviewee noted:

"The transition was kind of forced, not a transition you had time to understand, but it had to be done because there would be the Olympic and Paralympic Games" (RNSGB-NCT2).

Initially, ABCD focused on establishing legal aspects to comply with the responsibilities assumed internationally before WADA and the UNESCO Convention³. As with ABCD, the Brazilian NOC also implemented its own anti-doping policy (COB, 2019). Over the years, national sports governing bodies have advanced their own anti-doping regulations (COB, 2019; CBRU, 2020; FIFA, 2019; CBDA, 2018; CBJ, 2016).

The second step for ABCD and the Brazilian NOC was to bring the entities belonging to the national sports system closer to the Brazilian anti-doping ecosystem. An interviewee reflected:

"So, this is what happened initially: the ABCD was created, and it seems that a hole was opened, everyone pulled away, and then we started building the educational aspect, this aspect that values ethics, clean sports, this positive discourse much more than the punitive discourse, and using education as a mobilization tool" (RGI-CS1).

As a result, three different scenarios were identified in the current national sports governing bodies. A few national sports governing bodies have dedicated resources and specific sectors for anti-doping, recognizing its importance to the sport. However, there are varying levels of engagement. One interviewee described it as:

"At the same time, there are groups that say: 'Ah, I'll go if I can. If I can, I'll do it... if it's really necessary'. And then there are those who don't even want to know: 'No, this is just another cost. The

3. In 2005, during the 33rd General Assembly of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO), the International Convention Against Doping in Sport was established.

kid who comes here wants to train, not to listen to stories'. So, we still do not have unity in Brazil" (RNSGB-NCT2).

The misconceptions about anti-doping among managers reflect a broader issue: the community's lack of commitment and responsibility within its own context. As expressed by one participant:

"It is a lack of responsibility of the entities and athletes to realize the universe into which they are inserted because the moment you enter the sports world of high-performance competition, the anti-doping rules are the same as the competition rules" (RNSGB-NSCM4).

Some athletes, coaches, and entities still neglect or are unaware of these rules. As one respondent mentioned:

"The fact that the website is extremely clear does not mean that everyone is extremely aligned" (RNSGB-NSCM4).

Moreover, there is a certain resistance to the subject itself. The concept of anti-doping is commonly associated with the word "doping", which is related to corruption, immorality, and illegality. This association was highlighted by an interviewee:

"There is a cultural stigma where people kind of repel this theme because when it is not associated with breaking the rules, it is very much associated with muscles, getting strong, and improving performance, which is something associated with crime... So, nobody really likes to talk about it. I think this problem is very present. So, people think, 'Ah, this is a bad thing. Let's not talk about that. Let's talk about the good side of sports and what it brings to people's lives'. I think it is still difficult for people to deal with the subject because it is not a pleasant subject" (RNSGB-NCT2).

Consequently, the theme loses space within the entities, reducing the capacity for information outreach aimed at consolidating an anti-doping culture in Brazil. The importance of the first International Standard for Education (ISE) instituted by WADA becomes evident (WADA, 2021). The new document aims to "promote behaviours aligned with the values of clean sport and help prevent

athletes and other individuals from engaging in doping” (WADA, 2012, p. 4). The ISE is expected to mobilise and strengthen Brazilian entities and institutions responsible for this topic to enable such changes. An interviewee emphasised the need for good professionals:

“So, for this, we need good professionals engaged in constructing new knowledge. We need to be open to listening and discussing to better understand doping in its essence. And I think we need to start from our own discourse, how we talk about anti-doping, how we address the information we want to deliver, and the knowledge we want to transmit” (RGI-CS1).

When asked about the ideal professional profile for working in anti-doping education, physical education professionals were recommended:

“Our working tool is sport, so I think knowing how to use this tool on behalf of the citizen is what makes the difference when training a professional in the anti-doping field” (RGI-CS1).

Ultimately, regardless of the area of expertise, the interviewees emphasised that ethical aspects are paramount in the anti-doping field. According to one respondent:

“[Professionals] must be people open to new knowledge, open to debate, must be a person who knows by heart a motto that is: there is nothing I can do alone, that together I cannot do much better. So, we need to unify and have a single direction. [...] It must be a person who has ethics, who is reputable, who has principles, and who sees sport as a tool for awareness and citizen education. [...] ground zero of it all is the will to bring ethics and fair play to sports” (RGI-CS1).

Limitations, such as the lack of a unified language and a monitoring system, were highlighted regarding the anti-doping education actions currently carried out. One interviewee noted:

“We don’t have a language unification, so we have several scholars in Brazil, each acting in his/her own way. But sometimes, we crash into each other, and it seems that each one is talking about a different thing” (RNSGB-NCT1).

Another participant expressed concerns about measuring the effectiveness of educational efforts:

“People do not want to know the result of their actions; they want to say they have acted. I gave 853 lectures last year to athletes from all over Brazil, so what? How do you control the result of that? How are you watching this? Were the athletes engaged in these lectures? The language you used; did this establish communication? So, these questions, even those who are educating in Brazil, do not have the courage to ask themselves” (RNSGB-NCT1).

In Brazil, the ABCD leads most anti-doping education initiatives, offering both in-person and online programmes. These include stands at sports events, educational pamphlets, and videos on their website (ABCD, 2020b), as well as collaborations with universities and municipal sports departments to promote anti-doping awareness in various contexts and among diverse audiences. Part of ABCD’s efforts has been translating courses from the WADA Anti-Doping Education and Learning Platform (ADeL) into Portuguese. These courses provide information on clean sport and anti-doping for “athletes, coaches, doctors, administrators, and anyone interested in learning more about anti-doping and how to protect the values of clean sport” (WADA, 2020). However, the platform’s format and language present challenges to the success of educational activities in Brazil. One respondent criticised the teaching method:

“The teaching method is horrible. The content is universal, right? So, the content is from WADA; it is the content from the Code, the international standards. Now, the manner of communicating is sad; it is very sad because it is too awful” (RNSGB-NCT1).

To meet these demands, the Brazilian NOC’s Department of Education and Doping Prevention (DEPD) has been developing its own education platform. The focus is on developing virtual reality games to enhance communication, education, and training in anti-doping behaviour among athletes, sports professionals, and Brazilian society. It is important to recognise that:

“It is 20 years of WADA, two decades that the world system was created, and only now do we have an International Standard of Education to be launched in 2021; that is, everyone is starting” (RNSGB-NCT1).

Conclusion

Brazil's national sports governing bodies and government institutions demonstrate compliance with the World Anti-Doping Code by aligning their organisations and operations with international guidelines. However, the concept of organisational integrity in sports extends beyond mere compliance, encompassing a certain level of morality and fundamental ethical principles. These principles dictate that professionals working in sports are expected to exhibit suitable conduct, reflected in both their behavior and actions.

Despite this alignment with global standards, a significant concern arises from the many entities that, as highlighted by the interviewees, show little interest in or disregard for their responsibilities in this area. The lack of commitment from these organisations underscores a broader issue of ethical integrity within Brazil's sports governance.

Furthermore, when it comes to educational actions and cultural aspects, the effectiveness of WADA's courses in Brazil has been questioned. The topic of anti-doping remains stigmatised within the country, with many associating it with negative connotations such as corruption and illegality. This stigma poses a substantial challenge to fostering a positive anti-doping culture. Additionally, the absence of a unified language and a consistent appraisal process present significant barriers to establishing a robust anti-doping culture in Brazil.

To overcome these challenges, it is imperative for Brazil to invest in tailored educational initiatives that resonate with its cultural context. Developing localised training programmes and fostering open dialogue around the positive values of clean sport can aid in dismantling the stigma associated with anti-doping. Moreover, establishing a unified language and clear appraisal mechanisms will enhance the effectiveness of educational efforts, promoting a more cohesive and impactful anti-doping culture across the nation.

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FROM MEMORY TO IDENTITY: THE VISUAL COMMUNICATION CHANGE OF CHINESE OLYMPIC FILMS

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Abstract

As an important media to show the national sports achievements and cultural spirit, the spread process of Chinese Olympic films has witnessed the social changes and cultural evolution. This study combs the communication changes of Chinese Olympic films from memory construction to identity, and reveals its key role in shaping collective memory, strengthening national identity and promoting cultural communication. The article takes eight Chinese Olympic films during the two Olympic Games in 2008 and 2022 as a typical case. Through the analysis of the Olympic film collective memory elements and identity of local narrative, research found that the Chinese Olympic film not only recorded the glorious moment in the history of Chinese sports, but through artistic technique deepened the collective memory of the national honor and the national spirit, so as, to promote the construction of identity and consolidation. Moreover, the Olympic films during the 2008 Summer Olympics featured “collective memory”, while the 2022 Winter Olympics show a shift to “identity”. This study further points out that the future communication of Chinese Olympic films should continue to deepen the construction of collective memory and identity, and strengthen cross-cultural communication and international cooperation, so as to adapt to the diversification and individuation of audience needs in the context of globalisation.

Keywords: Collective memory, Identity; Olympic film; Visual communication

1. Introduction

1.1 Research background and research significance

As an important part of sports culture, the Olympic culture not only carries the spirit of sports, but also reflects the soft power and international image of a country. In this context, the image transmission of Chinese Olympic culture has gradually attracted wide attention, and the process of its transmission change also presents unique development characteristics.

The development of Olympic films in China can be said to be closely linked to the changes of Chinese society. Beijing hosted the 29th Summer Olympic Games and the 24th Winter Olympic Games in 2008 and 2022. During this period, China has also produced a series of Olympic films, which not only recorded the wonderful moments of the athletes, but also witnessed the takeoff of the Chinese sports industry. Through these films, the audience can more intuitively understand the spirit and culture of the Olympics, thus forming the unique memory, feelings and even cultural identity of the Olympics in their hearts. In the past ten years since the two Olympic Games, with the progress of science and technology and the rise of new media, the communication mode and audience group of Chinese Olympic films are also changing. Therefore, in the new era background, this paper aims to analyse the changing process of Chinese Olympic film communication, and reveal the social and cultural motivation behind it. From a long-term development perspective, this research not only has far-reaching theoretical significance, but also has urgent practical needs.

1.2 Development Overview of Chinese Olympic Films

Since the last century, the development process of Chinese sports film has been magnificent. It is important to note that the Olympic film does not only refer to a single meaning of “sports” film, according to the modern interpretation of Pierre de Coubertin. The Olympic spirit is not a pure competitive spirit, it does not only bring athletes psychological pleasure, but brings to people aesthetic feeling and sense of honor. Since the beginning of the modern Olympic Games, the Olympic spirit has been closely integrated with social life, and even became a way of life respected by the world. The beginning of the Chinese Olympic film originated in 2008’s “*The One Man Olympics*”, which tells the story of Liu Changchun, the first contestant to represent China in the 1932 Los Angeles Olympics, and reflects the struggle

and challenge of Chinese athletes in the international arena. Later, with the 2008 Summer Olympics and the 2022 Winter Olympic Games held in Beijing, Chinese Olympic films are increasingly appearing on the screen. In China, most scholars examine the Olympic film from the perspective of culture: the Chinese Olympic film is a kind of multicultural mix (Guo Lili, 2022)^[1], due to the “Olympic movement has the world, authoritative cultural characteristics, so people often use the Olympic film to show the national history, culture, sports and other characteristics”(Han Fang, 2012)^[2]. For example, in the 2022 Winter Olympic film “*Me and My Winter Games*”, the hutongs of old Beijing, traditional Chinese folk performances and modern landmarks such as the Beijing subway and the CCTV Building complement each other, presenting the ancient and modern Chinese culture to the public. From the early documentary recording to the post-modern multi-perspective construction^[3], the development process of Chinese Olympic theme films reflects the development trend of the mutual integration of sports and film art.

2. Start with memory: the narrative and emotional expression of collective memory in Chinese Olympic films

Collective memory, as a memory of past events, people or culture shared by a social group, is the cornerstone of social identity and cultural inheritance. It not only carries the history and culture of the group, but also plays an important role in maintaining social cohesion and stability. The Olympic film, as a special cultural product, records and spreads the history and culture of the Olympic Movement through its unique audio-visual language and narrative techniques, thus becoming a key medium for shaping and inheriting the collective memory. In his book, *On Collective Memory*, French sociologist Maurice Halbwachs proposed that collective memory is a process of social construction, which is influenced by the common influence of social framework, historical background and group experience^[4]. The Olympic films, as a video carrier to record and spread the Olympic spirit and culture, carry rich elements of collective memory. These elements span time and space, engraved the national honor, national spirit and the struggle of athletes in the collective memory of the audience. In 2008, China hosted the Olympic Games for the first time, which is a memorable and important year for China's sports industry. During this period, Olympic films such as “*Dream 2008*” (2008), “*The One Man Olympics*” (2008), “*Heart of Ice*” (2008) and “*Xu Haifeng's Gun*” (2012)

were born. In general, the Olympic films of this period mainly highlight the spirit of the Chinese people in the Olympic Games, reflecting the Chinese people for the eager hosting of the first Olympic Games. Collective memory became the dominant color of the Olympic films of this period. Specifically, the narrative and emotional expression of the collective memory in Chinese Olympic films are mainly manifested in three aspects: national honor, national spirit and personal course.

National honor is the main theme in the collective memory of Chinese Olympic films, and the typical Olympic events are often taken as the main line of the film. *"Dream 2008"* takes the seven-year construction process of the national main stadium as the clue, showing the great efforts and contributions made by the Chinese people for the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games, and integrating the sense of national honor into every construction detail.

Sports is often regarded as the embodiment of a country's comprehensive strength and national cohesion. The Olympic spirit plays an important role in enhancing national cohesion and inspiring the national spirit, so the national spirit often becomes one of the collective memory elements in Chinese Olympic films. The story of the film *"The One Man Olympics"* took place in 1932, when China was facing a difficult situation of internal troubles and foreign invasion. Liu Changchun's participation marked the official participation of Chinese athletes in the international Olympic Movement, opening the chapter of the history of China's participation in the Olympic Games.

In-depth personal story is a film narrative strategy, which is conducive to narrowing the psychological distance with the audience. For example, the film *"Xu Haifeng's Gun"* focuses on China's first Olympic gold medalist Xu Haifeng. The film narration closely follows Xu Haifeng's real experience, including his growth background, training process, challenges in the competition and the final victory, showing a real and full athlete image. Through the film, the audience also deepened the memory of the Olympic champion who broke the "zero" gold medal record in Chinese Olympic history at the 23rd Los Angeles Olympic Games. For another example, the movie *"Heart of Ice"* showcases the personal journey of Chinese grassroots short track speed skating coach Meng Qingyu on the Olympic road. His persistence, sacrifice and the ultimate realisation of value deeply explain the meaning of sportsmanship and personal struggle.

Taking collective memory as the entry point to examine Chinese Olympic films shows that film narrative and emotional expression are reflected in the image of athletes, which are more real and three-dimensional. Their success and

failure have become an important part of personal growth and identity. This also illustrates the shift in China's sports sector from a singular, nationwide system to a dual-track development, paralleling competitive and mass sports.

3. Towards identity: the local cultural narrative of identity in Chinese Olympic films

Collective memory helps to enhance the identification of the group and further imagination. It shapes the “self” internally, distinguishes the “other” externally, and solidifies, clarifies and confirms the identity in the mirror interaction between the “we” and the “other”^[5]. Identity, is a central issue in Olympic films. Identity is not only related to individuals' understanding and acceptance of self-culture, but also involves the positioning and belonging of individuals in different cultural backgrounds. This sense of identity makes people more united and values their differences and commonalities, thus promoting diversity and inclusiveness in society. Compared with the Chinese Olympic films during 2008, the Olympic films during the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics were created under the background of the new era. During this period, China paid more attention to the display of cultural confidence and national spirit, and the films began to reflect more profound self-identity.

On the one hand, Chinese Olympic films show their unique cultural depth of local narrative in building identity. The film *“40,000 kilometers”* depicts the challenging journey of a Han Chinese coach as he trains Tibetan athletes on the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau (located in southwest China), showcasing the dedication and perseverance of grassroots sports workers in China's ethnic minority regions. In the film, the Tibetan language is used as one of the dialogue languages, and it is also performed by many Tibetan actors. The visual elements such as traditional Tibetan costumes, traditional food culture and Pastoral yurt in the film are all marked with a deep local imprint. Through the clever use of historical and cultural elements, the film closely connects the struggle stories of athletes with the history and culture of the country and the nation, thus inspiring a strong sense of identity and belonging in the hearts of the audience. In particular, the film *“Me and My Winter Games”*, as the only animated film selected by the institute, also has typical characteristics in the dissemination of local culture. In addition to the mascots “Bing Dwen Dwen” and “Shuey Rhon Rhon” as the protagonists, the film also brings together nearly 50 classic Chinese animated characters,

evoking the childhood memories of several generations of Chinese people. The film also tells different stories to convey the Chinese philosophy, promote the spirit of sports, embodies the Chinese cultural spirit of Unity of heaven and man, people-oriented, to be vigorous, harmony is most precious. The integration of these local cultural elements not only enhances the identity, but also shows the world the charm of China as an ancient cultural country.

On the other hand, Chinese Olympic films show a complex and subtle tension when dealing with the relationship between individual and collective identity. The Beijing Winter Olympics film *“Beijing 2022”* takes a humanistic perspective as a starting point, focusing on both the world-renowned events and delving into the daily lives of ordinary people. The roles involved are not only athletes, but also venue builders, event organisers, volunteers, etc. They overcome numerous difficulties with their own efforts and persistence, achieving breakthroughs and transcendence, reflecting the close connection between personal life and collective activities. Another winter Olympics themed film, *“Breaking Through”*, the story of Yang Yang, a short track speed skater who won the first gold medal in the history of the Chinese Winter Olympics, shows her personal growth process and struggle for national honor, and reflects the close connection between individual efforts and national honor. This dialectical unity of individual and collective not only reflects the sports spirit of contemporary China, but also gives richer philosophical connotation and realistic significance to the identity of Chinese Olympic films.

Overall, identity in Olympic films plays an important role in social solidarity and the shaping of the national image. By stimulating the emotional resonance and identity of the audience, it enhances the cohesion and centripetal force among the members of the society, and also sets up a positive image for China on the international stage.

4. The Reasons for the Changes in visual communication from “Memory” to “Identity”

It is argued that the entire Olympic performance, as well as the performances of the athletes themselves, offer individuals the opportunity to address profoundly important existential questions about the nature of their personal and collective selves.^[6] Therefore, it is of certain theoretical significance to explore the course change of Chinese Olympic films from “collective memory” to “identity”.

This study analyses the changes of Chinese Olympic films from “memory” to “identity”, and draws a series of research conclusions. The influence of socio-cultural background, the internal demand of the sports concept, and deepening the indigenous spirit of the Olympic together constitute the three core driving forces to promote the change of the communication of Chinese Olympic films.

(1) In the aspect of social culture, this study finds that with the progress of The Times and the change of social environment, the cultural connotation and social value of Chinese Olympic films are also constantly enriched and deepened. From the initial political propaganda tool to gradually become an important carrier to reflect the social reality and convey the humanistic care, this transformation of Chinese Olympic film not only complies with the trend of social and cultural development, but also reflects the continuous maturity and improvement of the film art itself.

(2) In terms of the internal needs of sports concepts, this research points out that with the deepening of the Olympic concept in China, people’s expectation for Olympic films is no longer limited to the review of historical events and the memory of collective memory, but pays more attention to the role and identity of individuals in the society. Sports is no longer limited to competitive match, but has become a carrier of values such as healthy living, collaboration, and self challenge. As a cultural product, film need to reflect the spirit of The Times and the needs of the audience. Therefore, Chinese Olympic films gradually shift from collective memory to the exploration of individual identity.

(3) Deepening the indigenous spirit of the Olympic is also an important factor that cannot be ignored in the spread of Chinese Olympic films. While absorbing international advanced experience, Chinese Olympic films have always adhered to a localised creative concept and value orientation. By delving deeply into the essence of Chinese culture, cleverly integrating traditional cultural elements into it, and combining sports history with modern sports achievements, it showcases the development process of Chinese sports. While reviewing history, the audience can feel the vitality and progress of modern sports, thereby deepening their recognition of local sports culture and Olympic spirit.

5. Conclusion and discussion

Chinese Olympic films, as a special cultural product, not only record the glorious course of Chinese sports, but also play a decisive role in spreading the Olympic

spirit and culture. By analysing the spread process of Chinese Olympic films, this study reveals the reasons for the transition from “collective memory” to “identity”. This study found that Chinese Olympic films play an important role in spreading the Olympic spirit and culture, shaping collective memory, and promoting identity. However, in the face of the challenges and opportunities in the social media era, Chinese Olympic films need to constantly innovate and optimise their communication strategies to adapt to the market demand and audience changes, so as to better play their social and cultural functions.

In the future, in the context of global communication, Chinese Olympic films will pay more attention to cross-cultural communication and international cooperation. As an important part of sports culture, Olympic films will become an important bridge connecting different civilisations and promoting mutual understanding. Through in-depth cooperation with the International Olympic Committee and foreign film organisations, Chinese Olympic films adhere to the principle of “based on the local, embrace the world”, will continue to strengthen cooperation and exchanges with international academia, innovate narrative techniques, expand theme areas, and constantly enhance the global communication power.

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Appendix: Introduction to eight Chinese Olympic themed Films

Year	Movie Name	Plot introduction
2008	<i>Dream 2008</i>	It records the preparation process for the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games, and shows the efforts and sweat of Chinese people to realize the Olympic dream from a few small things.
2008	<i>The One Man Olympics</i>	It tells the story of athlete Liu Changchun, who refused to represent the puppet state of Manchukuo supported by Japan in the 10th Los Angeles Olympics in 1932, and overcame numerous obstacles, crossing the ocean for the first time to represent China on the Olympic stage.
2008	<i>Heart of Ice</i>	It mainly tells the exemplary deeds of Chinese short track speed skaters Da Yangyang, Wang Meng and other world champions, as well as short track speed skating coach Comrade Meng Qingyu.
2012	<i>Xu Haifeng's Gun</i>	It tells the story of Xu Haifeng, the first gold medalist in Chinese Olympic history. The film shows how Xu Haifeng shot down the first gold medal in China's Olympic history and presented it to the "Chinese Revolution Museum", expressing his gratitude for the country's cultivation.
2017	<i>40,000 kilometers</i>	Based on the first Chinese Tibetan Olympic gold medalist and the bronze medalist in the women's 20 kilometer race walk at the 2012 London Olympics, Che Yangshi, this story tells of a retired Han athlete who rediscovers herself on the Qinghai Tibet Plateau, cultivates the indomitable spirit and hard work of Tibetan people, and uses sweat and sacrifice to achieve the Olympic dream.
2022	<i>Me and My Winter Game</i>	The animated Olympic films produced by the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympic Games and the Winter Paralympic Games have gathered many Chinese animated characters and the mascots of the Winter Olympic Games, Bing Dwen Dwen, and the Winter Paralympic Games, Shuey Rhon Rhon, around the opening ceremony of the Beijing Winter Olympic Village and the Winter Paralympic Village, and told a story of many chapters about unity, dreams, courage, and hard work because of the encounter.
2022	<i>Breaking Through</i>	It tells the story of China's breakthrough in winning zero Winter Olympics gold medals in short track speed skating. In 2002, Yang Yang won the gold medal in the women's short track speed skating 500m event at the 19th Salt Lake City Winter Olympics, becoming China's first Winter Olympics champion.
2023	<i>Beijing 2022</i>	The official documentary of the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics tells the true story of China's concerted efforts to fully fulfill its bid commitment for hosting the Winter Olympics. The film not only showcases an international perspective and Chinese charm, but also pays special attention to grassroots athletes, conveying values of tolerance, equality, and internationalism through their stories.

THE FIRST GENDER-EQUAL OLYMPIC GAMES IN HISTORY: GENDER REPRESENTATION IN THE TELEVISION NEWS COVERAGE OF THE PARIS 2024 OLYMPICS

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Abstract

This paper aims to present the design of a research project focused on the analysis of gender representation in the prime-time television news coverage of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games (OG) in mainstream Spanish TV news programmes. Additionally, it seeks to examine how young audiences perceive this representation. The specific objectives of this study include assessing the presence and relevance of female athletes, the topics covered, the information treatment reported by Spanish outlets, and a qualitative analysis of the audience perceptions. The methodology will use mixed methods, combining the content analysis technique with focus groups to contrast the data and achieve a comprehensive understanding.

This research is relevant because the Paris 2024 Olympics were the first gender-equal Games in history, with an equal number of male and female athletes. Given the massive audience of the Olympics, it is important to analyse media coverage from a gender perspective to identify disparities and biases. This study can positively influence the visibility of female athletes as role models and contribute to combating stereotypes in sports.

Expected outcomes include, among others, international collaborations to replicate the study in other countries and develop this research line further. The dissemination of results is planned for conferences, scientific publications, and

through university training events. Moreover, the final report is expected to be communicated to the media, the International Olympic Committee (IOC), and the Spanish Olympic Committee (COE) to provide recommendations for gender equality strategies in sports media coverage.

1. Introduction

The Paris 2024 Olympic Games (OG) are historically significant as they are the first to feature an equal number of male and female athletes. This fact makes this topic not only timely but also of high social relevance, as the Olympic Games are one of the events that attracts the largest global audience. For instance, the Tokyo 2020 Olympic Games were watched by 66% of the Spanish population, with approximately 30.3 million viewers (Barlovento Comunicación, 2021). In 2024, the total coverage of the Paris Olympic Games' broadcastings reached 31.3 million viewers, equating to 67,1% of the population in Spain who turned in at least once (Barlovento Comunicación, 2024).

The massive media coverage of the Olympic Games is frequently questioned regarding gender representation and inclusion in sports. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) has set gender equality as one of its goals for the 2021-2024 cycle. Particularly, regarding media coverage, the IOC (2024) has developed guidelines for promoting equal, fair, and inclusive representation, encouraging media outlets, content creators, and sports leaders to embrace and adapt these guidelines in their respective contexts.

This paper aims to present the design of a research project focused on the analysis of gender representation in the prime-time television news coverage of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games in Spain. The study will explore gender disparities in the journalistic coverage made by Spanish mainstream media and assess whether the outlets adhere to the IOC's guidelines on gender equality.

2. Persistent Underrepresentation of Female Athletes in Spanish Media

Previous research has highlighted the limited and often stereotyped representation of female athletes in mainstream media during the Olympic Games (Eastman & Billings, 1999; Billing & Eastman, 2003; Burch, Pedersen & Geurin, 2012; Grabmüllerová, 2022; Salido-Fernandez & Muñoz-Muñoz, 2023). In Spain,

evidence has shown that women's presence in sports media is almost non-existent, in comparison to the high percentages of male athletes' presence (Sainz de Baranda, 2014). This phenomenon had already been confirmed in a case study of Catalonia's public television, where female athletes were nearly invisible in terms of both their presence and the quality of their representation. The authors (Ramajo et al., 2009) found that women athletes were typically featured in minor sports, while in more popular sports, their roles were brief and secondary, often focusing on their appearance rather than their athletic ability or used as background decoration in male-dominant stories.

More recent studies (Abuín-Penas & Fontenla-Pedreira, 2020) demonstrate the constant unequal treatment, favouring male athletes over female athletes in the official social media posts of the Spanish National Football Team. This finding confirms that this pattern continues to persist despite the growing digitalisation of media. Despite a 2023 report (Appletree Agency & Rebold, 2023) showing an increase in the coverage of women's sports in traditional Spanish media from 14% in 2021 to 22% in 2022, the gap in the representation between male and female athletes remains very high. Notably, women's football has become the most widely covered female sport in media (Appletree Agency & Rebold, 2023) while other studies have indicated a growing interest in the consumption of women's sports in Spain (Mujika-Alberdi et al., 2021).

Research has also shown the continued dominance of male sports in Spanish media. Male athletes receive extensive visibility in some of the country's most popular digital sports outlets, such as *Marca* and *AS*, while coverage of female sports remains almost non-existent (Roca-Marín & Navarro-García, 2022).

This persistent underrepresentation and stereotyping female athletes in Spanish sports is confirmed by the audience research project conducted by Mujika-Alberdi et al. (2021). Their study surveyed public opinion in the Basque Country and found that female athletes are perceived as less visible and less prominent than their male counterparts.

This disparity in media coverage influences public opinion and contributes to the perpetuation of gender stereotypes in sports. As journalists and editorial boards select elements of perceived reality to report (Entman, 1993), they shape public interpretations by framing specific perspectives and topics. These selections compose the structure of media agendas, determining which issues and people are relevant and which are marginalised (Mccombs & Shaw, 1972). Therefore, the media's framing of sports coverage impacts how the public

perceives women and other genders in sports, shaping attitudes, behaviours, and expectations.

3. Project Aim

The primary objective of this project is to analyse gender representation in the prime-time television coverage of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games (OG) in daily mainstream TV news programmes in Spain, as well as to explore how young audiences perceive this gender representation.

Specific Objectives:

- **SO1:** Quantify and characterise the presence and relevance of athletes' coverage by gender in Spanish television news.
- **SO2:** Identify and analyse the topics, audiovisual language, and information treatment of athletes' coverage by gender in Spanish television news.
- **SO3:** Explore how young audiences perceive gender representation in the media coverage of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games as presented on daily mainstream Spanish TV news programmes.

4. Methods and Sample

Regarding the methodology, we will use mixed methods combining quantitative and qualitative techniques across two phases. In the first phase, a content analysis will be conducted on the news pieces related to the Paris 2024 Olympic Games broadcasted on Spanish mainstream TV channels to identify the characteristics of the coverage of athletes by gender. The second phase involves focus groups with young audiences of the Paris 2024 OG and Spanish TV news programmes to understand their perception of the journalistic coverage from a gender perspective.

4.1. First Phase: Primary Content Analysis

The unit of analysis for this study is the audiovisual news piece broadcasted on mainstream TV news programmes. The sample includes only those audiovisual news pieces related to the Olympic Games. The selected TV news programmes

are prime-time broadcasts from the five major Spanish channels: one public (La1, RTVE), and four private (Antena 3, Cuatro, Telecinco, and La Sexta). A total of 85 TV news programmes, aired during the celebration of the Olympic Games, from July 26th to August 11th of 2024, will be collected from the online archives of each channel.

Once the data is selected and the sample defined, we will proceed to validate the variables of the study and the research instruments. The author of this paper and the other project researchers will analyse and register the data in a database, following the guidelines established in the codebook designed for the content analysis. The codebook will include definitions and examples for each one of the variables, and all coders will undergo proper training. To assess data reliability, an intercoder reliability test will be carried out in 10% of the sample, allowing us to make adjustments to the coding sheet.

4.2. Second Phase: Focus Groups

A total of three focus groups will be conducted among Generation Z audiences. In order to freely deepen the youth public's perception of gender representation in the TV news coverage, one focus group will be exclusively female, another exclusively male, and the third mixed. This design will allow us to compare their perceptions by gender.

The focus groups will take place at the Autonomous University of Barcelona, led by one of the project researchers. Each group will consist of 8 to 10 participants and will last approximately 1.5 hours. The sessions will be recorded on video and transcribed for the analysis. The transcripts will be analysed thematically to identify emerging categories.

While analysing the media messages through content analysis is essential, incorporating audience reception analysis is equally important. Media coverage not only reflects but also influences societal perceptions and attitudes towards gender and equality. This project will provide valuable evidence on how equitable representation in media coverage can positively impact the visibility of role models and contribute to combating stereotypes in sports coverage.

5. Expected Outcomes and Future work

To conduct the research and inform about their corresponding findings, a series of expected outcomes are outlined below.

The results of this research aim to be presented at national and international conferences, academic forums, and sports, gender, and media communication conferences. Moreover, the findings are expected to be published in high-impact scientific journals as well as in explanatory articles for the mainstream press and specialised media.

The final report aims to be distributed to the media outlets included in the study sample. We also intend to communicate the project's results to a broader media audience through a press release issued by the Communication and Promotion Office of the Autonomous University of Barcelona (UAB). The most significant results are planned to be disseminated through the university's communication platforms, such as UABmèdia (via interviews or publications), and potentially through the social media channels of the UAB, the Faculty of Communication Sciences, and the Olympic Studies Centre (CEO-UAB).

One of the key future steps is to generate international collaborations to replicate this research in other countries with access to the television news coverage of the Paris 2024 Olympic Games. These collaborations could result in research papers focused on gender representation across different countries, as well as comparative studies with Spain. We intend to establish partnerships with at least two or three countries over the course of the project. As several members of the research team are originally from outside Spain, a research network could be formed to facilitate the replication of this study in their respective countries. Likewise, it is expected that some collaborations could emerge from the 31st International Seminar on Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students, which the author of this paper attended.

We also foresee potential collaborations with the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the Spanish Olympic Committee (COE), capitalising on existing synergies between these organisations and the Olympic Studies Centre (CEO-UAB). The findings from this project could help these bodies in promoting gender equality in sports media coverage. Collaboration may include raising awareness among media professionals about the importance of equitable gender representation, with a focus on boosting the visibility of female and minority sports.

Other outcomes could be the organisation of events and seminars. Some seminars will be organised to share the research methodology and findings with the UAB community, particularly with PhD and Master's students, as well as the general public. These seminars may also take place in countries involved in potential comparative studies, to promote awareness and support for equality in sports media within the academic community. Also, a roundtable event could be held at UAB, presenting university experts in sports, gender, and communication. The purpose will be to discuss the project's findings and provide advice to the research team for future developments, particularly regarding preparation for the upcoming "Knowledge Generation Projects" Spanish funding call.

Finally, the last expected outcome will be the creation of a shared database to facilitate future research on the evolution of gender representation in media coverage of the Olympic Games (or other large-scale sporting events), as well as to enable comparative studies across countries. This database will help establish a new line of research at the CEO-UAB, building on the institute's previous studies in this area.

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NATIONALISM AND OLYMPIC LEGACY: BEIJING 2008 IN CONTEXT

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1. Introduction

Throughout Europe, North America, and other regions, it is prevalent to use sports mega-events for urban marketing to promote economic development and image building (Liu and Gratton, 2010). In recent years, the number of cases involving developing countries has also increased, such as the 2008 Beijing Olympics, the 2016 Brazil Olympics, and the 2022 World Cup in Qatar. As one of the most famous mega-events in the world, in order to continue this enthusiasm and provide evidence that hosting the Olympic Games is beneficial to the host city, the International Olympic Committee has proposed the concept of “legacy” to refer to assumed long-term benefits (Grant, 2014a; Mangan, 2008; Zimbalist, 2015). As one of the most important sports legacies, local sports facilities will bring about changes in the host and local residents’ economic activity patterns and lifestyles (Kim and Petrick, 2005).

However, this heritage statement may have positive implications while ignoring adverse effects (Karadakis and Kaplanidou, 2012). Moreover, this impact is more measured from the perspective of the overall local development, and less attention is paid to the personal interests of residents. Holt and Ruta (2015, p. 1) pointed out: “Greece brought us an unforgettable Summer Olympics in 2004, and Turin also hosted the Winter Olympics in 2006, but many sports infrastructures are rarely used”. The report of China Economic Weekly (2008) also shows that from 2004 to 2008, the Olympic Games helped Beijing’s GDP increase by 105.5 billion yuan. However, it did not mention that the construction

of the Bird's Nest and the Water Cube would affect the surrounding residents, causing noise disturbance, rising prices, and forced migration (Ma, S. C. *et al.*, 2013). Therefore, the direct economic benefits of these sports facilities brought by sports mega-events often become more of the performance of local governments and business opportunities for large enterprises, without considering local residents' actual needs and interests, and even causing them violation (Zhang and Wu, 2008). In this case, in order to avoid disputes over sports facilities, the national government tends to use non-material values such as nationalism, whose keywords are described as unity and honour, to compensate and cancel these problems (Gorokhov, 2015).

Hence, this essay takes the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games as an example and attempts to critically discuss the view that disputes over local sports facilities come from influential urban promoters and growth alliances, who are prioritising economic and image-making objectives over the needs of local citizens. First, the abstract will elaborate on the three main stakeholders related to sports facilities and explain their relationship. Then, it will use evidence to prove that the interest growth alliance formed by the government and commercial enterprises puts the needs and interests of residents behind for economic development and image building. Finally, by analysing the nationalist ideology contained in related sports policies, it explains how the government resolves disputes about sports facilities.

2. Analysis from the perspective of stakeholders

When it comes to the sports mega-events and its legacy of sports infrastructure, the main stakeholders are three parties: the city government, commercial enterprises, and local citizens (Vadiati, 2020). Among them, the city government is the primary advocate and the biggest beneficiary (Zhang and Wu, 2008). They promote the construction of sports facilities by holding sports mega-events to achieve economic growth and reconstruct the city's image.

First, sports mega-events such as the Olympic Games are highly emotional and are associated with certain symbolic meanings and emotions (Liu and Gratton, 2010). Therefore, urban promoters can use these sports infrastructures and the glorious moments in these venues to reshape the image of a place and a country. For example, the construction of the Bird's Nest and the Water Cube has set a new standard for international stadiums, and the opening ceremony staged in the

Bird's Nest also has a shocking effect (Gratton, Preuss and Liu, 2015). According to Nielsen's statistics, China opened its doors more widely than ever before: the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games' opening ceremony that attracted approximately 2 billion TV viewers (China Daily, 2008). Therefore, this is an opportunity to help the world understand modern China: the excellent traditional Chinese culture, peace and friendship, mutual exchanges, and other universal values displayed in the Bird's Nest help to improve the past impacts from poor democratic governance and reshape a good image (Grix and Lee, 2013).

In addition, hosting large-scale competitions at home makes it easier for the host team to enter the venue and become more familiar with the venue, which can help them achieve better athletic performance (Zhou, Ap and Bauer, 2012). Achieving excellent medal standings in international sports mega-events such as the Olympic Games can be regarded as the country's excellence and strength, thereby promoting internal and external image building (Gorokhov, 2015).

Secondly, it needs to be explained that under the conditions of a market economy, in order to increase fiscal revenue and improve the performance of serving officials, city governments need to rely on the support of commercial enterprises. Investment is mainly aimed at land development, and land is an essential resource unique to local governments (Zhang and Wu, 2008). Therefore, the city government and enterprise groups have formed an interest growth alliance to develop and utilise land resources to varying degrees by constructing sports facilities to promote economic growth. However, in China, due to the imperfect democratisation and legalisation, urban citizens and non-government non-profit social organisations play a minimal role in monitoring and questioning this kind of interest growth alliance. Therefore, citizens are excluded from this alliance, and their interests are not taken seriously (Zhang, 2001).

For example, in order to renovate sports facilities and their surroundings, many local residents in Beijing migrated with a certain amount of compensation. As a result, the number of families who lost their original homes was approximately 1.25 million (COHRE, 2007). However, the Olympic Village built with the land resources acquired was bought by developers at a price of more than US\$2,000 per square meter after the 2008 Beijing Olympics and was gradually transformed into a high-end residential complex (Liu, 2008). In fact, this approach has improved the government's profitability index in the Olympic cycle and demonstrated its legacy management capabilities. It also enabled

commercial enterprises to obtain policy concessions and purchase high-quality land resources at relatively favourable prices. However, for local residents, this is a sacrifice to make way for the city's economic development and national reputation, which is unfair (Zhang, 2015). Even due to the construction of these sports facilities, housing prices in nearby areas have risen, causing more trouble to the surrounding residents. According to statistics from CRIC, the housing prices around Beijing Olympic Park have increased from an average price of 9702 yuan/m² in 2006 to 87418 yuan/m² in 2015 (Sohu, 2016a). This situation also occurred after the 2000 Sydney Olympics and the 2016 Rio Olympics (Cashman, 2015; Grant, 2017b).

In addition, the Bird's Nest and Water Cube, the two most-watched venues, were built as new tourist attractions after the Olympics, and local residents were not allowed to enter the venues to use the sports equipment (Gratton, Preuss and Liu, 2015). The development of tourism is mainly to attract foreign tourists for consumption and entertainment and promote economic development, which will not directly benefit the lives of local residents. Simultaneously, due to poor management after the events, the operator of the Bird's Nest tried to sell the naming rights, but the government intervened in policy to prevent these transactions and took over the stadium operations (Gratton, Preuss and Liu, 2015). The purpose of this is to preserve the honor and reputation that the National Stadium symbolises by forcing commercial enterprises to give up certain management rights. Hence, even interest alliances will disintegrate after the sports mega-event – those with administrative power continue to intervene and effectively control the city's development (Zhang and Wu, 2008).

Nevertheless, as one of the stakeholders, the support of local residents is also crucial for holding sport mega-event because each citizen pays the cost of infrastructure actually, and sometimes they have to pay more taxes to cover expenses. Also, this can ensure that residents become volunteers and make visitors feel a good atmosphere (Karadakis and Kaplanidou, 2012). If it arouses dissatisfaction among residents and creates tension, it will not only threaten the government's purpose of building the image of the city and the country, but also cause chaos in social order, such as the 2016 Rio Olympics (NBC News, 2016).

Therefore, the government has to make some promises to obtain residents' willingness to follow their policies. Propaganda introducing some core values and universal ideologies is more conducive to public acceptance to achieve interest alliances (Grix and Lee, 2013).

3. The key to covering up sports facilities disputes: Nationalism as a communication tool for related sports policies

The *Government Work Report* (2002) clearly stated: “Beijing’s acquisition of the right to host the 2008 Olympic Games marks the further improvement of China’s international status and the continuous expansion of its influence in international affairs”. Here, the hosting of the Olympic Games is linked to the strength of a country and a nation, and the Games are described as a solid basis for enhancing the country’s reputation and visibility and proving the legitimacy of the existing political system (Zhou, Ap and Bauer, 2012; Gorokhov, 2015). This may explain why the Chinese people are willing to support the government’s Olympic-related policies and accept high expenditures on sports facilities, poor utilisation of sports facilities, and other issues, although it may be illusions. Political elites influence the people through political ideology in related sports policies (Alekseyeva, 2014). Moreover, because of the particularity of China’s history and political background, nationalism eventually became a tool to help the state and city governments promote related sports policies and maintain the existing ruling order, and ultimately benefited the interest alliance (Gorokhov, 2015).

When the principles of national sentiment, attachment, and identity are amplified, the principle of collectivism will become one of the characteristics of Olympism (Close, Askew, and Xu, 2006). In China, the people’s sense of national identity for the Olympics has been sourced for a long time, and it has even become a cultural tradition (Luo and Huang, 2013). The introduction of the Olympic Games and Olympic culture occurred at the beginning of the twentieth century under the unique background of domestic turmoil and foreign aggression, which prompted the Chinese to regard this kind of sports mega-event as a platform that can revive national pride (Mangan, 2008). On this platform, no matter what international status, all countries, including the colonised, can participate in the Olympics. For example, at the 2004 Asian Cup, the ridicule of Chinese football fans against the Japanese team originated from the resentment and dissatisfaction left over from Japan’s war of aggression against China in the past (Close, Askew, and Xu, 2006). Therefore, competition and hostility between countries in sports mega-events can reasonably be understood as potential nationalism.

Therefore, this kind of nationalism, which represents the “imaginary political

community” (Anderson, 1991, p. 4), has become the priority for the government’s policy propaganda strategy. In this case, by strengthening the commonalities between the members of their own country and minimising the similarities with the people of other countries, people try to distinguish their nation from other countries and create an ideal close community group (Billings *et al.*, 2013). In such a community with a shared future, citizens are eager to provide support and pride for their imaginary country (Grant, 2014a). In *the Speech at the Reception Celebrating the 52nd Anniversary of the Founding of the People’s Republic of China* (2001), then-Premier Zhu Rongji stated: “Beijing’s bid for the 2008 Olympic Games was successful, and the people of the whole country were rejoicing, and the patriotic enthusiasm was unprecedentedly high”. Similarly, *The Implementation of the National Economic and Social Development Plan in 2000 and the Draft National Economic and Social Development Plan in 2001* (2001) mentioned: “Our athletes in the 27th Olympic Games created the best results since participating in the Olympic Games. This statement has inspired the patriotic enthusiasm and spirit of unity and struggle of the people across the country”. Here, through emotional expressions such as patriotism and unity, the victory of a sport mega-event serves as a universal and legal carrier to show the strength of a country and shift public attention to the nation’s consciousness (Gorokhov, 2015). This strong sense of identity and empathy is the overflow of nationalism, which provides the foundation for the subsequent large-scale development of sports facilities in the country and local cities.

According to the National Audit Office of China report, the total investment in the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games venues reached \$3.13 billion (Gratton, Preuss, and Liu, 2015). Robinson (2005) pointed out that in sports mega-events, most of the budget is spent on constructing stadiums and the hosting of sports events that take place here. However, due to the high cost of construction, maintenance, and operation, if there is no mature sports industry, strong sports culture, and active participation in mass sports after the event, the utilisation of these facilities will be significantly insufficient (Robinson, 2015). Moreover, these facilities will consume a country’s financial resources and hinder other fields during and after the Olympic Games. In fact, according to the *Eleventh Five-Year Plan for the Sports Industry* (2006) issued by the State Sports General Administration, on the whole, China’s current sports industry is still relatively small, and its share in the national economy is still relatively low; the sports industry as a whole is still in its infancy, and the sports market is still immature.

Therefore, these three stakeholders understand the current development of the sports industry and the expected use of sports facilities in the future (these policies are open to the public). In this case, the construction of the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games stadiums was still relatively smooth, and even the National Aquatics Center Water Cube received donations from the general public (Luo and Huang, 2013).

The support embodied in nationalist policies played a key role. Specifically, by guiding the public to pay attention to the independent innovation of the Bird's Nest, the policy leader shifts the people's attention to the resulting sense of national pride. They linked this process with the independence and self-improvement of the Chinese nation and made the people believe that supporting the independent construction of the Bird's Nest is supporting the rejuvenation of the Chinese nation, and vice versa may be considered unpatriotic behavior (Zhou, Ap, and Bauer, 2012). At the *Bird's Nest Construction Policy Meeting*, Liu Qi, secretary of the Beijing Municipal Party Committee, clearly requested that special high-strength steels should not be imported as long as they can be produced in China; Hou Zhaoxin, the leading expert of the 2008 Engineering Construction Command, said that "The Bird's Nest has dozens of innovative technologies, which is one of the most difficult steel structure projects in the world, and the entire steel structure construction is done independently by the Chinese" (Sohu, 2018b).

In such an atmosphere of celebration and joy, citizens will be more likely to ignore their oppression and differences. In fact, this is a concept stealing of the national sentiments conveyed in the emotional symbols and policies of sports facilities: independent innovation is essential and excellent for a nation; however, what is the cost of these steel frame structures? Is it necessary to spend so much energy and money designing these so-called venues to create a new landmark in Beijing and show its image to audiences at home and abroad? As a general contractor, Beijing Urban Construction Group has recruited outstanding talents in various professional fields to form a special team. Meanwhile, to support the independent innovation of Bird's Nest, 2 million yuan is drawn from the research funding of the headquarters as the Bird's Nest scientific research funding (Sohu, 2018b). Citizen leaders do not pay attention to the specific financial statements of the facility but tend to pay attention to the image of the city it represents, whether it echoes the collective self-esteem (Liu and Wilson, 2014). Therefore,

these issues did not generate the same disputes or even protests in Brazil in 2013 (for example, the BBC report, June 18, 2013).

4. Summary

As an essential legacy of sports mega-events, sports facilities mainly involve three stakeholders. Through the review of the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games and its sports facilities legacy case, it can be found that the construction of sports facilities is promoted by the interest growth alliance with the goal of economy and image building, and the fundamental needs and interests of local residents have been ignored. Therefore, lots of sports facilities have become a “white elephant”, in addition to the Beijing Olympics, such as those experienced at the Lillehammer (1994), Nagano (1998), Salt Lake (2002), and Winter Olympic Games (Karadakis and Kaplanidou, 2012).

Among them, city promoters and interest growth alliances composed of city governments and commercial enterprises try to use the drama and pleasure of sports facilities and sports mega-events to create an ideological product for public consumption (Grant, 2014a). The practice in China is to build a community of common defence against external threats by hiding nationalism behind relevant policies, effectively concealing or delaying disputes and conflicts with local residents due to improper use of sports facilities. Under the umbrella of nationalism, city governments are more likely to obtain citizens’ support for urban renewal and facility structure changes, and the initial more reasonable planning and consulting process may be overturned (Zhou, Ap, and Bauer, 2012). The result of this approach is to attract investment in construction and tourists to the city, becoming an accelerator that promotes economic growth and the legalisation of urban image reconstruction projects (Silk, 2014).

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STUDY ON OLYMPIC SOCIAL INCLUSION

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Study on Olympic social inclusion

The Olympic Movement plays an important role in improving overall social inclusiveness and promoting the construction of an inclusive society. By applying Bailey's social inclusion framework, this study aims to identify the theoretical logic and analyse relevant practical measures of Olympics in promoting social inclusion from spatial, functional, relational and power dimensions. The results show Olympic Movement can promote positive impacts in all four dimensions of social inclusion. The findings of this research are expected to provide a deeper understanding of the positive impacts of Olympics in promoting social inclusion and conclusions for its unique social value. Hoping to further enrich the research spectrum of the Olympic Movement.

Keywords: Olympic Movement; Social inclusion; Social exclusion

Introduction

Sport can be used as a valuable tool to address social exclusion problems and promote the inclusiveness of the society. As one of the most influential sporting events worldwide, the Olympic Movement is a cultural phenomenon with the values of tolerance, unity and equality, which can be used to eliminate discrimination, break down social barriers and promote social inclusion. It not only allows public to appreciate the excellence of sports, but also plays a unique role in the development of an inclusive society. Currently, there is still a lack of

research on how the Olympics promotes social inclusion. Its theoretical logic and practical measures in facilitating the development of an inclusive society have not been systematically summarised, and many issues still need to be explored in depth. Thus, this study deeply explores the internal logic of Olympics in enhancing social inclusiveness by applying Bailey's social inclusion framework. Analysing the actual practical path of its inclusive measures from four social inclusion dimensions including spatial, functional, relational and power, in order to enhance the understanding of the Olympics in promoting social inclusion.

Social Inclusion Theory

Social Inclusion

Before we analyse the concept of social inclusion in depth, the emergence of social exclusion is worth to be mentioned. The concept of "exclusion" originated from poverty, a social problem that people believed would disappear during the social and economic reconstruction process in the 1970s (Jing, 2004). It is the various deprivations or exclusions brought to different social individuals due to changes in the external economic environment (Rees, 1998), which do not only refer to economic poverty, but also include deeper social problems such as lack of skills, gender inequality, and individual psychological or physical defects. As the definition given by European Commission in 1993:

"Social exclusion is the exclusion of people from normal social interaction, time and power in modern society due to multiple and changing factors. Poverty is one of the most obvious factors, but social exclusion also includes people's lack of power in areas such as housing, education and health care" (Percy-Smith, 2000).

The emergence of social exclusion theory expanded people's horizons in the study of social issues. Poverty was no longer the only factor that produce social exclusion. Instead, more diverse and deeper causes of exclusion were included. At the same time, the continuous improvement of the concept of exclusion also laid a theoretical foundation for the subsequent development of the concept of social inclusion.

The concept of social inclusion and its related derivative concepts are now increasingly used terms in different research fields. Consistent with social

exclusion, it also originates from the study of the “new poverty” problem, with gender discrimination, race, culture, physical defects and other exclusion issues as the research object. As the internal mechanism and external manifestations of social exclusion issues are increasingly recognised by politicians, sociologists, and psychologists, the research discourse on describing social issues has gradually shifted from exclusion to a more positive term, namely inclusion. This positive discourse shift shows adaptability to the demands of current social development. It is a further deepening of the existing concept of social exclusion based on the characteristics of current social development, and attempts to build a vision-oriented social development model to reflect the positive value orientation and value pursuit of social members for current social development. The concept of social inclusion not only provides us with a new theoretical concept to explain various exclusion problems and explore corresponding solutions, but also provides us with a new perspective to study social problems from a macro level. For example, the United Nations has promoted social inclusion as an important means to achieve the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and has formulated 17 social inclusion goals including poverty alleviation, decent work, gender equality, and education (United Nations, 2016), with the development vision of achieving an inclusive society and promoting the sustainable development of human civilisation. Similarly, driven by this positive discourse transformation, the connotation of social inclusion has become clearer. Its core concept is to eliminate any form of social exclusion, so that all members of society can share the outcomes of social and economic development, eliminating the social barriers and including all members of society in the process of social and economic development, regardless of their gender, nationality, physical ability, cultural background, economic situation, etc.

Bailey’s Social Inclusion Framework

As the concept of social inclusion involves too many fields, different studies have defined and analysed its core natures from different disciplinary perspectives and research focuses, presenting diversified, fragmented and complex research characteristics. It is a complex and challenging concept that is difficult to reduce to a simple definition or dimension (Tjørndal, 2019). As a result, this study adopted the sports social inclusion analysis framework of Richard Bailey and conducted research on the social inclusion of the Olympics around the spatial

dimension, relational dimension, functional dimension and power dimension (Bailey, 2005):

- 1) Spatial: Social inclusion relates to the proximity and the closing of social and economic distances;
- 2) Relational: Social inclusion is defined in terms of a sense of belonging and acceptance;
- 3) Functional: Social inclusion relates to the enhancement of knowledge, skills and understanding;
- 4) Power: Social inclusion assumes a change in the locus of control.

Olympic Social Inclusion

Spatial Dimension

The focus of spatial social inclusion lies in the aggregation value that the Olympics bring to human society. On the one hand, this aggregation focuses on the physical gathering of people centered around the Olympic Games, making it become a value opportunity to minimise the social distance between people with different background. On the other hand, from the inner perspective, it is the resonance of intangible values with sport as the bond, transforming the Olympic ideology with universal values into people's behavioural motivations, forming common value goals and value principles, and concretising it into people's daily behaviours. The focus of Olympic spatial inclusion is to narrow the distance between social members with different backgrounds in the material and spiritual worlds, closing their physical, social cultural and economic distance.

In terms of practical measures, the Olympics promotes spatial social inclusion based on its understanding and respect for the diversity of the world. The Olympic Games is not only an excellent opportunity for the world's diverse cultures to blend and collide, but also an important bond for the interweaving of diverse cultures. With the value of unity, it promotes mutual understanding among diverse cultures, unifies the value conflicts in diverse cultural forms under Olympism, and enables individuals with a certain cultural distance to respect and tolerate each other's cultural differences under the guidance of this transcendent ideology, thereby narrowing the cultural distance and reducing the barriers and obstacles between different cultures. Additionally, Olympics is also open and inclusive to emerging sports cultures. For example, the inclusion of "younger"

sport of BMX, break dancing and skateboarding in Paris 2024, or, the inclusion of the new digital phenomenon – eSports or Virtual Sports in the Olympics. The IOC's acceptance of these emerging sport cultures reflects the openness and inclusiveness of the Olympics, and narrows the distance between emerging sports culture groups and traditional sports culture groups. It allows people with different sports preference to discuss, understand and embrace variety of sports cultures, which helps to break the misunderstanding and prejudice between different sports culture groups. Narrowing the distance between different sports culture groups under the guidance of Olympic values.

Functional Dimension

Coubertin believed that the future of human civilisation did not depend on political or economic foundations, but entirely on the direction of education (IOC, 2023). Functional social inclusion focuses on the value of sports-related educational practices to both individuals and society as a whole. It emphasises the contribution of individual capacity improvement to the overall social development. The development of personal abilities is regarded as a fundamental process for improving social inclusiveness. The Olympic education can be regarded as “life-world-oriented” (Naul, 2008), it can contribute to the development needs of both individuals and society. It conducts individual education with the goal of promoting overall social development, so that individual growth can be reflected in society. Just as mentioned in the Olympic Charter:

“The goal of Olympism is to place sport at the service of the harmonious development of humankind, with a view to promoting a peaceful society concerned with the preservation of human dignity” (IOC, 2021).

Thus, the basic essence of the Olympics in promoting functional social inclusion is to improve individuals' physical and mental qualities, thinking cognition, communication skills and other comprehensive abilities through Olympic-related educational activities, cultivate people's awareness of inclusion, and bring individuals' good physical and mental qualities into social activities, thereby contributing to building an inclusive society.

In practice, Olympics plays a multi-faceted role in the development of humankind. It not only promotes the improvement of individual physical fitness

and health levels but also deeply influences the formation of individual values, driving the comprehensive improvement of individual abilities from both physical and mental aspects. For instance, since the concept of Olympic volunteer service was formally proposed at the 1992 Barcelona Olympic Games, Olympic volunteer service has become one of the important ways for the Olympics to improve the comprehensive capabilities of individuals. Olympic volunteer service can provide rich practical opportunities and diverse learning experiences, and has a positive impact on the development of individual skills, social responsibility, and moral qualities. It is conducive to the all-round development of people and cultivates talents with inclusive concepts and dedication for the society. Besides, one of the important manifestations of the Olympics functional social inclusion is that it can help individuals understand and respect the diversity of all aspects of society through various educational activities cantered on the Olympic spirit, shaping individuals' inclusive awareness, which encourage them to identify and solve various social exclusion problems with critical analytical skills, and promote inclusive social development through personal growth.

Relational Dimension

The focus of relational social inclusion is on how individuals gain or improve their sense of identity in an inclusive society and group, thereby stimulating their intrinsic motivation for self-identity. From the perspective of the external social environment, the universal ideological values of Olympics can create a more inclusive external social environment, curb the marginalisation of excluded groups and eliminate discrimination against specific groups, in order to establish a more inclusive social environment for vulnerable group. From the perspective of internal individual identity, the Olympics can also deeply intervene in the construction of different individual social identities, and help individuals gain or enhance their sense of belonging and identity to the group, society, and country. Build a more inclusive social relations through the emotional identification brought to individuals by external cognition. This two-way promotion mechanism not only plays an irreplaceable role in people's life experience of pursuing self-value realisation, but also demonstrates its unique value significance in advocating the concept of inclusiveness to the world and promoting the overall development of an inclusive society.

The practical promotion of Olympic relational social inclusion is mainly

reflected in the inclusion of vulnerable or excluded groups, helping them to change their negative self-image, relieve the anxiety, fear, tension and other negative emotions caused by physiological differences, gain social identity and belonging from a more inclusive social atmosphere which help them form a correct self-worth identity. For example, in the late 1980s, the Paralympic Games officially became part of the Olympics. It has become a world stage for people with disabilities to demonstrate their abilities, gain social recognition, and realise their self-worth. In which, produced significant effects on eliminating public's inherent prejudice and discrimination against people with disabilities. Also, the Olympic refugee team took onto the Olympic stage for the first time in Rio 2016, which gave great spiritual encouragement to tens of thousands of displaced people around the world, attracted the attention and recognition of the refugee group by the international community, and fully demonstrated the inclusive concept and humanistic spirit of Olympics. As a result, the inclusion and tolerance of vulnerable groups by the IOC is an important measure to promote relational social inclusion. It is conducive to vulnerable groups to better gain a sense of social acceptance and cultivate positive self-cognition, so that they can carry out their daily social life more proactively and confidently. Additionally, the Olympic Games help different social individuals to converge around the same goal, forming a social group with a consensus of values and inclusiveness, stimulating a sense of social identity and belonging, and thus forming a sense of community in society based on the principle of Olympism. Taking 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics as an example, 2022 Beijing proposed the concept of "Sharing", emphasizing that the hosting of the event requires the joint participation of the whole society which in practice, constructed a special social interaction scene that allows social members with different abilities, resources, and interests to gather around the Beijing Winter Olympics. Established a conscious community coupled by different members of society, which enhanced people's sense of identity and social belongings, enable individuals to more deeply understand, integrate into and contribute to the society they belong to.

Power dimension

Power dimension emphasises the balance of social power and ensures the social participation and life quality of excluded groups through equal and balanced distribution of social power and resources. The Olympic principle of fairness

actually reflects its expectation for a fair, just and equal human society, so that members of society can obtain more inclusive social power and resources, and receive basic support and protection in sports participation, skills education, health care and other aspects. Olympics use sports as a means to avoid excessive centralisation of social power, and strive to eliminate the exclusion problems caused by unequal distribution of power and resources. Strengthening people's sense of control over their own lives, thereby achieving a relative balance of social power and improving social inclusion in the power dimension. However, the equality pursued by the Olympics is not absolute equality, but relative equality based on the principle of "equality of personality". Rather than, blindly seeking equality in all aspects, the Olympic fairness seeks to eliminate any forms of discrimination, reduce the impact of pre-existing conditions, and provide everyone with opportunities and conditions for fair living. Approach social equality on the premise of accommodating differences in economic conditions, physiological conditions, cultural backgrounds, etc. Rationally pursuing equality in the society by avoiding extremism.

As for the practical measures, as one of the largest non-profit organizations in the world, the IOC plays an important role in the equal distribution of resources, making the flow of resources for the development of world sports more inclusive and allowing everyone to receive corresponding resource support. According to the IOC's 2017-2021 report, the IOC used 90% of its total revenue of US\$7.6 billion to support the development of global sports, including financial subsidies to athletes from various countries, IFS, NOCS, and various Olympic event organisers (IOC, 2021). It helps promote the balanced flow of global sports development resources, avoid excessive concentration of resource, and make resource allocation more inclusive and equal. Besides, the IOC clearly stated in Recommendation 13 of the Olympic Agenda 2020 that it will cooperate with interest groups in the Olympic family to the greatest extent possible, and proposed measures such as giving the Olympic Organizing Committee more flexibility in preparation, strengthening exchanges and cooperation with other sports organisations and professional sports leagues, and paying more attention to the needs of athletes and young people (IOC, 2014). This governance model reflects the equal and autonomous cooperation of all Olympic governance entities under the guidance of Olympism, respects the differences of each Olympic governance entity, ensures that all stakeholders can express their demands and make joint decisions in a governance environment of mutual

understanding and mutual cooperation, promotes voluntary participation and power sharing, and thus achieves the goal of mutual benefit and win-win results. On the one hand, the IOC governance model promotes sports as a soft power to play a more active role in promoting international cooperation. On the other hand, it can also promote the equalisation of resource power, protect the rights and interests of different groups, and make the power and resources of the Olympic movement more inclusive.

Conclusion

By applying Bailey's social inclusion framework, this study identifies social inclusion in Olympics from four dimensions, including spatial, functional, relational and power. The theoretical logic and practical measures of Olympics in promoting social inclusion are further explored. However, due to the size of the study, the biggest limitation of this research is the simplicity of the research method, future research should attempt to explore the practical value of Olympics by using other qualitative research methods such as interviews or questionnaires in order to gain a more accurate and clear outcome. Also, social inclusion is a phenomenon with extensive complexity, and thus the four dimensions mentioned by Bailey's framework may not be sufficient to represent the full form of it. Therefore, future research should also expand more influential dimensions based on Bailey's theory, thereby gaining a more comprehensive understanding of social inclusion theoretically.

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EXPLORING TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATIONS IN INTERNATIONAL SPORTS FEDERATIONS: ENHANCING FAN EXPERIENCE

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Abstract

This article explores the use of new technologies by international sports federations (IFs) to enhance the fan experience at sports events. By analysing a range of technologies, including communication platforms, real-time data tracking, artificial intelligence and immersive entertainment tools such as virtual and augmented reality, the study reveals how IFs are adapting to meet the growing demands of fans. Through a review of literature and data from officially published sources, the study highlights the most adopted technologies and their role in creating personalised, interactive and engaging experiences for spectators. The results indicate that IFs are placing an increased level of importance on these innovations as a means of improving fan engagement, event quality and overall satisfaction. However, the study also recognises the limitations of data availability and suggests directions for future research to fully capture the evolving relationship between technology and spectator experience.

Introduction

“Sports organizations have an important connection with their fan bases, but they often have superficial or incomplete knowledge of their fans”
(Deloitte, 2024).

(Deloitte, 2024) anticipate that many sports leagues and organisations will engage heavily in developing proprietary fan databases and assembling

and overseeing their own comprehensive fan data programmes in the future.

To increase engagement, loyalty, and sales, sports organisations can utilise data to target and reach supporters with personalised marketing messages, promotions, and fan experiences more effectively (Deloitte, 2024). As an example, in 2021, the NFL set a new standard for fan engagement through its partnership with Genius Sports, which leverages data-driven solutions and interactive tools to create highly personalised and immersive fan experiences across the league's ecosystem (Genius Sport, 2021). And this strategy works well, according to Deloitte data, since almost 70% of customers are more inclined to make a purchase from a company that personalises their experience than from one that doesn't. Customers, on the other hand, have grown to anticipate customised marketing and communications from the companies and brands they deal with (68% of customers claim personalisation greatly improves their brand happiness), and this is also applicable to their favourite sports teams and leagues (Deloitte, 2024).

There is a growing trend towards a more thrilling game day experience, with fans arriving early to take advantage of the entertainment zone within the stadium complex for food, shopping, and tailgating. Thus, top-level sports leagues are now generating new sources of revenue by running mixed-use entertainment areas that offer attractions all year round and reinforce links with the community. These areas usually include a mix of commerce, dining, entertainment, office, and living areas. Moreover, each of the five major sports leagues has submitted new venue plans for projects that include entertainment areas throughout the last two years (PWC, 2024). According to (PWC, 2024) prediction, every significant new venue development project that is announced in 2024 will centre around entertainment areas.

These considerations lead us to ask: "What technologies do IFs use?" and "How do IFs use these technologies to improve the quality and attractiveness of their events?". First, the relevant academic literature on the subject will be explored in order to highlight key topics and directions. Then, the methodology and key steps followed in writing this paper will be presented. The results will be described and discussed, taking into consideration the limitations identified.

Literature reviews

By taking an interest in the fan experience, it is important to clarify the differences between a sport spectator and a sport fan as they are two distinct individuals (Wann, 1995 “Sport-fan motivation scale”). Making the line between sports supporters and spectators is the first crucial step in this process (Wann, 1995, 1997). Those which are interested in, and follow a sport, team, athlete, or both are known as sport fans. Those who actively watch a sporting event in person or via media (television, radio, etc.) are known as sport spectators (sometimes called sport consumers) (Wann et al., 2001). However, the terms “sport fan” and “sport spectator” are often employed together, especially among sport researchers. In addition, these terms are not exclusive. Depending on the event or the sport a sport fan can become a simple sport spectator and inversely (Wann et al., 2001).

To better understand the issues to the success of an international sport event, we need firstly to define an event. An event had three characteristics, following the dictionary definition revealed by (Getz & Page, 2024). First, it is an occurrence at a given place and time, then it is a special set of circumstances and finally it corresponds to a noteworthy occurrence. In the article “Major international sporting events”, a definition of international sports event was given by grouping the criteria of some authors an international scope; a considerable number of participants, spectators and volunteers; appeal and extensive media coverage; high organisational expenses; significant impacts on the public and the built environment (Bourbillères, 2023). Based on this observation, we may be interested in the spectator experience aspect of this international event. “The concept of sport experience design (SX design) represents the process of enhancing customer engagement by improving the use and pleasure provided in interactions between the customer and the delivery of the sport product or service. There are three main factors that influence SX design: the sport user; the sport context; and the sport management system” (Alexandris et al., 2016).

The Literature’s review makes me realise that there is not an abundance of works in the domain of new technologies used during sports events. Nevertheless, please find below a relevant example of technology that can be used to improve fan experience in the future. Well know from the public nowadays and greatly linked with data, generative artificial intelligences have the potential to completely change the sports industry’s fan experiences. In general, sports groups have been

slow to adopt emerging technologies. However, generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) offers a chance to leverage fan data and predictive analytics to build greatly customised fan experiences. Organisations may optimise engagement strategies and provide personalised experiences for fans at the venue and at home by digitising fan data and implementing AI models. Adjusted commentary and commercials, captivating branded moments during games, and tailored suggestions for ticket purchases and halftime snacks are a few instances of GenAI-driven fan experiences (PWC, 2024).

Methods

I started my research by conducting an extensive review of the literature, concentrating on significant publications that covered the subjects pertinent to my field of study. During this initial phase, articles, books, and reports were studied to gain an understanding of the present state of the field. Through a reading of the literature, I was able to identify themes that closely matched my research topic. Concepts like the fan experience, the spectator experience, new technology, fan engagement, and international sports events were in these themes. These topics were particularly pertinent to my research because they highlight the fundamental ways that advancements in technology and interaction are changing the international world of sport.

Then, I went on to collect information from a variety of sources to form the basis of my study findings, mostly using online grey literature. I concentrated on annual reports and official publications since 2021 from all international sports federations (IFs) recognised by the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and members of the Association of Summer Olympic International Federations (ASOIF) to guarantee objectivity and credibility in my findings. Because they provide insights into the workings, innovations, and tactics of major international sports organisations, these records were of great importance. In addition to annual reports, I explored each IF's official website, especially looking for sections that addressed the subjects I had selected. To maintain coherence throughout my investigation, I used the identical terms from my examination of literature. Through this method, I was able to locate pertinent case studies and articles that demonstrated how IFs have incorporated new technology into their strategy. Lastly, I used the same terms of research and the names of each federation

to expand my search past official sources using larger internet search engines. Following data collection, I grouped the results based on the technologies being used and the innovative category they belonged to.

Results

International Sports Federations are using new technologies in various ways to make the fan experience more exciting and engaging. These technologies include real-time information, personalised content, and immersive entertainment, all of which are applied to improve how fans experience events. In this section, we will explore the most common technologies used, along with concrete examples of initiatives by different federations, and how these innovations are making a difference for fans.

One of the most used technologies by sports federations is real-time information platforms. For instance, World Athletics launched platforms that provide fans with live updates, scores, and athlete statistics during major events. As a result, fans can follow the action as it happens, regardless of where they are watching. Similarly, World Rowing offers its World Rowing App, which provides live race results, performance data, and even notifications tailored to fans' specific interests. These apps and platforms allow fans to stay connected with the event, ensuring they never miss important moments. Another notable example is the Badminton World Federation (BWF), which introduced its Badminton4U app. This app gives fans real-time data on matches, live rankings, and personalised notifications, thereby helping them stay engaged with their favourite athletes and teams. In addition to real-time updates, artificial intelligence (AI) is another crucial technology used to enhance the fan experience. FIFA, through its FIFA+ platform, utilises AI to automatically generate customised match highlights, allowing fans to rewatch their favourite moments. Moreover, AI analyses match statistics in real time, delivering tailored content that suits each fan's interests, making the viewing experience more engaging and individualised. Similarly, World Taekwondo has adopted AI to improve fan engagement through initiatives like the World Taekwondo Replays, which offer real-time, AI-driven event analysis. This technology breaks down each match, offering fans insights into the athletes' performance and match dynamics, which in turn enhances their understanding and enjoyment of the sport.

Entertainment technologies are also widely used to bring fans closer to the action. For example, World Taekwondo uses instant replay and highlight systems through its Taekwondo Replay initiative, allowing fans to relive the most exciting moments of each match. This system provides immediate replays during live broadcasts, helping fans stay engaged even after key moments have passed. In a similar manner, the International Golf Federation introduced advanced broadcast features as part of its Golf TV platform. This platform offers fans multiple camera angles, enhanced sound, and real-time feedback on player performance, thus creating an immersive viewing experience. Fans can easily switch between different angles and focus on their favourite players, making them feel as though they are right in the middle of the action. Furthermore, World Sailing has made significant strides with its SailGP App, which includes augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) features. Fans can access 360-degree views of the racecourses, track boats in real time, and view live stats overlaid on the video feed. These immersive technologies allow fans to feel more involved in the sport, even when they are watching remotely.

Discussion

The adoption of new technologies by international sports federations (IFs) reveals clear tendencies to enhance the fan experience. Communication technologies, such as social media and interactive applications, increase fan engagement by creating more personalised and real-time interactions. Educational tools, such as live data tracking, give fans a better understanding of events, while entertainment technologies, such as virtual reality and enhanced screens, make viewing more immersive and engaging. Together, these innovations make sporting events more tangible and create more engaging and dynamic experiences for fans, boosting both satisfaction and loyalty.

Firstly, communication technologies are among the most frequently adopted tools across federations such as the Badminton World Federation (BWF) and the Fédération Équestre Internationale (FEI). These technologies are primarily employed to strengthen fan interaction and increase visibility. Social media, digital campaigns, and fan engagement platforms allow federations to establish a direct line of communication with their audience. The BWF, for example, uses social media and vlogs as part of its #SuperSmashSquad campaign to connect

fans with athletes, offering exclusive behind-the-scenes content. Similarly, the FEI's use of communication technologies in fan engagement campaigns, such as #MyDreamJumpChallenge, allows fans to actively participate in the event narrative. These initiatives are essential for federations wishing to make their events more attractive to the public. They also encourage real-time interaction and customised experiences for fans.

Secondly, educational technologies play a role in providing fans with detailed information and real-time data. Federations such as the BWF and FEI are using educational and information technologies to improve the accessibility of live match data, statistics and performance analysis. For example, the BWF's Badminton4U application allows fans to access live match data, rankings and player statistics in real time. This not only improves the quality of the spectator experience by providing more in-depth information, but also makes the sport more attractive to fans looking for detailed analysis. Similarly, the FEI has integrated performance dashboards into its events, giving fans and participants access to detailed performance metrics. By making this information available on digital platforms, these federations increase transparency and encourage fan involvement, which ultimately improves the overall quality of events.

Furthermore, entertainment technologies are also largely used to enhance the visual and auditory experience of events. The BWF's use of SXFI LIVE audio holography is an example of how a federation can create immersive experiences for fans watching from a distance. This technology allows fans to experience audio as if they were in the arena, making the visual experience more engaging. In addition, FIBA's introduction of LED glass floors at basketball events shows how federations are using new visual technologies to enhance the spectacle of live events. The integration of these technologies not only improves the attractiveness of the event for the public, but also offers new marketing and visibility opportunities for sponsors, contributing to the overall commercial success of the event.

In comparing the different IFs, it is clear that they all focus on technologies that promote fan engagement and interactivity. Communication technologies, in particular, are a common feature of many federations, reflecting a wider trend towards digital fan engagement. Social media campaigns, interactive applications and live streaming platforms are essential tools for federations looking to attract a younger audience and create a more dynamic relationship with their fan base. However, the use of educational and entertainment technologies varies more

significantly between federations, with some prioritising data analysis and others focusing on enhancing the spectacle of the event.

To answer the first question of the problem, which was: Which technologies are used by IFs? An analysis within the different categories is necessary to observe the technologies directly. Those most commonly used by IFs are social networking technologies, mobile applications and streaming platforms, which enable direct, personalised interaction with fans. Otherwise, the use of real-time data, artificial intelligence and virtual/augmented reality solutions are also often solicited. They contribute to making events more immersive, engaging and attractive. It is therefore easy to imagine that the use of these technologies will vary according to the specific objectives of the federation, its audience and, above all, its resources.

As for the second question, how are IFs using these technologies to improve the quality and appeal of their events? The IFs use them to make their events more interactive, informative and visually appealing. Communication technologies, for example, allow federations to interact with fans in real time, creating a sense of community and involvement. Educational technologies give fans access to in-depth statistics and analysis, enhancing their understanding and appreciation of the sport. Entertainment technologies, create a more captivating atmosphere, both for spectators on site and for those watching from a distance. Collectively, these technologies contribute to a more modern and engaging experience for fans, making sporting events more attractive in an increasingly competitive entertainment market. This combination of sport and entertainment, widely recognised in the field of sports marketing, is often referred to as 'sportainment'.

Limits

While this study provides insights into how International Sports Federations (IFs) are using new technologies to improve the fan experience, there are several limitations that need to be considered. Firstly, much of the data comes from grey literature and official sources like annual reports and websites. Since these sources tend to highlight only the positive aspects, or the elements that the IFs would like to share, thus the study may not fully reflect the challenges or failures federations face when adopting new technologies. In addition, the study focuses on data from 2021 onwards. Although this ensures the findings are up to date,

it may overlook earlier initiatives that could provide a better understanding of long-term trends.

Moreover, by concentrating only on federations recognised by the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and members of the Association of Summer Olympic International Federations (ASOIF), the study may miss out on innovations from other sports organisations that are not linked to the Olympics. Furthermore, in this study primary data collection, such as interviews with federation staff, technology providers, or fans are not included. As a result, it is harder to fully assess how well these technologies are being implemented or received by different stakeholders. Additionally, while using consistent search terms helped to keep the study focused, it may have limited the scope by overlooking initiatives that were described differently. Therefore, broadening the range of search terms could lead to more varied and comprehensive findings. Additionally, future research is important to fill these gaps and provide a clearer picture of how new technologies impact the fan experience. By including more direct feedback from fans and staff, and looking at other sports beyond Olympic federations, future studies could offer deeper insights and help improve how these technologies are used to improve spectator experience.

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Appendix

Appendix A - List of technologies by International Sport Federation

Federation	Technology Class	Technologies Used	Initiatives
Badminton World Federation	Communication Technology	Social Media, Vlogs, Interviews	#SuperSmashSquad Campaign
Badminton World Federation	Educational Technology, Information Technology	Badminton4U App, Real-time Data, Rankings	Enhanced Badminton4U App
Badminton World Federation	Entertainment Technology	SXFI LIVE (Creative), Audio Holography	Holographic Audio in Live Broadcasts
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Communication Technology	Fan Engagement Campaigns	Longines My Dream Jump Challenge
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Communication Technology	Digital Campaigns	Digital Campaigns (#MyDreamJumpChallenge, #TimeToBeat)
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Entertainment Technology	Online Fan Shop	FEI Fan Shop
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Entertainment Technology	LED Screens and Enhanced Graphics	Enhanced Visual Presentation
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Information Technology	TackApp and Equipment Database	FEI TackApp and Equipment Database
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Information Technology	Centralized Hub	FEI Hub
Fédération Equestre Internationale	Information Technology	Live Tracking Technology	Live Tracking Technology
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Communication Technology	Mobile Apps and Social Platforms	Expansion of Mobile Apps and Social Platforms
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Entertainment Technology	Esports (NBA 2K23)	Launch of eFIBA
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Entertainment Technology	Betting (J9)	Partnership with J9
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Entertainment Technology, Information Technology	Streaming Platforms (Twitch)	Collaboration with Twitch
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Information Technology	Website : collaboration with Google	Google Partnership
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Information Technology	Direct-to-Consumer Platform (Courtside 1891)	Launch of Courtside 1891
Fédération Internationale de Basketball	Manufacturing Technology	LED Glass Floor	Introduction of LED Glass Floor
Fédération Internationale d'Escrime	Communication Technology	Social Media Engagement	Social Media Engagement
Fédération Internationale d'Escrime	Communication Technology	Digital Content Creation	Digital Content
Fédération Internationale d'Escrime	Communication Technology	Media Partnerships	Media Partnerships (Eurosport, CNN)
Fédération Internationale d'Escrime	Communication Technology	Digital Magazine	ESCRIME XXI Magazine
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Artificial Intelligence	AI and Communication Technologies (VAR)	AI and VAR Technologies
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Artificial Intelligence	FIFA Player App	FIFA Player App
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Artificial Intelligence	Real-Time Ball and Player Tracking	Real-Time Tracking Technology
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Artificial Intelligence	Semi-Automated Offside Technology (SAOT)	SAOT
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Artificial Intelligence	Connected Ball Technology	Connected Ball
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Communication Technology	Accessibility Measures	Accessibility Measures
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Communication Technology	Trophy Tour and Activations	Trophy Tour and Activations
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Entertainment Technology	FIFA Fan Festivals	FIFA Fan Festivals
Fédération Internationale de Football Association	Information Technology	FIFA+ Platform	FIFA+
Fédération Internationale de Gymnastique	Artificial Intelligence	AI	Future AI Developments for Judging and Coaching
Fédération Internationale de Gymnastique	Artificial Intelligence	Fujitsu Judgment Support System (JSS)	Fujitsu JSS
Fédération Internationale de Gymnastique	Entertainment Technology	Streaming Technology	All Gymnastics Digital Platform
Fédération Internationale de Gymnastique	Entertainment Technology	Swiss Timing Innovations	Trampoline Gymnastics World Championships 2023
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Communication Technology	Fan Engagement Initiatives	Various Fan Engagement Initiatives
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Communication Technology	FIH Family Account	FIH Family Account
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Information Technology	Watch.Hockey	Watch.Hockey
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Information Technology	Hockey Data Hub	Hockey Data Hub
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Information Technology	Digital Media Assets Management	Digital Media Assets Management
Fédération Internationale de Hockey	Information Technology	FIH TMS and Sport Data Dashboard	FIH TMS and Sport Data Dashboard
Fédération Internationale de Volleyball	Artificial Intelligence	WSC Sports AI, VolleyStation, Deltatre's FORGE Platform	Digital and Commercial Initiatives
Fédération Internationale de Volleyball	Entertainment Technology	VNL Fantasy Game, Bolt6 Partnership	Fan Engagement and Challenge System Enhancement
Fédération Internationale de Volleyball	Information Technology	CVC Capital Partners, Infront Lab's Stream Engine	Volleyball World, CEV's OTT Platform Upgrade
International Canoe Federation	Artificial Intelligence	AI (Alibaba Cloud)	Partnership with Alibaba Cloud
International Canoe Federation	Artificial Intelligence	Event Sustainability Tools (Alibaba Cloud)	Alibaba Cloud Summit
International Canoe Federation	Communication Technology	Social Media Campaigns	Campaign #Paddle100
International Canoe Federation	Green and Clean Technology	Event Management Tools (Alibaba Cloud)	Partnership with Alibaba Cloud
International Canoe Federation	Transportation Technology	Electric Vehicles (BYD)	Partnership with BYD
International Federation of Sport Climbing	Entertainment Technology	Sponsorship	New Sponsorship with Toyo Tires
International Federation of Sport Climbing	Information Technology	Digital Platform (FORGE)	Digital Transformation
International Golf Federation	Entertainment Technology	VR Game	Olympic Esports Week 2023 : Golf+

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International Golf Federation	Entertainment Technology	Game console	Olympic Esports Week 2023 : 2K Games
International Golf Federation	Entertainment Technology	Golf Simulators	Olympic Esports Week 2023 : Trackman and Full Swing (
International Golf Federation	Entertainment Technology	TGL (Tech-infused Golf League)	Partnership with TMWR Sports
International Handball Federation	Educational Technology	Rule Interpretation App	Rule Interpretation App
International Handball Federation	Educational Technology, Information Technology	Education Centre Upgrade	IHF Education Centre Revamp
International Handball Federation	Entertainment Technology	VR System	Video Review (VR) System
International Handball Federation	Information Technology	OTT Platform	New IHF TV Platform
International Handball Federation	Information Technology	Sportradar Partnership	Media and Integrity
International Judo Federation	-	-	-
International Surfing Association	Communication Technology	Modern Web Design	New Website Launch
International Shooting Sport Federation	Information Technology	Website Redesign, Radar Technology, Virtual Reality (VR)	Digital and Technological Advancements
International Tennis Federation	Entertainment Technology	Wildlife Studios (Esports), Mobile Game	Esports and Digital Engagement
International Tennis Federation	Information Technology	World Tennis Number (WTN), Cloud Migration	Digital Transformation and Services
International Tennis Federation	Information Technology	Website, Mobile Apps, WeChat Mini Programs	Platform Enhancements
International Tennis Federation	Information Technology	Sportradar, Infront	Partnerships and Innovation
International Table Tennis Federation	Artificial Intelligence	Hawk-Eye Technology	Upcoming Implementation
International Table Tennis Federation	Artificial Intelligence, Entertainment Technology	AI Stats, Dolby Atmos, VR	Digital Innovation
International Table Tennis Federation	Communication Technology	Mobile Apps, WeChat Mini Programs	Improved Fan Interaction
International Table Tennis Federation	Information Technology	Website	Website Relaunch
International Table Tennis Federation	Information Technology	New Sponsorships	Secured Global Premier Partners
International Weightlifting Federation	Entertainment Technology	Online Youth World Cup	Technology Adoption
International Weightlifting Federation	Green and Clean Technology	Event Modernization	Rebranding and Modernization
International Weightlifting Federation	Information Technology	Digital Strategy by Redtorch, SPORTFIVE	Digital Strategy and Fan Engagement
Union Cycliste Internationale	Artificial Intelligence	QR Codes and Social Media Integration	QR Codes and Social Media Integration
Union Cycliste Internationale	Entertainment Technology	Gamification	Gamification in Fan Engagement
Union Cycliste Internationale	Entertainment Technology	Reward Platform (My World of Cycling)	My World of Cycling
Union Internationale de Pentathlon Moderne	Communication Technology	Social Media Campaign	Engagement on Social Media
United World Wrestling	Communication Technology	Social Media and Streaming	Performance Metrics
United World Wrestling	Educational Technology, Information Technology	UWW Academy	Educational Resources and Online Courses
United World Wrestling	Information Technology	Data Utilization	Enhanced Fan Management
United World Wrestling	Information Technology	UWW+, N3XT Sports, CRM Solutions, SSO	Digital Transformation and Growth
World Aquatics	Communication Technology	Social Media	Social media engagement and targeting younger generations
World Aquatics	Entertainment Technology, Information Technology	Hybrid Streaming	Hybrid streaming model managed in-house
World Aquatics	Information Technology	New website and digital platform development	Pulselive
World Archery	Artificial Intelligence	Dizplai, QTV, Real-time Dynamic Graphics	Real-time graphics and fan participation
World Archery	Entertainment Technology	VR (Funique), YouTube, Virtual Reality	VR broadcast at Taipei Open
World Archery	Entertainment Technology	Automatic Scoring Systems (ITSport), Gamification	Automatic scoring system and gamification
World Athletics	Entertainment Technology	Mobile Gaming (TapNation)	Launch of 'Athletics Rush'
World Athletics	Information Technology	Calendar synchronization tool	Event synchronization
World Athletics	Information Technology	Event configuration	Pioneering Change 2024-2027
World Athletics	Information Technology	Fan database	Pioneering Change 2024-2027
World Athletics	Information Technology	Performance measurement	Pioneering Change 2024-2027
World Athletics	Information Technology	Automatic measurement systems	Innovation in event technologies
World Rowing	Communication Technology	TikTok, Instagram, WeChat	Expansion on Social Media
World Rowing	Entertainment Technology	EXR App (Salty Lemon Entertainment)	EXR Digital Application
World Rowing	Information Technology	Deloitte Sports Group, Charles Russell Speechlys	Strategic Commercial Partnership
World Rowing	Information Technology	Indoor/Connected Rowing	Development of Indoor/Connected Rowing
World Rowing	Information Technology	Video, QR Codes	Video Content Production and QR Code Usage
World Rowing	Information Technology	IRIS	Partnership with IRIS for Data Analysis
World Rugby	Entertainment Technology	Genius Sports	New Digital Gamification Strategy
World Rugby	Entertainment Technology	Genius Sports	Interactive Digital Strategy with Genius Sports
World Rugby	Entertainment Technology	Various	Phased Plan to Enhance Rugby's Global Appeal
World Rugby	Information Technology	Capgemini	Enhancing Fan Engagement
World Rugby	Information Technology	Wiz-Team	Tournament Management System (TMS)
World Rugby	Information Technology	Opta, Capgemini	Technological Enhancements for Rugby World Cup 2023
World Rugby	Information Technology	Various (Shape of the Game Forums)	Shape of the Game Forums
World Sailing	Entertainment Technology	AR, VR, LiveLineFX Technology	SailGP's AR and VR App Experience
World Skate	Information Technology	Live Scoring	Partnership with LiveHeats
World Taekwondo	Entertainment Technology	Virtual AXIS, Gamification	Virtual Taekwondo
World Taekwondo	Entertainment Technology	Advanced Video Replays	Tokyo 2020 Innovations
World Taekwondo	Entertainment Technology	PSS (Protective Scoring System)	Ongoing Developments
World Taekwondo	Entertainment Technology	Power Bar	Gamification and Viewer Experience
World Taekwondo	Information Technology	Safety Measures	Random Weigh-Ins
World Triathlon	Artificial Intelligence	RaceRanger	Anti-Drafting Technology
World Triathlon	Entertainment Technology	Super League Triathlon, Zwift	Arena Games Triathlon World Championship Series
World Triathlon	Information Technology	Website Redesign, WCAG Standards	Website Design and Navigation
World Triathlon	Information Technology	TriathlonLive	Platform Evolution

OLYMPIC GAMES AND THE OLYMPIC SPIRIT HELP SOLVE HOT SOCIAL ISSUES

Zhihao JIANG (CHN)

Abstract

The Olympic Games and the spirits shown by it concentrate various merits of human beings which are eternally immutable. Nowadays, the society is filled up with challenging hot social issues including peace and solidarity, economic development, climate change and sustainable development, cultural conflict and communication, etc. By analysing how the Olympic Games and spirits prompt to solve these social issues, this article hopes to help spread the Olympic spirit and contribute to the development of the society.

Keywords: Olympic Games, the Olympic spirit, hot social issues

1. Introduction

Olympic Games are the world's largest comprehensive games hosted by the International Olympic Committee. They are hosted every four years and they are the world's most influential sports event. From the perspective of the holding time, the Olympic Games can be divided into Summer Olympic Games and Winter Olympic Games; when it comes to the competitors, they consist of Olympic and Paralympic Games. The Olympic Games originated in ancient Greece more than two thousand years ago and got their name because of the venue in Olympia. Fifteen hundred years after the ancient Olympic Games were suspended, Frenchman Pierre de Coubertin proposed the idea of holding the modern Olympic Games at the end of the 19th century. The International

Olympic Committee was established in 1894. The first Olympic Games and Winter Olympics were held in 1896 and 1924 respectively.

The Olympic Spirit is the core value of the modern Olympic Games. It includes mutual understanding, lasting friendship, solidarity and fair play. This spirit not only reflects the essence of sport, but also reflects the pursuit of peace, friendship and unity of mankind¹. The Olympic spirit originated from ancient Greek civilisation, emphasising the spirit of “faster, stronger and higher”, and the spirit of fairness, justice, equality and freedom of sports competition. It emphasises health, optimism, and a good attitude toward life, and combines various qualities of body, mind and spirit in a balanced way. The 138th Plenary session of the IOC voted to change the Olympic motto to “Faster, Higher, Stronger, Together”. The proposal of “Together” is not only the International Olympic Committee’s rethinking of human sustainable development under the crisis of pluralistic consensus, but also the value and connotation of the Olympic Games in the new era².

2. Olympic Games and the Olympic Spirit Help Solve Hot Social Issues

Nowadays, the society is filled up with challenging hot social issues including peace and solidarity, economic development, climate change and sustainable development, cultural conflict and communication, etc. By the holding of Olympic Games and the spread of the Olympic spirit, these issues can be resolved or alleviated.

2.1 Peace and Solidarity

Mankind needs peace and the prosperity of the world needs solidarity. Peace is the absence of war in human society, and the consequences of war are the destruction of stable life, the destruction of countless rural towns and the death

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1. Xie Weidong. *The Olympic Spirit* [M]. Beijing: China Joint Press for Industry and Commerce, 2007.
 2. Li Yan. From “Faster, Higher, Stronger” to “Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together”: The essence and rise of the Olympic spirit [J]. *Journal of Sports and Science*. 2021, 42(5): 20-26.

of thousands of people. Therefore, since the day of war, human society has had a vision of peaceful life and efforts for peace.

Since ancient times, the holding of Olympic Games has been contributing to the cease of war and peace³. In the 8th century BC, slave city-states emerged in Greece after the collapse of the Aegean civilisation. There was no unified monarch, so the city-states were at war all day long, and the people longed for peace. In 884 BC, the Kings of Elis and Sparta reached an agreement and signed the Olympic Truce. The treaty stipulates that during the Olympic Games, all countries must truce, and prepare to participate in the Olympic Games. Even if there is a war, the warring sides must declare a truce. The initial period of the truce was one month, but as the number of countries participating in the Olympics increased, the truce was extended to three months. As an international high-level sports event with the largest number of participating countries, which makes it the most influential, the concept of “peace” has been passed on. In 1992, the United Nations sanctioned Yugoslavia and banned its athletes from international competition, and it is the first time that sport was included in the sanctions. Under the joint initiative of the Olympic Committee and the United Nations, the warring sides of Bosnia and Herzegovina stopped fighting during the Olympic Games.

Taking a cue, the Olympic Committee revived the “Olympic Truce” on July 21. The following year, 121 countries unanimously adopted a “truce” at the United Nations General Assembly, and every time before the start of the Olympics, the United Nations urged the warring parties to stop fighting. This rule did work in several wars. As Edstrom, the fourth president of the International Olympic Committee, said, “The Olympic Games cannot impose peace, but they provide an opportunity for the youth of the world to come together as brothers”.

2.2 Economic Development

Summer Olympics are growing with larger media coverage and sponsorship, and give host cities opportunities to develop tourism and pursue other likely economic effects that occur by staging such a special event. Studies have pointed to the long-term benefits of the Games, such as “new event facilities and

3. Song Jixin. The Pursuit of Peace of Olympic Games – Push the way of the Stability of Beijing Olympic Games and Research the Rising of China Peace [J]. *Journal of Sports and Science*, 2004, 25(5): 43-46.

infrastructure, urban regeneration, enhanced international reputation, increased tourism, as well as improved public welfare, increased employment, local business opportunities and corporate relocation”⁴. Existing studies show that the Olympic Games not only have direct economic impact on the host country in terms of consumption, investment and foreign trade, but also affect economic development through indirect channels, such as strengthening residents’ identity, shaping national brands, managing the natural environment and enhancing political ties. Some countries take advantage of the opportunity of hosting the Olympic Games to promote their own economic benefits in the short term by increasing consumer spending, improving infrastructure construction, and upgrading industrial structure.

The Beijing Olympic Games have brought huge economic growth benefits to China, and with the promotion of the government, hosting the Olympic Games has successfully unleashed China’s growth potential. A study conducted by Ding, Zhu and Sun shows that from 2003 to 2010, the total economic impact of the Beijing Olympic Games reached 71.706 billion US dollars, of which the direct impact was about 58.5%; in the seven years after the end of the Beijing Olympics, the average annual growth of China’s economy was 0.3%; in 2009, total retail sales of consumer goods increased by 0.6% over the same period last year. In the three years after the Beijing Olympics, the average annual growth rate of China’s fixed asset investment remained at 22%-25%⁵.

The Los Angeles Olympics (1984) was one of the most successful business model innovations in modern Olympic history. Organising Committee Chairman Peter Ueberroth introduced a market-based model of private sector funding, sponsorship, and television rights auctions, making Los Angeles the first profitable summer Olympics. Through smart commercial operations, the Los Angeles Organising Committee eventually realised a profit of \$225 million, which not only offset all costs but also greatly improved the city’s infrastructure and international visibility.

The Barcelona Olympics (1992) also demonstrated the economic impact

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4. Evangelia Kasimati. Economic Aspects and the Summer Olympics: a Review of Related Research [J]. *International Journal of Tourism Research*, 2003, 5: 433-444.
 5. Ding Huanfeng, Zhu Yuxi, Sun Xiaozhe. Asymmetric Effects of Hosting the Olympic Games on Host Country Economic Growth: New Evidence from a Quasi-natural Experiment [J]. *Journal of Shanghai University of Sport*, 2022, 46(12): 82-93.

of the Games. After winning the bid, Barcelona began to build infrastructure until the Games were held. The total economic impact reached \$16.266 billion, half of which came from investments by authorities and private capital in the construction of hotels and private housing. After the Olympic Games, Barcelona's tourism industry has been unprecedented development and the city's economic structure has been optimised. What's more, the city's image has been greatly improved, and a large number of domestic and foreign investment has been attracted.

The Sydney Olympic Games (2000) not only enhanced the country's international status by hosting the Games, but also promoted the development of related industries such as construction and service industries during the preparation and hosting process. According to statistics, the Sydney Olympics brought about \$6.3 billion approximately in additional tourism revenue to Australia, and boosted employment and regional economic growth.

Although the initial investment of the Olympic Games is huge, the comprehensive benefit is difficult to measure. Not only are they sporting events, they also bring opportunities for cultural showcase, economic growth and international recognition to the host country.

2.3 Climate Change and Sustainable Development

International Olympic Committee President Thomas Bach admitted in an interview with AFP that due to the impact of global warming, the future summer Olympics may have to move from the traditional July and August to the cooler autumn, "the future international sports calendar may be completely different from what we are used to now".

From wildfires in Australia and extremely high temperatures in California to flooding everywhere, climate change is threatening our very existence. Progress on key climate change indicators such as Earth's surface warming, glacier retreat and sea level rise is accelerating, which will have a major impact on Asia's social, economic and ecological systems, according to the World Meteorological Organisation's "State of Asia's Climate 2023". In 2023, sea surface temperatures in the Northwest Pacific reached the highest ever recorded, and even the Arctic Ocean experienced a Marine heat wave.

In this rapid-urbanisation era, Olympic Games are quite useful in addressing the looming sustainability challenges for cities: "reducing greenhouse gas

emissions, guaranteeing social peace and justice, providing sustainable mobility and curbing urban mega-project”⁶. In the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympic Games, China presented a wonderful, extraordinary and outstanding Olympic Games to the world, delivering a perfect answer to the world’s green, low-carbon and sustainable development, and providing the world with a Chinese solution to energy conservation and emission reduction. As early as June 23, 2019, on the International Olympic Day, the Beijing Organising Committee of the Winter Olympics officially released the “Low-carbon Management Work Plan for the Beijing 2022 Olympic and Paralympic Winter Games”, which proposed 18 measures in four aspects, including low-carbon energy, low-carbon venues, low-carbon transportation, and taking the lead in reducing carbon emissions generated by the Beijing Winter Olympics as much as possible. At the same time, it put forward carbon compensation measures such as forestry carbon sequestration, enterprise independent action and carbon GSP. Since the release of the “Low Carbon Plan”, the Beijing Winter Olympic Organising Committee has worked closely with the Beijing Municipal and Hebei Provincial governments to promote the implementation of various measures and achieved positive results.

In the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics, the torch was designed as a “glimmer fire”, whose emission is only one thousand of the 2008 Beijing Summer Olympic torch. And instead of using natural gas or propane and other gases as fuel, this Olympic Games using hydrogen energy as the torch energy, which is the first time in the history of the Olympic Games using hydrogen energy as the torch energy.

In order to, better achieve energy saving and emission reduction, carbon emissions in the field of transportation cannot be ignored, and promoting the development of energy conservation in the field of transportation is of great significance to achieve the strategic goal of low carbon-emission in China. In the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics, energy-saving and clean energy vehicles accounted for more than 80% of the vehicles during the Games. The use of lightweight technology, environmentally friendly degradable materials, graphene air purifier, grey water reuse system to jointly create a green and low-carbon space for the Winter Olympics. From the perspective of building

6. Martin, M. et al. An evaluation of the sustainability of the Olympic Games [J]. *Nature sustainability*, 2021, 4: 340-348.

energy conservation, the venue has established an energy conservation system, including controlling the volume of the new venue, enhancing the use of natural ventilation and lighting, and improving the energy operation level of the venue, which reduces the overall impact of the ice venue on the environment and improves the operation efficiency of the venue.

2.4 Cultural Conflict and Communication

Sport has the quality of a universal language that is simple and clear, necessary for daily life, and involving everyone. The simple quality of sport, accessible to all, provides an effective means of international exchange. Sports exchange has a unique role in promoting fitness and leisure, building civilised etiquette, leading social customs, enhancing people's physical fitness, improving national quality, promoting social harmony, and improving the degree of social spiritual civilization. The practice of the Olympic Games has proved that only through sports exchanges can sports value be better reflected. International sports exchanges such as the Olympic Games have become a unique activity of human society, which has produced comprehensive social functions and values such as politics, economy, culture and education. Even the social effects of Olympic sports exchanges are unexpected.

In the era of mass communication, international large-scale sports events are regarded as an important platform to show national image and national soft power. The bidding of the modern Olympic Games is related to the display and competition of the country's comprehensive strength. Olympic sports communication has been given more meaning beyond cultural exchange. The Olympic Games, as a visual landscape jointly created by power, capital and technology, is the physical expression and visual construction of the values and Olympic spirit of the Olympic host country⁷.

The opening and closing ceremonies of the Olympic Games will make all kinds of media act at the same time and focus the audience's attention for a short time, which means that discussions will be held around various aspects of the topic, including the preparation of the opening ceremony and the closing ceremony, the on-site effect and the influence of the programme, etc. In a short

7. Luo Zhengli. Spectacle Manufacturing and value spreading of the Olympic Games [J]. *Journal of Sports and Science*, 2016, 37(6): 54-60.

period of time, such discussions will be concentrated and released by the media such as radio, television and social media, forming a public opinion field and media spectacle of the Olympic Games. At the same time, under the media communication offensive, the potential influence of media spectacle events will gradually enlarge.

The modern Olympic Games plays a key role in the global cultural exchanges, and the Olympic movement has become a public value recognised by the world with its unique form and content, moral code and way of thinking. In other words, since the birth of the modern Olympic Movement, it has fulfilled the intermediary function of enhancing the understanding and mutual trust between different countries and different nations, and has become a “stage medium” for cultural exchanges. By embedding the Olympic culture in the Olympic Games, the host country focuses on the global attention resources with the help of the “focus effect” of the Olympic Games, so as to realise the cultural exchanges among countries in the world. And this kind of communication is easier for the public to understand and accept⁸. From the perspective of communication, international sports events are a physical space media formed on the basis of high mobility and short-term movement on a relatively large scale. Due to its scarcity, the quadrennial Olympic Games have become a special platform for cultural exchanges between different ethnic groups around the world in a short time⁹.

The 2022 Beijing Winter Olympic Games is one of the largest and most influential international sporting events, serving as a great stage to show a multidimensional national image of China to people of various nations. Scholars have pointed out that the Beijing Winter Olympics has promoted cultural exchanges through a number of measures. First of all, the opening ceremony emphasised the mainstream consensus of the world – “Together for the Future”, which echoes the Olympic spirit of “Together”. Secondly, designers use visual symbols beyond language to convey the common aesthetic and spirit of mankind. In addition, the organisers of the event actively integrated the

8. Liu Bin, Li Yao. Evaluation of the soft power of Chinese culture promoted by the Beijing Olympics [J]. *Press Circles*, 2010(5): 25-26.

9. Zhang Yuqiang, Pang Min. Re-examination of Values of International Communication of Modern Olympic Games [J]. *Journal of Wuhan Institute of Physical Education*, 2022, 56(1): 13-19.

emotional memory that resonated with the world in the opening ceremony, awakening the emotional empathy of the hosts and guests, and realising a wide range of emotional identification¹⁰.

3. Conclusion

Inspired by the Olympic spirit and carefully planned by the International Olympic Organising Committee, the modern Olympic Games have gone through 128 years. The Olympic spirit is still continuing to inherit and develop, integrated with the excellent spirit of all nationalities, encouraging people to continue to strive towards “Higher, Faster, Stronger, Together”, and pushing human civilisation to a new chapter.

From the perspective of the Olympic Games and the Olympic spirit to promote the solution of social hot issues, including peace and solidarity, economic development, climate change and sustainable development, cultural conflict and communication, this paper hopes to enhance people’s understanding of the Olympic Games and promote the spread of the Olympic spirit.

10. Zeng Zihan. Cross-cultural Empathic Communication of National Image: Analysis of International Communication Strategies and Effects of the Beijing Winter Olympic Games[J]. *Asian Social Science*, 2022, 18(11): 1-4.

THE OLYMPIC IDEALS IN CURRENT EDUCATION AND THEIR SOCIAL UTILITY AS A STRATEGY FOR CONFLICT REDUCTION: THEIR APPLICATION THROUGH TCHOUKBALL

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1. Object of study

It is proposed the application of the ideals of Olympism in the current educational context using *Tchoukball* as a strategy, to solve certain problems generated during recess and Physical Education classes, in a Secondary School center in the Community of Madrid, focusing on the following principles of the Olympic Charter:

“2.– The goal of Olympism is to place sport at the service of the harmonious development of humankind, with a view to promoting a peaceful society concerned with the preservation of human dignity.

4.– The practice of sport is a human right. Every individual must have access to the practice of sport, without discrimination of any kind in respect of internationally recognised human rights within the remit of the Olympic Movement. The Olympic spirit requires mutual understanding with a spirit of friendship, solidarity and fair play.

1. Paula Navas Cordero participated in the IOA Seminar and presented the paper.

6.– *The enjoyment of the rights and freedoms set forth in this Olympic Charter shall be secured without discrimination of any kind, such as race, colour, sex, sexual orientation, language, religion, political or other opinion, national or social origin, property, birth or other status*". (International Olympic Committee, 2024, pp. 8-9).

2. Objectives

- **Identify and address the strengths and weaknesses in Physical Education Teaching at a Secondary Education center in the Community of Madrid.** To know the characteristics and resources of Physical Education in the educational center and to locate and identify its weaknesses in: programming, available resources, and attention to diversity, in order to propose solutions by putting into practice the principles of the Olympic ideals.
- **Promote the application of the aforementioned Olympic principles** in the center under study, actively and daily transmitting: the equal human right to sports practice, solidarity, and fair play. We aim not only to transmit these values among the students but also to foster an inclusive and respectful school environment, where everyone has equal access to sports practice, regardless of their personal characteristics.
- **Use Tchoukball as a conflict resolution strategy.** Having identified the specific challenges of the first objective regarding conflicts during recess, which arise from playing football, *Tchoukball* is proposed as a strategy to address and mitigate these conflicts by including it in the Physical Education programme and as a recreational activity in the school yards. Its focus on cooperation, mutual respect, and peaceful dispute resolution provides an effective alternative to traditional sports that generate tensions among students and will foster an atmosphere of peaceful and collaborative coexistence.
- **Promote active student participation in their learning.** Students will be involved in the planning, execution, and evaluation of the theoretical and practical activities of *Tchoukball*. This will provide

them with greater autonomy and responsibility, promoting the development of social, emotional, and problem-solving skills through collaboration and teamwork.

The aim is to provide students with tools to become active agents of change in their educational environment, promoting values of inclusion, respect, and solidarity in their school community in direct alignment with the ideals of Olympism and with the goal of the athlete being an inspiration for ethical behaviour.

3. Methodology and methodological design

By consulting the school's archives for the *Educational Project* documents and its *Programming* and using the *document analysis* technique, information was extracted about the characteristics of Physical Education (PE) developed to analyse the resources for PE teaching (human, material, technological, and spatial), the circumstances of the PE subject (annual, course, and session), attention to diversity (as reflected in the school project and programming, which was also observed in classroom sessions), and the connection of PE with extracurricular and complementary activities.

The instruments and data collection techniques were: a checklist and a rating scale for the evaluation of classroom teaching programmes, direct observation for the analysis of teaching during the teaching-learning (T-L) process; and an *interview* with the head of the Physical Education department.

By comparing the obtained data and information, the strengths and weaknesses related to PE were identified. Among the weaknesses identified were conflicts in the schoolyards, mainly due to playing football, confirming that the situation affects the development of the yards and carries over into PE classes.

After this analysis of the description of the reference framework, by investigating specialised literature and relying on studies from recent years on the subject, direct relationships with the Olympic ideals were established as an alternative to social conflicts, for subsequent application.

At the end of the methodological process, a didactic proposal was made to address the described and contextualised weakness: a programming unit of *Tchoukball* through the development and specific attention to the values already outlined in the *Olympic Charter*, along with the development of its different elements, as well as its monitoring and evaluation.

4. Practical proposal

4.1. *Presentation of the Unit*

In this section of the proposal development, we will detail the different strategies to be followed in order to address the chosen weakness, which involves the conflict situations that have arisen in the mentioned yards and their influence on the development of PE in the educational center.

For this Programming Unit (PU), we have chosen the sport of *Tchoukball*. According to the *International Tchoukball Federation* (FITB), it is a team sport invented in the 1970s by Dr. Hermann Brandt, with the purpose of promoting sportsmanship and equitable participation of all players (FITB, 2021b). The objective of the game is to throw a ball against a rebound frame and prevent the opposing team from catching it before it touches the ground outside the prohibited area. Two teams of seven players each participate on a rectangular field. A ball similar to the one that is used in handball, made of rubber, is used. At each end of the field, there will be a rebound frame, surrounded by a prohibited area with a radius of 3 meters. A characteristic aspect of this sport is the emphasis on player safety, always prohibiting physical contact, as well as active defence (Barnechea Álvarez, 2010).

The FITB states that this sport is based on a series of values and principles, such as respect, cooperation, inclusion, and equality, always promoting *fair play* (FITB, 2021a). Fair play is emphasised, and the participation of all players is encouraged, regardless of their skill or gender, allowing for mixed teams. With all these characteristics, we can see how this sport fosters personal and social development, teamwork, and overcoming challenges, which earns it the name “the sport of peace”, and therefore, it is closely related to the ideals of Olympism.

4.2. *Development of the proposal*

Our proposal is aimed at students in the 3rd year of Compulsory Secondary Education (ESO). The intention is for these students, who will be in the 4th year of ESO in the next academic year, to have acquired a greater level of responsibility and maturity regarding the proposed objectives, allowing them to support their peers in the 3rd year and continue the process with the organisation of the tournaments for the complementary activity.

This PU, titled “*Comprehensive and Responsible Tchoukball*”, aims to

introduce students to invasion sports using alternative sports, initiating them into the technical-tactical principles of this classification through the *Comprehensive Teaching Model* and the *Teaching Personal and Social Responsibility Model* (TPSR), in order to address the objectives of the proposal.

The aim is to introduce *Tchoukball* as an alternative sport, emphasising its main characteristic: the absence of contact and direct opposition in gameplay, as well as putting into practice the principles of the *Olympic Charter* already mentioned. The first contact will be through nine sessions, after having previously worked on other sports, thus facilitating potential strategic transfers. Following this, students will be able to apply their knowledge to the subsequent complementary activity, where they will introduce this sport to the rest of the students at the school.

4.2.1. Methodology

For the development of this Programming Unit, we will base ourselves on the *Teaching Personal and Social Responsibility Model* (TPSR) by Hellison (2011) and the *Comprehensive Vertical Teaching of Sports Model* by Castejón Oliva et al. (2003).

For its part, the TPSR is structured into five levels:

- **Level 1.** Students gather information about the rules of the sport and apply it in game situations.
- **Level 2.** Students propose adaptations to tasks based on the group's level, promoting respectful communication.
- **Level 3.** During tutoring sessions, individual approaches to *Tchoukball* are developed and then shared in a group.
- **Level 4.** In a second round of tutoring, group reflections on the activities take place, and the weeks of introduction to the sport and the tournament are organised.
- **Level 5.** A tournament organised by the students is held, where they participate as organisers, referees, and secretaries.

The *Comprehensive Teaching Model* (Castejón Oliva et al., 2003) focuses on developing students' skills and understanding through a progressive and sequential work of basic concepts and skills of *Tchoukball*, adapting activities to ensure inclusive participation and providing constant feedback. It also promotes the recognition of skill transfer, teamwork to achieve common goals, and ongoing formative assessment to set short-term objectives and ensure student progress.

4.2.2. Evaluation

We will work on a formative evaluation proposal, and for this, we will take into account its three aspects:

- **Evaluation of student learning.** The proposal for this unit is structured with the following sections determined by Hernández Álvarez and Velázquez Buendía (2004): the two main objectives of learning evaluation in Physical Education (evaluation for the development of competencies and the evaluation of competencies), the instruments that will be used for both objectives, and the moment when these will be applied.
- **Evaluation of teaching.** Within this, according to authors such as Hernández Álvarez and Velázquez Buendía (2004), who incorporate Jackson's contribution (1996, in Hernández Álvarez and Velázquez Buendía, 2004, p. 58), we find three main phases that can guide our proposal on “*the what of teaching evaluation*” (Hernández Álvarez and Velázquez Buendía, 2004, p. 58): the pre-interactive phase, the interactive phase, and the post-interactive phase.
- **Evaluation of the teaching-learning process.** This section will assess the influence that our intervention as teachers has on the development or mastery of student learning. The purpose of this evaluation takes two forms: Reflecting, on one hand, in action (the teacher verifies what is happening during the teaching-learning process) and, on the other hand, reflecting on action (the teacher, with the collection of information, reflects on how the session has developed and the possible influence of their intervention on the level of development or mastery of student learning).

4.2.3. Complementary activity

After the development of the *Tchoukball* Programming Unit, students will actively participate in a *Playground Proposal*, where, through joint work with the playground monitors present at the center, they will develop a *Tchoukball Tournament* in which all groups from the center can participate throughout the academic year, ensuring that part of the recess spaces are always allocated to this sport.

To start the tournaments, the 3rd-year ESO students themselves will lead introductory sessions to *Tchoukball* during the recesses of the two weeks

following the development of their Programming Unit. Previous tutoring sessions will be dedicated to planning these sessions as well as the tournament itself. In these preparation sessions, the development of the TPSR that has been ongoing during the *Tchoukball* practice sessions will continue, so at the beginning of these sessions, students will be informed of the level of responsibility they are expected to achieve.

4.3. Monitoring and evaluation of the proposal

Direct observations of the playground sessions will be carried out during and after the sessions until the end of the academic year. Conflicts that may arise, as well as the reasons and the grade level of the students involved, will be recorded. Playground monitors will be provided with a template to note all circumstances related to the aforementioned issues.

In this way, it will be verified whether conflict situations have decreased compared to those prior to the proposal, and it will be identified in which grades a more specific intervention might be necessary. Additionally, we will be able to define which sports cause the most conflict, aiming to demonstrate that the sport addressed in the proposal is away from these situations.

Following this evaluation, efforts will be made to encourage the continuation of these tournaments in subsequent academic years, working in the same manner, with two prior weeks of introduction to *Tchoukball*, leading to the subsequent tournament organised by the 3rd-year ESO students.

5. Results and conclusions

The developed didactic proposal provides an alternative response to the weaknesses identified in the Physical Education programme of an educational center in the *Community of Madrid* by including *Tchoukball* in the classroom curriculum. It is designed to improve coexistence and reduce the conflicts detected among students by proposing specific activities and exercises to foster teamwork, empathy, and effective communication, as well as strategies for constructive problem-solving.

Given the results regarding the circumstances of Physical Education in this center, we propose as a conclusion the application and implementation of the Olympic ideals through a didactic unit of *Tchoukball* in the classroom curriculum

and the organisation of a *Tchoukball Tournament* as a playground activity organised by the 3rd-year of ESO students.

This represents a useful guide for future implementations. The importance of carrying out a process of adaptation and customisation of the proposal to the specific characteristics and needs of each center is highlighted. Additionally, it is suggested to implement a pilot plan and collect data to evaluate the impact and effectiveness of the proposal in reducing conflicts and improving the school climate through data collection during its implementation.

It is important to mention that this proposal presents challenges and limitations that must be addressed. These include the training and education of teachers in *Tchoukball*, the availability of material resources and adequate spaces, as well as the necessary institutional support for its successful implementation, especially regarding the complementary activity, as it involves coordination with the playground monitors.

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COEXISTENCE OF GLOBALISATION AND NATIONALISM IN THE OLYMPIC GAMES – A CASE STUDY OF 2020 TOKYO

Zikun LI (USA)

The modern Olympic Games represent one of the most prominent global mega-media events. Prior to Tokyo 2020, the Summer Games had only been postponed three times in history – specifically in 1916, 1940, and 1944 – due to the outbreak of world wars. In this context, the postponement of the Tokyo 2020 Games in response to the COVID-19 pandemic serves as a profound indicator of the pandemic's far-reaching and destructive impact (Han & Noland, 2020). While numerous scholars argue that the pandemic has driven a retreat from global economic integration and accelerated de-globalisation in many countries (e.g., Kozlov & Sokolova, 2020; He et al., 2020), the participation of 11,091 athletes from 206 nations in the Tokyo Olympics underscores the enduring interconnection and interdependence of the global community. The 2020 Tokyo Games, despite these challenges, exemplify the resilience of global solidarity.

On the other hand, despite the Olympic Truce's invitation for nations to pause conflicts and commit to building "a peaceful and better world through sport and the Olympic ideal", nationalism-driven competition remains a defining feature of the Games. Nationalism, often intertwined with pride, has historically been a central element in hosting the Summer Olympic Games, and Japan was no exception. Tokyo 2020 was more than just an international sporting event; it served as a powerful symbol, signaling to the world that "Japan is back" following years of economic stagnation and recovery from natural disasters. Moreover, with the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics looming, the stakes were high. A successful Winter Games, juxtaposed with a failed Summer Games, could hand China a significant propaganda victory, leaving Japan to bear considerable

shame, particularly given the historical tensions between the two nations. In this sense, nationalism permeated much of the Tokyo 2020 proceedings. Against this backdrop, this essay examines Tokyo 2020 as a case study to explore how globalisation and nationalism are intertwined within the Olympic Games in a simultaneous yet tense relationship. It also seeks to investigate the balancing mechanisms that allow the Olympic Games to maintain their vitality in the post-COVID-19 era.

Globalisation and Nationalism in the Modern Olympics

Globalisation and nationalism, along with their interrelations, have long been central topics of debate among scholars of international relations. Both concepts are crucial for understanding the contemporary world, which is marked by a complex interplay of interdependence and distinctiveness. Globalization refers to “the compression of the world and the intensification of consciousness of the world as a whole... both concrete global interdependence and consciousness of the global whole in the twentieth century” (Robertson, 1994, p. 8). This definition underscores that globalization is a process of reducing barriers to trade, communication, and cultural exchange. While globalisation can be traced as far back as the fifteenth century (Bentley, 1999), the rapid advancement of technology and social media has significantly elevated globalization in terms of scale, speed, and cognition (Abdulsattar, 2013).

Nationalism, by contrast, refers to the feelings of attachment and solidarity among members of a nation and the pride that a nation holds in itself (Kacowicz, 1998). As Godfrey (2008) argues, nationalism must be understood on an international scale, as it is often employed to promote and defend a particular culture associated with a specific ethnic group or identity. Nationalism forms the foundation of modern society and social cohesion, and it is frequently utilised by politicians to foster national unity and patriotism (Abdulsattar, 2013).

One of the most prominent arenas where the coexistence of globalization and nationalism can be observed is the Olympic Games. The modern Olympics were the brainchild of Pierre de Coubertin (1863-1937), a French bureaucrat whose worldview was shaped by two key ideas (Short, 2008). The first was a national concern with improving the physical fitness of French youth, a response to the perceived physical shortcomings that contributed to France’s defeat in the Franco-

German War of 1870. Encouraging participation in sports was seen as a means of enhancing the physical fitness of the younger generation. The second idea reflected the broader trend of internationalism that emerged in the last third of the nineteenth century. During this period, major powers increasingly competed for overseas markets and colonial possessions, and heightened international interaction spurred a new wave of globalisation. Alongside this trend, new organizations were established to regulate international exchanges. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) was founded in 1894, contemporaneous with other global initiatives such as the signing of the International Postal Convention in 1874 and the ratification of the Hague Convention on the rules of war in 1899. In this sense, the modern Olympic Games are a product of the first wave of globalisation, and they play a pivotal role in the performance, display, and celebration of global community (Short, 2008).

The internationalism of sports and the creation of a global community are embodied in the modern Olympic Games; however, the Games also reinforce nationalism, as they serve not only as a platform for international sports competition but also as a stage for national representation. The primary organising framework of the Olympic Games is national (Short, 2003). With the exception of the earliest Games, where athletes could compete as individuals, since 1912, each participant has competed as part of a national team, with only athletes selected by national Olympic organisations being eligible to participate. National representation, therefore, has become the dominant semiotic structure of the Games: athletes represent their countries, wear national uniforms, enter the opening ceremony as members of national teams, and medalists are honored with the raising of their national flags and the playing of their national anthems. In this sense, the Games often intensify national pride and identity rather than transcend them.

Tokyo 2020

Globalisation in Tokyo 2020

Global athletes

As global poverty has decreased and incomes across the world have converged, participation in the Olympic Games has broadened, leading to a more pluralistic distribution of medals, particularly in sports with lower barriers to entry in terms of

facilities and equipment. Despite the global impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, 205 countries participated in the Tokyo 2020 Games (with North Korea opting out to protect its athletes from the pandemic). This number surpasses the 195 countries recognised by the United Nations, demonstrating the International Olympic Committee's (IOC) more flexible approach to nationhood. The IOC allows participation from entities like Taiwan, Palestine, and Kosovo, which do not meet UN nationhood criteria, and even smaller nations, such as Nauru, also competed in Tokyo 2020. Additionally, 11,091 athletes participated in 41 sports and 339 events, and around 79,000 overseas officials, journalists, and support staff traveled to Tokyo to facilitate the Games. These figures serve as a strong testament to the interconnectedness and interdependence of the global community.

The percentage of total medals won by the top 10 nations at the Olympic Games has been exhibiting a downward trend since 1980 (Han & Noland, 2020). This can be partially attributed to the growing number of athletes from developing countries receiving training in traditional sporting nations such as the United States and Germany. Access to top-tier facilities and training in these international settings has significantly narrowed the athletic gap between developed and developing countries. A prime example of this phenomenon is seen in Asia. Track and field has historically been a weak area for Asian countries, with the gap often attributed to "racial differences". However, with the increasing practice of sending Asian athletes to the U.S. for training or bringing American coaches to Asia, the region's performance in track and field has improved dramatically. This emerging trend of transnational training has undoubtedly benefited from the forces of globalisation.

Another notable phenomenon contributing to the dispersion of medal distribution is the rise of multi-nationality among athletes. Increasingly, athletes are eligible to compete for multiple National Olympic Committees (NOCs) due to their mixed national ancestry. The "transfer of allegiance" has accelerated since the 1990s (Jansen et al., 2008). Gulf countries, in particular, have been actively recruiting world-class athletes to become citizens, with Qatar being among the most prominent examples. At the Tokyo Games, Qatar fielded 16 competitors, many of whom were originally from countries such as Mauritania, Egypt, Sudan, and Morocco (The New York Times, 2021). In exchange for substantial financial compensation, many of these athletes were even willing to change their names to represent Qatar, a salary that would have been unattainable in their home

countries. The Gulf states are not unique in this practice. Even the United States, one of the world's leading sporting nations, actively recruits talented athletes from around the globe. For instance, Weini Kelati, a native of Eritrea, became a U.S. citizen just 48 hours before competing for a spot at the Tokyo 2020 Games. While the transfer of allegiance raises questions about the integrity of national representation in international competitions, it also highlights how globalization is increasingly challenging and undermining the traditional nation-state paradigm (Castles, 2002).

A key example of the impact of globalisation on human mobility at the Tokyo 2020 Games is the Refugee Olympic Team (ROT), composed of 29 Refugee Athlete Scholarship holders from 11 countries. During the Opening Ceremony, the ROT marched second, immediately following Greece, under the Olympic flag. For all official ROT athletes, the Olympic flag was raised and the Olympic anthem played during medal ceremonies. The Refugee Olympic Team first appeared at Rio 2016, and its size has tripled in just one Olympiad (i.e., four years). The creation of this team conveys a powerful message of hope and inclusion to millions of refugees worldwide. In addition to forming the refugee team, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) established a Refugee Emergency Fund of \$1.9 million to support international aid agencies in integrating refugees through sport. The growing attention the IOC places on the refugee population reflects its commitment to human rights, which, according to Robertson (1994), is a fundamental reference point in the fabric of globalisation.

Olympic Commodification

While the Olympics may have initially been conceived as an idealistic celebration of athletic achievement, it has evolved into a “money machine”, becoming one of the most valuable brands in the world, worth \$47.4 billion in 2012. In this regard, the Olympics now serve as the premier global platform for corporations to enhance their brand image on the international stage. Although Tokyo 2020 may not be the most ideal case to illustrate the commodification of the Olympics – given the financial losses from ticket sales, tourism, and negative public sentiment – it still reflects this trend. Japanese corporate sponsors contributed \$3 billion, the largest amount ever from domestic companies, to cover the additional costs incurred by the Japanese government due to the pandemic-induced postponement. Despite negative public sentiment, leading

Japanese sponsors like Toyota, Fujitsu, NEC, and Nippon Telegraph opted not to air Olympic-themed television ads in Japan but continued to broadcast them internationally. On one hand, these companies aimed to support their nation during a fiscal crisis, but on the other, they sought to leverage the financial benefits of being Olympic partners on the global stage.

Additionally, NBC has paid \$7.7 billion for exclusive broadcasting rights in the United States through 2032 and had already sold \$1.25 billion in ads for the Tokyo Games. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) was estimated to earn \$3 billion to \$4 billion from television rights for the delayed Tokyo 2020 Games (Associated Press). The immense financial value of the Olympics today is inextricably tied to the global economy and its commodification.

Nationalism in Tokyo 2020

Medal Ranking

Despite the Tokyo 2020 organisers' efforts to convey the message of "unity in diversity" – one of the event's mottos aimed at highlighting the diversification of societies through migration, recent migration policy changes, and rising social movements in Japan regarding diversity (Yamamura, 2020) – nationalism was pervasive throughout the Games. As a Chinese individual living in the U.S. during Tokyo 2020, I observed the patriotic coverage in both the U.S. and China. In the U.S., television broadcasts frequently emphasised the latest medal counts and rankings of the American team, as though these figures were direct indicators of U.S. national merit. Traditionally, medal rankings were based on the number of gold medals, with total medal counts only relevant when countries had an equal number of golds. However, what struck me as ironic, particularly from my perspective as a Chinese spectator, was that American media subtly shifted the focus to the total medal count as the primary ranking method in order to keep the U.S. in first place – especially since the Chinese team was leading in gold medals until the very last day. In contrast, Chinese media adhered to the traditional ranking method, which kept China at the top until the final day.

While this difference in ranking methods may seem trivial, it reflects the close link between Olympic performances and national pride. Moreover, given the heightened tension between the U.S. and China, the world's two largest powers, since the Trump administration, the competition at Tokyo 2020 further

fueled nationalist sentiment on both sides. The Games, in this context, became more than just an athletic event; they served as a stage for the projection and intensification of national pride and rivalry.

National Sport

In addition to the traditional expressions of nationalism at the Olympic Games – such as national uniforms, flags, and anthems – another significant dimension through which nationalism manifests is through national sports. Table tennis (Ping Pong) is one such example. China has long dominated the international stage in table tennis, a sport that is also widely popular within the country. At Tokyo 2020, the defeat of China's mixed doubles table tennis team to Japan in the finals sparked widespread online outrage. Following the match, Liu Shiwen, the female athlete on the team, publicly apologized, stating that she felt as though she had let the entire team down. Her partner, Xu Xin, also expressed that the result was unacceptable for the Chinese team. For many in China, this match was more than just a sporting event; it held symbolic significance, given the complex relationship between China and Japan. A similar nationalism-fueled reaction occurred in badminton. When China lost the badminton doubles final to Taiwan, the Chinese public felt a sense of shame and anger, especially in light of the escalating political tensions between China and Taiwan.

Parochial nationalism was also evident in the UK. When Jade Jones, a two-time Olympic taekwondo champion from Great Britain, was defeated by Kimia Alizadeh, an Iranian asylum seeker competing for the Olympic Refugee Team, the British broadcaster focused solely on Jones's shocking loss, neglecting to highlight Alizadeh's remarkable story. Throughout the Games, the BBC devoted much of its coverage to the successes of Team GB, reinforcing a narrative of mechanical nationalism.

As with many social practices, the Olympics both reflect and shape societal values. As Jarvie (1993) notes, "the Olympics often provide a uniquely effective medium for inculcating national feelings, and they offer a form of symbolic action that asserts the case for the nation itself" (p. 74). In this sense, Tokyo 2020 was not only crucial for Japan to demonstrate its resilience in the face of the pandemic, but for all participating nations, it served as a platform to consolidate national unity through success on the sporting field.

Conclusion

Through an analysis of the interplay between globalisation and nationalism at Tokyo 2020, it becomes clear that the Olympic Games – perhaps more than any other sporting event – expose the deep political and economic dimensions of sport, despite the International Olympic Committee's (IOC) efforts to maintain an apolitical stance. Economically, the Olympics exemplify a truly globalised event, mobilising capital, labor, and ideas on a global scale. Politically, the Games serve as a platform for nationalism, offering nations the opportunity to redefine and assert their national identities through athletic performance.

This duality is essential to the continued vitality of the Olympic Games. Globalisation serves as the mechanism through which the Games attract attention and engagement from diverse audiences across the globe, while nationalism remains at the heart of the Games' appeal, fueling the emotional investment of spectators and athletes alike. To sustain its relevance in an increasingly interconnected world, the Olympics must embrace both globalization and nationalism, as these forces together shape its enduring significance. In this sense, the Olympics stand not only as a showcase of sporting excellence but also as a reflection of broader socio-political dynamics, where global unity and national pride coexist in a delicate balance.

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THE EVOLUTION OF OLYMPIC NEWS REPORTING IN THE DIGITAL ERA
– INTERVIEW WITH MR ANTHONY EDGAR, FORMER HEAD
OF IOC MEDIA OPERATIONS & MS ASHLEE TULLOCH,
REPORTER OF OLYMPIC CHANNEL

Jingjing LIAO (CHN)¹
Qiuyu DU

Abstract

Reviewing the history of Olympic news reporting, the evolution of technology has played a decisive role. This interview focuses on the communication mode of Olympic news. Through the interview of Olympic media professionals from two generations, try to explore the changes brought by digital technology innovation to the Olympic news reporting system. The research shows that Olympic media is still the main disseminator of Olympic news by virtue of professionalism, storytelling is an important part of Olympic reporting, and the value standard of “Content is King” has not been replaced. The anthropotropic trend of technology is to serve people, not to replace people with machines as gatekeepers of information. Under the background of the digital era, Olympic media should learn to master emerging technologies, strive to adapt to the complex and changeable media environment, adhere to the core concept of “people-oriented” to give context aura, and guide people to understand the emotional and spiritual connotation of the Olympics. Olympic news reportage should take the initiative to carry out the responsibility of healthy and orderly

1. Jingjing Liao participated in the IOA Seminar and presented the paper.

dissemination of Olympic culture and deliver high-quality content that meets the needs of the times.

Keywords: Digitisation; Media Technology; Olympic News Reporting; Content is King; Olympic Media

Introduction

Mr Anthony Edgar, once covered as a journalist/photographer for a sports magazine at the Atlanta 1996 Olympic Games. In 2001 he worked as press officer for the International Volleyball Federation and from 2003 to 2020, he joined the International Olympic Committee (IOC), where he was Head of Media Operations for the Olympics. Mr Anthony was responsible for managing the delivery of media facilities and services at the Olympic Games. He worked closely with Olympic Games Organising Committees, National Olympic Committees, International Federations and major news agencies and publications.

Ms Ashlee Tulloch participated in the IOC Young Reporters Programme to cover the 2014 Nanjing Youth Olympic Games. From 2016 to 2022, she was invited to join the Olympic Channel as a reporter and producer. She is a representative of the new generation of Olympic media person and accumulated considerable popularity among global Olympic fans. Currently, she returned to her hometown in New Zealand and is working as a freelancer in Olympic reporting.

1. Preface

Covering about four billion audiences worldwide empowers the Olympic Spirit, temporarily, to act as a global norm, as Billings puts it (Billings et al., 2018, p.1):

The Olympics is, indeed, part reality show, part nationalistic emblem, part Chicken Soup for the Soul, and part global festival.

The Olympic Games are transmitted to the audience through the media. The 2016 Rio Olympics are commonly regarded as a turning point in the evolving history of contemporary Olympic media where the rise of social media has greatly impacted on the overall media narrative mechanism (Billings et al., 2018; Zhou, 2016; Sun, 2019). In recent years, digital technology has developed rapidly

and has been applied in the media field represented by Olympic broadcasting, which emphasises technological innovation. The outbreak of the pandemic has provided a “super accelerated” training to millions of media professionals on digital workflows and tools that otherwise would have taken years to be completed (OBS, 2021, p. 25). So what are the characteristics of Olympic news reporting in the digital era? What changes has technology advancement brought to contemporary Olympic news reporting? With a curiosity, the author invited Mr Anthony Edgar and Ms Ashlee Tulloch, a senior journalist and a producer of the Olympic Channel, to make in-depth discussions.

2. Identity Discussion: Who is the main communicator of Olympic news reporting?

Host (referred to as H): Hello, Anthony and Ashlee, thank you for accepting the interview. I have noted that the Olympic Agenda 2020+5 mentioned that future Olympic development need to grow digital engagement with people. What is the reason to propose this strategy? How to describe the era background that current Olympic coverage is facing?

Anthony Edgar (referred to as A): I think the Olympics and the world have been already digitally engaged with each other for many years. You have got a company like Facebook now, which has twice as many people following it as the population of China. Information release only takes one hour to get the attention of up to 2.5 billion people.

Ashlee Tulloch (referred to as AS): Right. Nowadays, the world is such a technology-focused place and digital world and technology work hand in hand. So, for the Olympics to maintain relevance and continue to connect with humans in the best possible way, we need to be evolving. I think it's catering and evolving with the way that we are as humans.

H: The global impression of the Olympic Movement has been cultivated by mass media of communications, the efforts of professional news organisations. They were considered as the main communicator of Olympic culture. While along with the thriving of social media and we-media, the boundaries between communicator and audience have become hard to tell. Everyone can be the information sender. Famous athletes have much more fans than news agencies

on social media platforms. Can professional news organisations still maintain the main status in Olympic culture communicator camp?

A: Yes. Professional news agencies still maintain the main status in Olympic culture communication. Athletes can communicate with a lot of people. But they don't go online before every match or give a review of every single match they witnessed. That is not news reporting. News reporting is, as you know from this industry, something quite different. And it is supposedly there to tell the truth or to report the truth of the events that happen, not just one aspect of them.

AS: I think the importance of professional news agencies should not be ignored. Everyone is allowed to speak. But also, there is so much misinformation. Professional news organisations have a history of being reliable, honest and giving us information correctly. They sincerely provide people with professional news to help them understand the past, the present and the future about the Olympics.

H: Some people believe that the current society has a liquid-turning trend, the sense of boundary is disappearing. With the development of social media, we can all disseminate news. There is no fixed paradigm for news display. Anthony, you seem to think that there is a certain standard for news so the message was as posted by athletes and audience on the social media and cannot be regarded as a piece of formal news?

A: No, but it doesn't mean they are not important. We all use social media as a part of a news channel. One of the important things that's happening for the last years is trying to differentiate between what is fake news and what is real news. Professional news agencies are good at it.

H: So are you trying to say Olympic news reporting needs to be done by professional journalists?

A: No, I did not say that. It can be done by anyone but someone who speaks on a mobile phone doesn't mean they are reporting. They don't know how to report but that doesn't mean what they do is not important. I mean London in 2012, the director of the news for London Olympic Games said that about 50% of their breaking news stories were found through social media. For example, the wrong Korean flag was put in medal plaza, and it was noticed from a tweet².

2. In the women's football match between North Korea and Colombia in 2012 London Summer Olympics, the North Korean flag was mistakenly displayed as the South Korean flag. North Korea women's football players refused to take field.

H: Do you think the rise of digital platforms such as social media is conducive to the development of Olympic news reporting?

A: Yes. The rise of social media means reporters can use more channels to display the information as well as collect the information.

3. Content Discussion: What is the originality of the Olympic news reporting?

H: What do you think is the difference between Olympic news coverage and other competitions?

A: When I went to my first Olympic Games in Atlanta in 1996, I was sitting on a plane and there were a bunch of reporters on the plane. Each of them had been assigned five or six sports that they were going to report on. Some of these sports they have never covered it before. This reflects two characteristics of Olympic reporting, one is we need a lot of background information, the other is we need to give consideration to reporting when multiple matches are held at the same time. It reminds me of the importance of OIS³. The information provided by OIS can help reporters better understand the background information of the sports to improve the quality of reporting. And I think that's the same with the public as well. They don't know most of these sports. Our duty is to popularise the knowledge of the project before the competition. When the competition starts, people know what to focus on.

H: Do you think the principle of “content is king” still applies to the development of Olympic reporting today?

A: Yes, I remember one story. In 2000, wrestling was a minority sport in Australia. We wanted to know how these people were preparing for the Olympic Games as a wrestler with no wrestling club and no one to wrestle against to practice. We were doing a story on some Australian athletes and we came across athletes to compete in wrestling and then this is what we found out through our

3. OIS: Olympic Information Service (OIS) is an IOC-supervised professional sports reporting and information service designed to keep the accredited media informed and to help them achieve the best possible coverage of the Olympic Games, Paralympic Games and Youth Olympic Games. OIS does not replace media, but provides basic information, not finished manuscripts. The OIS team publishes news, features and flash quotes to the accredited media.

reporting. The athlete built a fence in his backyard and with a shovel he put a lot of dirt on one side of the fence. Every single morning, he would go out and put all of the dirt over the fence. He lifted all the dirt back to the other side at night when he came home. That's how he developed his own strength in the middle of nowhere and became an Olympian. It's not just telling the results. It's finding out about what is the magic inside all of us. It's a real story about people. Olympic reports need to tell stories. Compared with who won the gold medal, we need to pay attention to how they won the gold medal. There are so many stories of the Olympics, the magic of finding those stories is what I think is so wonderful.

H: In the digital age, where there is an overwhelming amount of information and attention is easily diverted, should Olympic reporters actively cater to their audience? And how can they strike a balance between meeting audience preferences and upholding professionalism?

AS: Nowadays people don't have a very long attention span. They want to see things, know things, get information straight away. We need to break down the content into different pieces while ensuring its news value as much as possible. There are two kinds of different types of storytelling, I think one is very quick and very fast because they want the information now and then. At the same time, when they have time and want to watch a movie on a flight or listen to a podcast on a train. We should give a very solid background and very strong feelings of good storytelling to them.

4. Tendency Discussion: Will machines replace human beings to dominate the future Olympic news reporting?

H: Relying on algorithms, AI robots could imitate news editors to automatically produce news. As far as I know, some media, such as the Washington Post, have used AI to participate in the production of Olympic news. What do you think of this phenomenon?

A: Reuters have been using AI robots for some years, not everything but basic analysis, charts and different things which the computer can do. How far will it go, I don't know. Would they take the job of reporters? I don't think so.

H: Why don't you think that robots could replace the real journalists to report?

A: There are some things that robots can do better than humans, but that

doesn't mean that they can do everything better than humans. At least they can't bring me the story about the Sydney wrestler.

H: So what do you think is the biggest strength of real reporters compared with robots?

AS: I don't believe that reporters can be replaced by robots. I don't understand how algorithms are going to be able to foresee and forecast various situations at the Olympic Games. For example, when someone suddenly decided to not compete. How would AI robots respond to that? There, it needs to be humans involved in these decisions because, without them, there's no connection to the content and human emotion and understanding or judgement being made on reporting.

H: What do you think of the visual reality application in the Olympic news coverage?

AS: VR technology enables people living far away to get closer to the scene, providing a new opportunity to experience the Olympic Games. Perhaps in the future, people will not watch the live broadcast on computers and mobile phones but will wear VR helmets and sit on their own sofas to enjoy the game.

H: We have talked about AI and VR, the most up-to-date digital technology. And you seem to treat the technology in innovation just as a tool. This tool helps reporters to produce a report of a higher quality. The main focus is to produce good content.

AS: I agree. But I think technology as a whole is working together to create a more real experience and understanding. So it's a very valuable tool.

H: Are there any bad effects that technology progress may bring to the Olympic news industry?

A: It's the people using the platform that are doing the information and the reporting. There's nothing inherently bad about any of the platforms. It's how they are being used that makes them good or bad. We should focus on how to use technology to present better Olympic reports. For example, OIS is a great digital platform catering to the needs of contemporary sports news production.

H: What do you think the Olympic news reportage means for the Olympic Movement development?

AS: The popularity of the Olympic Movement is inseparable from the efforts of the media, which still play an important role today. In this journey, news reports and the Olympic Games go hand in hand. It is precisely because of professional reports and interpretations that people can feel the spiritual power

brought by the Olympic Games behind laughter and tears, and gain momentum in the strong feelings.

H: Right, I hope the efforts of Olympic media have left golden memories for people. Thank you for your sharing today. I expect to meet you soon. Wish you all the best!

A/AS: Pleasant chat, talk to you next time.

5. Conclusion

We have been in a deeply mediated society, which is an advanced society where digital media and deep social infrastructure are connected with society everywhere after they have developed to a certain extent. It is connected with algorithms, data and digital infrastructure (Wei & Shang, 2021). The rapid development of digital media has brought about decentralisation and information prosperity, posing challenges to the traditional reporting system. The braid news proposed by Shel Israel in *TWITTERVILLE*, which is jointly participated by traditional media, web media and social media, is particularly prominent in the current discourse system (Israel, 2010). In this kind of news ecological competition, professional media ensure their influence and maintain their dominant position of communication by virtue of their long established credibility and professional news literacy. The interest of the Olympic audience comes from the ability of the Olympic Games to generate multiple narratives, genres and symbols (Chalip, 1992). The Olympic Games will produce a series of narrative capabilities, usually around the athletes, but not the only one. Each narrative is a separate invitation to the Olympics. Sports communication should focus on the core concept of “people-oriented” to prevent the dissipation of the text aura caused by mechanical copying (Tuo, 2007). Technology is a tool, which plays an auxiliary role rather than a decisive role. Journalists are expected to combine new technology with news accumulation, use “new pots” to fill “old wine”, and constantly adapt to the changing and developing external media environment, serving as the recorders of the times, inspire people to understand the emotional and spiritual core of the Olympic Games.

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FROM BEIJING TO PARIS: POLICY SUPPORT AND THE EVOLVING ROLE OF CHINESE FEMALE ATHLETES WITH DISABILITIES IN THE PARALYMPIC MOVEMENT

Jia CHENG (CHN)

Abstract

This paper explores the evolving role of Chinese female athletes with disabilities in the Paralympic Movement, from Beijing 2008 to Paris 2024. It highlights how policy support, social integration, and technological innovation have contributed to their development. The analysis examines key factors including legal frameworks, societal attitudes, and sports policies that have empowered these athletes. Special focus is placed on the 2008 Beijing Paralympic Games, a turning point for the inclusion of female athletes in China, and the strides made in the lead-up to the 2024 Paris Paralympics. The research underscores the significance of increased media coverage, improved social security, and technological advancements in facilitating their success. The achievements of Chinese female Paralympians not only elevate their athletic status but also challenge stereotypes, encouraging broader societal engagement with disability sports.

Keywords: Paralympic, Female Athletes with Disabilities, 2008 Beijing Paralympic Games

Introduction

Since the mid-20th century, with the establishment of international organisations for disability sports and the increasing number of related events, disability sports

have garnered growing attention and support from the global community. The founding and development of the International Paralympic Committee (IPC) have laid a solid foundation for the standardisation and internationalisation of disability sports worldwide. In recent years, disability sports have exhibited trends of greater diversity in events, broader participation, and enhanced influence, fostering the social integration and identity recognition of individuals with disabilities. Disability sports competitions, particularly the Paralympic Games, have brought greater visibility to the achievements of disabled athletes (Bass University Doctoral Dissertation) (Huang and Brittain, 2006), offering them opportunities to showcase their athletic talents. Moreover, increased media coverage has significantly raised public awareness and understanding of disability sports. Major international media outlets (e.g., BBC, CNN, Al Jazeera), specialised sports media (e.g., ESPN, Sky Sports, Sports Illustrated), and disability-focused platforms (e.g., Paralympic.org, Disability Sports News) have highlighted the abilities and accomplishments of disabled athletes through authentic reporting and compelling narratives. These reports have not only prompted governments and related institutions to focus more on disability sports policies and financial support but also motivated nations to increase their investment in the sector. As a result, disability sports have received greater social attention and support, elevating the social status and influence of disabled athletes while promoting diversity and inclusivity within society.

The Olympic Movement has played a significant role in promoting gender equality by progressively eliminating gender discrimination and encouraging equal participation in sports through various measures and actions. Both the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the International Paralympic Committee (IPC), as global governing bodies, have not only advanced gender equality in competitive sports but also fostered inclusivity and diversity worldwide. In 2018, the IOC released the Gender Equality Review Project, identifying gender inequalities within the Olympic Movement and presenting 25 recommendations. These recommendations span several areas, including the participation of female athletes, the involvement of women in coaching and officiating, funding and resources, governance, leadership, culture, and media representation.

The IPC, as the leading authority on international Paralympic sports, plays a pivotal role in advancing equality, inclusion, and social progress for people with disabilities. It has established a prominent position in global disability sports by

expanding opportunities for female participation, increasing women's leadership roles, promoting media coverage, and fostering international cooperation. These efforts have enhanced women's influence in the field and contributed to balancing gender representation in sports.

Notably, the 2024 Paris Paralympics will share a logo with the Olympics for the first time in history. This symbolic gesture signifies the growing integration of the two events. The emblem, featuring a gold medal, a flame, and Marianne – a symbol of the French people and revolution – incorporates female elements, honouring women athletes and emphasising the importance of gender equality. Additionally, the Paris Paralympics aims to achieve a historic milestone, with women athletes comprising 50% of the total participants.

From the establishment of the International Paralympic Committee (IPC) and the successful hosting of international Paralympic events to the increasing media coverage and the IPC's special focus on women at the 2024 Paris Paralympics, there has been a significant shift in global attention toward female athletes with disabilities. In recent years, the Chinese government has strengthened its protection of the rights of people with disabilities and women, which has greatly improved the social status and recognition of women with disabilities. Through the implementation of policies across various sectors – including social security, employment support, reproductive rights, educational resources, accessible infrastructure, and the application of advanced technology – the government's attention to women with disabilities has steadily increased.

These social policies and measures have not only improved the living conditions and development opportunities for women with disabilities but also provided crucial support for the development of sports policies targeting this group. With comprehensive government backing, China has continuously improved its performance at the Paralympic Games, maintaining the top spot in both the medal and gold medal standings for six consecutive events.

Taking the 2008 Beijing Paralympics as a key milestone, this analysis will review the Chinese government's policy support for women with disabilities, covering critical areas such as legal frameworks, societal attitudes, media coverage, the education system, community support, and economic opportunities. The athletic performance of Paralympic athletes is inseparable from the social security and economic support they receive, which are closely intertwined.

Table 1. Rankings of the Chinese Delegation in Previous Paralympic Games

Year	Host City	Gold Medals	Total Medals	Rank by Gold Medals	Rank by Total Medals
1984	New York / Stoke Mandeville	2	22	28	26
1988	Seoul	17	38	15	19
1992	Barcelona	16	31	10	18
1996	Atlanta	16	39	9	11
2000	Sydney	34	73	6	8
2004	Athens	63	141	1	1
2008	Beijing	89	211	1	1
2012	London	95	231	1	1
2016	Rio de Janeiro	107	239	1	1
2020	Tokyo	96	207	1	1
2024	Paris	94	220	1	1

Historical and Policy Development in China: From Marginalisation to Support

Pre-Beijing 2008 Policy Landscape

Before the 2008 Beijing Paralympic Games, China's policies on sports for people with disabilities underwent a transformation from initial exploration to systematic support, encompassing legal frameworks, the establishment of specialised institutions, public awareness campaigns, and infrastructure development (see Table). In the 1984 Los Angeles Paralympic Games, China sent female athletes with disabilities to compete for the first time. Although their numbers were limited, their participation marked the gradual emergence of Chinese women with disabilities on the international sports stage. During this period, the performance of female athletes in China's Paralympic team showed a steady upward trend. At the 2004 Athens Paralympics, the Chinese delegation topped the medal tally for the first time, with many female athletes excelling in athletics, swimming, and other events, showcasing the strength of Chinese women with

disabilities. The competitive performance of these athletes was closely linked to the national policies and social security measures of that era.

Table 2. Key Events in the Development of Chinese Female Athletes with Disabilities from 1984 to 2008

Year	Key Events	Policy Measures
1984	China's First Participation in the Paralympic Games	Female athletes with disabilities began to gain attention, but the policy support system was still in its early stages.
1988	The State Began to Focus on the Development of Disability Sports	The state gradually introduced policies encouraging people with disabilities to participate in sports, with increasing attention to female athletes.
1990	The First National Games for the Disabled	The National Games for the Disabled expanded the social influence of female athletes with disabilities, and policy support began to emerge.
1995	Enactment of the Law on the Protection of Persons with Disabilities	The Law on the Protection of Persons with Disabilities provided legal protection for women with disabilities to participate in sports.
2000	Issuance of the General Administration of Sports' Opinions on Disability Sports	Increased funding and facility construction for disability sports; improved training conditions for female athletes with disabilities.
2001	Beijing's Successful Bid for the Paralympic Games	Increased funding and resources for female athletes with disabilities, especially in preparation for the Beijing Paralympic Games.
2004	Success at the Athens Paralympic Games	Further strengthened policy support for female athletes with disabilities, including accessible facility design and social security.
2008	Beijing Paralympic Games and Support for Female Athletes with Disabilities	Significant increase in special funding, enhanced social security and reemployment policies, and the establishment of a systematic training system.

In addition to the key events listed above, other organizations and legal policies have also played a crucial role in supporting the development of female athletes with disabilities. In 1988, China established the China Disabled Persons' Federation (CDPF), a national non-governmental organisation. The CDPF not only provides services and support to people with disabilities but also plays an essential role in policy advocacy, safeguarding the rights of people with disabilities, and promoting social inclusion. Its establishment marked the

institutionalisation of the state's attention to disabled groups, gradually building a comprehensive support system for individuals with disabilities in areas such as life, education, employment, and sports. Through the Federation, the state began systematically planning for disability sports, with a particular focus on the needs of women with disabilities. This was facilitated by resource allocation and policy coordination to encourage their participation in sports.

The enactment of the 1995 Sports Law of the People's Republic of China was a milestone. This law explicitly stipulated that people with disabilities, including women, have the same rights as other citizens in the realm of sports. For the first time, the sports rights of women with disabilities were legally recognised at the national level, ensuring their equal access to athletic activities and furthering their involvement in sports. The law's introduction signalled that people with disabilities, especially women, were being granted more opportunities in sports, laying the legal foundation for subsequent related policies.

In 2000, the release of the Outline for the Development of Disabled Persons' Sports further advanced the standardisation and systematisation of disability sports. This outline emphasised the role of sports in rehabilitation and social integration for people with disabilities, indicating that the state viewed sports not merely as an opportunity for competition but as a vital pathway for the overall development of disabled individuals. In this context, the participation of disabled women in sports took on additional social significance, becoming a means of rehabilitation, empowerment, and social inclusion.

The 2004 Law on the Protection of Persons with Disabilities reinforced these efforts, providing more comprehensive legal guarantees for the rights of people with disabilities, particularly women, in the field of sports. This law established a solid institutional framework for the advancement of disability sports, laying a firmer foundation for the future development of female athletes with disabilities.

Between 1984 and 2008, China's policies for female athletes with disabilities evolved from initial involvement in international competitions to a more legalised and systematic approach. Key milestones, such as the successful 2001 Olympic bid and topping the medal tally in 2004, propelled the participation and progress of disabled women in sports. Ultimately, these advancements contributed not only to athletic achievements but also to meaningful progress in their social status and rights protection.

Post-Beijing 2008 Developments: Support Mechanisms

After 2008, China hosted the 13th Summer Paralympic Games in Beijing, which brought significant opportunities for the development of disability sports in the country. In response, China introduced a series of social security systems to safeguard the basic livelihoods of individuals with disabilities. Social security refers to a set of policies, systems, and measures established by a country or region to ensure the basic living standards and economic security of its citizens. It encompasses key areas such as pensions, healthcare, unemployment, work-related injury insurance, and maternity benefits. An improved social security system is fundamental to enabling people with disabilities to participate more actively in sports. By analysing the broader societal support for female athletes with disabilities, we can better understand the reasons behind the continuous improvement in the performance of China's female athletes at the Paralympic Games.

At the national level, the Chinese government has increased its support for athletes with disabilities. Various policy documents explicitly highlight the importance of promoting the development of disability sports (see Table). Female athletes with disabilities have been among the beneficiaries of these efforts. Notably, the revision and implementation of the Law on the Protection of Persons with Disabilities emphasised the right to equal participation in sports, further reinforcing the government's commitment to inclusive athletic opportunities.

Table 3. Laws and Policies on Sports for Women with Disabilities in China

Year	Policy/Measure Title	Main Content	Issuing Authority
2008	Law on the Protection of Persons with Disabilities of the People's Republic of China	Ensures equal rights for women with disabilities in sports, supporting their participation in various sports activities.	National People's Congress
2010	Outline for the Development of Chinese Women (2011-2020)	Focuses on the protection of rights for women with disabilities, promoting their equal participation in all types of sports activities.	State Council
2015	13th Five-Year Plan for the Development of Disability Affairs	Emphasizes increasing the participation rate of women with disabilities in sports and strengthening their rehabilitation and fitness services.	State Council

Year	Policy/Measure Title	Main Content	Issuing Authority
2017	Guiding Opinions on Promoting Equal Participation of Women in Sports	Encourages women with disabilities to participate in community fitness activities and promotes the construction of accessible fitness facilities.	General Administration of Sport, All-China Women's Federation
2021	Law on the Protection of Women's Rights and Interests of the People's Republic of China	Emphasises the protection of the sports rights of women with disabilities, particularly safeguarding the rights of female athletes with disabilities.	Standing Committee of the National People's Congress
2022	Several Opinions on Further Promoting the Development of Women's Sports	Further promotes the participation of women with disabilities in sports activities, offering more training and competition opportunities.	General Administration of Sport, All-China Women's Federation
2022	White Paper on the Development of Sports for Persons with Disabilities in China	Highlights progress in sports for women with disabilities and promotes their participation in winter sports.	State Council Information Office
2022	Revised Law on the Protection of Women's Rights and Interests	Strengthens the protection of the rights of women with disabilities in sports and other areas, particularly addressing gender discrimination in employment and participation.	National People's Congress
2023	Law on the Construction of Barrier-Free Environments of the People's Republic of China	Ensures equal sports rights for women with disabilities in accessible environments and supports their sports needs.	Standing Committee of the National People's Congress

The social security system for female athletes with disabilities is gradually improving, allowing more athletes to benefit from health insurance, pensions, employment, and maternity benefits. Additionally, local governments have introduced incentive policies to encourage their participation in social activities and employment, providing them with more opportunities for social engagement.

The development of Chinese female athletes with disabilities is closely linked to the country's growing technological strength. In modern sports, technological innovation has become a key factor in helping athletes surpass physical limits and enhance their performance. Advances in assistive devices and training systems have offered more diverse development pathways for these athletes.

A notable example of China's technological prowess was showcased at the 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics and Paralympics, where the widespread use of

smart wheelchairs drew attention. These domestically developed wheelchairs integrate advanced features such as automatic obstacle avoidance, voice control, and GPS navigation, significantly improving the independence and safety of athletes while providing a more efficient mobility experience. This innovation marks a major breakthrough in assistive technology and offers a higher level of support for athletes with disabilities in both their daily lives and sports careers.

Furthermore, technological advancements in training methods have opened new possibilities for female athletes with disabilities. For instance, the Shanghai wheelchair basketball team has adopted a virtual reality (VR) training system, a prime example of how high-tech tools are empowering disabled athletes. Through this system, athletes can simulate real game scenarios and adjust training based on different tactical needs, greatly enhancing their response times and tactical abilities. This technological breakthrough provides athletes with physical limitations, who may not always be able to participate in on-site training, with high-intensity and precision training opportunities, thereby improving the overall performance of the team.

Evolving Role of Chinese Women Athletes with Disabilities in the Paralympic Movement

Beijing 2008: a Turning Point

At the 2008 Beijing Paralympic Games, China sent a delegation of 332 athletes, comprising 196 men and 136 women. For the first time, the number of female athletes surpassed 100, accounting for over 40% of the total delegation. This marked a significant increase in the participation of female athletes with disabilities compared to previous Paralympic Games, reflecting the growing importance placed by the state on their involvement in sports. These athletes not only competed in traditionally strong events such as athletics and swimming but also participated in a wider range of sports, showcasing their broader athletic capabilities.

Table 4. Number of Participants from the Chinese Delegation in Previous Summer Paralympic Games

Edition	Year	Host City	Total Participants	Male Athletes	Female Athletes	Female Athlete Percentage
7	1984	New York / Stoke Mandeville	24	16	8	33.33%
8	1988	Seoul	43	26	17	39.53%
9	1992	Barcelona	40	25	15	37.50%
10	1996	Atlanta	43	26	17	39.53%
11	2000	Sydney	87	53	34	39.08%
12	2004	Athens	200	126	74	37.00%
13	2008	Beijing	332	196	136	40.96%
14	2012	London	282	163	119	42.20%
15	2016	Rio de Janeiro	308	176	132	42.86%
16	2020	Tokyo	251	142	109	43.43%
17	2024	Paris	284	126	158	55.63%

The participation of female athletes with disabilities not only showcased the athletic achievements of Chinese women but also broke through the dual barriers of gender and disability. Society often holds stereotypical views about individuals with disabilities, particularly women, perceiving them as unsuited for competitive sports. However, the performance of Chinese female athletes at the 2008 Paralympic Games challenged these prejudices through their determination and perseverance, making them role models of resilience and self-reliance.

Chinese female athletes with disabilities achieved remarkable success at the 2008 Paralympics, securing multiple gold, silver, and bronze medals. Their accomplishments not only contributed to China's rise in the Paralympic medal rankings but also inspired more women with disabilities to engage in sports. In the years that followed, these athletes became role models within the disabled community, encouraging more individuals with disabilities to leave the confines of their homes and participate in social activities.

During this period, Chinese female athletes with disabilities gained international recognition, elevating both China's status in the Paralympic arena

and advancing societal awareness and support for people with disabilities. Their stories were widely reported, contributing to greater public attention to the rights of women with disabilities and prompting the development of more accessible facilities and broader social support for the disabled community.

Paris 2024: Further leap

At the 2024 Paris Paralympic Games, Chinese female athletes excelled in traditional strength events like swimming and athletics, winning 94 gold, 76 silver, and 50 bronze medals – 220 in total – securing their position at the top of both the gold and overall medal tables. With the support of research teams, athletes optimised their performance and prevented injuries through technical advancements. Their success not only brought honor to the nation but also inspired Paralympians worldwide.

Leaders and Record Breakers

Chinese female athletes, particularly in athletics, swimming, and weightlifting, have set new world records, solidifying their leadership in Paralympic sports. Sprinter Li Rui broke her own world records in the 100m and 200m races, while weightlifter Zhang Li claimed gold with a record-breaking performance, showcasing China's strength in these fields.

Ambassadors of National Image

Beyond their athletic achievements, these athletes symbolise China's commitment to disability sports. Swimmer Ma Yuting expressed gratitude for national support through international media, further enhancing China's positive global image and spreading the values of sportsmanship and inclusivity.

Role Models and Social Advocates

Through their perseverance, these athletes show that physical disability does not limit one's potential. Wheelchair fencer Zhou Xiaomei not only excelled in competition but also championed disability rights, using her platform to encourage broader societal support for the disabled, becoming a driving force for social progress.

Chinese Women Athletes with Disability in Global Paralympic Sports: Challenges and Opportunities

After the Olympic Games, commercial support and media attention kept Olympic athletes in the public eye, demonstrating both the economic and social benefits of the event. In contrast, exposure for Paralympic athletes is mostly limited to the event period. As Wu Xueping (2024) points out, the impact of Paralympians is like throwing stones into a lake – the ripples spread but quickly fade. Wu emphasises that the key to maximizing the value of Paralympic gold lies in making the influence of these athletes more sustained, integrated into everyday life, and reflective of their real worth.

The Paralympic Games serve as an international stage for female athletes with disabilities to showcase their abilities. Faced with dual challenges of gender and disability, these women often have to work harder than their male and non-disabled counterparts. Their success at the Paralympics not only helps them realise their own value and achieve physical empowerment but also highlights the growing status of female athletes on both national and societal levels. This recognition can further promote greater attention to and support for disabled female athletes and the broader community of women with disabilities.

**CONCLUSIONS OF
THE WORKING GROUPS**

CONCLUSIONS OF THE WORKING GROUPS

1. The evolution of the Olympia sanctuary and Panhellenism (8th-6th c. BC)

Question 1: Why was Olympia the centre of the Panhellenic Festival?

Olympia was the centre of the Panhellenic Festival because of its quite unique characteristics. One of them was its remoteness. Hence, it did not belong to anyone. This was considered to be relevant as all over the Greek world, there was constant tension between different communities, which often caused conflicts due to the desire to achieve supremacy over one another. In fact, at that time, leaders of these communities used to fight for their identity, to gain power, fame, remembrance, and territory. Therefore, it was a special occasion to gather together in a place that was a politically neutral space that no one – except for the gods maybe – possessed.

In ancient times, these festivities were firstly not sports competitions, but primarily religious gatherings for worshipping the gods. Firstly, the city was since the beginning, organised and dedicated, to the most prominent gods in Greek mythology, Kronos, Hera and later especially Zeus, the father of all gods and humans. As Zeus was the supreme god in ancient Greek mythology, we can consider that it was a relevant reason for different tribes of Greece to come from far away locations.

Also, mythical traditions were centred around this place. Olympia is situated in the Peloponnese which got its name from the mythical hero Pelops. He was an ancient king in that region and a sanctuary dedicated to his person, was found here in Olympia. Another tradition concerns Heracles, the son of Zeus, who is said to have created the landscape of Olympia during one of his *athla*. According to Pausanias, the demigod was also the founder of the Games.

2. The Macedonian Kings, politics, and Olympia

Question 2: What meant to be an Olympic Victor?

Olympic Victors were admired people, an example to imitate, subsidised by their states (regarding money, food, and time), famous, and a link to their community during the games. Olympic victors were considered people to worship, having a god-like status. They would be seen as protectors of the city. If a victor dies, he would be considered a semi-god and be worshipped. Universally accepted fine athletes were loved because they inspired, but were also considered to be useless in specific situations (especially in war).

So, victors were characterised differently depending on the sources. For example, Euripides in the satyr play *Autolycus* (Fr. 282) considered victors useless and inefficient people. This criticism can be seen as a reaction of an intellectual class to a prevailing normative ideal which believed that a fit body was also a sign of being sound of character, as we can see in Homer's epics, the *epinikia* of Pindar, or later texts like Chariton's *Kallirhoe*. Statues, that were erected for victors, were an integral part of memory culture in ancient societies, carrying significant, mostly positive local identity values. In fact, this belief that links appearance to morality was very influential regarding power-dynamics, which leaves us today with a problematic question of its reception, and general acceptance.

Ancient victors wore several roles, or identities. They belonged to the *oikos* (house), *demos* (municipality), *polis* (city-state), *oikumene*, and athletic, religious games. Particularly, in Olympia, victors would fulfil their athletic role, which then emerged to be of greater influence in other parts of society. Becoming a victor turns someone into a symbol, a memory, and a set of values, becoming material for shaping an imagined and idealised belief of oneself as a community. Next to practical consequences, like gaining important social functions after a professional athletic career, it was primarily their impact to shape, strengthen or idealise a collective identity.

3. Was there an Olympic idea in Antiquity?

Question 3: Why do we need antiquity for the modern Olympic Games?

The way the question is phrased conceptually means that there is no way around antiquity. We, as human beings, are inherently tied to “a” past. Hence, we need antiquity to understand the past to not make the same mistake and to make good decisions for the future regarding different issues, since it is uncovering the causes and conditions of our present. It represents our cultural origins as human beings. Consequently, taking antiquity into consideration is a way of becoming aware of the evolution of our species linked with the development of sport. Apart from this remembering, being confronted with an ancient culture can also be something irritating for us. As we can learn something through something that differs from ours, antiquity can make us think about our contemporary sports culture in a deeper way. Moreover, through ancient physical activities and their facilities, modern Olympic Games took inspiration. They also represent symbols of antiquity, keeping legitimacy in organising such a big event. Thus, different societies in different times draw their own picture/interpretation of the ancient games (e.g. in the 20th century, because of an upcoming new concept of civil society, it was centred around agonist (*citius, altius, fortius*), but nowadays this is shifting more towards unifying and community aspect (*citius, altius, fortius, communiter*; as seen with the development of the Paralympics). To conclude, if we do not learn our history, we are condemned to repeat it. Without the past, we are unable to understand the present, and are unable to conceptualise future perspectives.

4. What is the value of Olympic Victory?

Question 4: Do we need Olympic Victors today?

Today, Olympic Victors play an important role far beyond sport. They symbolise excellence, perseverance and dedication, and are a source of inspiration for millions of people around the world. Through their personal stories, surpassing yourself and obstacles, they embody values that transcend sport, providing a source of motivation and hope in a world that often needs role models to embody discipline and resilience.

Olympic victors also play an essential role in promoting global unity and national pride. The Olympic Games are one of the rare events where countries sometimes put aside their political differences to compete peacefully, making the winners ambassadors of international harmony. At a national level, their victories can inspire entire populations, becoming symbols of collective achievement and identity. This can be particularly important for certain nations that are less visible and less powerful on the international stage. So, Olympic success is also a unique source of pride and unity.

However, the celebration of Olympic victors is not without its critics. Some argue that the Games can promote elitism, as athletes from the wealthiest nations often dominate the competition, sometimes overshadowing the global need for equity and inclusion. In addition, new social issues, such as mental health, social justice and environmental sustainability, raise questions that international and national bodies must address. Therefore, while Olympic victors remain important, there is a growing need to ensure that Games organising committees take into account changing societal values.

5. Can Athletes Use Their Abilities and Fame to Make a Better World?

Question 5: What is the definition of a woman for the purpose of Olympics and sports?

The definition of a “woman” in the context of the Olympics is determined by the policies of governing sports organisations, such as the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and International Sports Federations (IFs). These policies have tried to evolve over the last 50 years. Historically, the definition of a woman in sports was based on biological factors of sex, which were defined by a person’s physical appearance. Often this involved physical examinations or chromosomal testing (so called *nude parade*). Over time, however, these methods have been criticised for being invasive and for not accounting for the complexities of biological sex and social gender.

Gender is defined as a social and cultural construction. A person’s gender is how they identify internally and how they express this externally. There is no fixed number of gender identities. They occur on a spectrum, which really means that the possibilities are infinite. Nowadays, the topic of gender and sex

is primarily considered around testosterone level. But even with this proposed solution, there lies an implicit definition of female on a biological level, although federations try to introduce a gendered perspective into their regulations. In general, we can see that federations (especially IAAF, FIG, IOC) uphold a gendered logic of “reading athletes” as male and female, which is justified by the ideal of equal opportunities and fairness in competition.

On the basis of a meritocratic order and the principle of performance, a gender hierarchy is implied in sports, which means that people have to clearly position themselves in a binary system (male/female) in order to participate in the sporting system. As research in social sciences show (e.g. Heckemeyer 2017), all athletes are targeted by gender-verifying assessments and have to prove that they are women, as a suspected case only arises if a female athlete is better than socially accepted. We can see this with the *Hyperandrogenism Regulations* which only come into practice, when female (!) athletes are considered being “too male”, i.e. “too strong”. As a consequence, female athletes then explicitly need to portray and perform stereotypical female-read behaviour in order to remain their integrity regarding their femininity. As of now, the implicit Olympic image of women is a stereotypical, hetero-normative and sexualised one.

Therefore, the definition of women in the Olympic context should not be static but should reflect current understandings from the fields of sports science, social development, and individual gender identity. As well as, the specific techniques or skills required in each distinct sport event. This approach advocates for a more nuanced and inclusive definition that respects both scientific criteria and the diverse experiences of athletes. It may be necessary to conduct certain physical level testing scales and psychological gender self-awareness scales, and combine the two to define women in the Olympics, sport by sport.

This topic – right now – remains to be unsolved, as we can see with the discussions in boxing during the Paris 2024 Olympic Games. This topic is not only to be discussed in high-performance sports, but is a fundamentally social and educational issue in which we need to rethink the primate of a binary (male-female) system in sports from early childhood onwards.

6. The Principle of Competition and the Performance Concept in Ancient Greek Athletics

Question 6: What was interesting for you in this lecture (ca. two sentences)?

Name	What was interesting for you in this lecture (ca. two sentences)?
Thomas	The importance of honor and shame in ancient Greek society, particularly in athletics. I was impressed that they would sometimes withdraw from competitions if they felt they had no chance of winning to avoid the disgrace of losing. From my point of view, it's a mentality we try to avoid in our modern society, and I think it is a cowardly way of thinking.
Emily	The lecture discussed the ancient Greek concept of athletic competition, emphasising the cultural significance of honour, glory, and personal virtue. Unlike today's focus on statistics and record-breaking, ancient Greek athletes competed not only for victory but also for moral excellence.
Zikun	The first one is related to individual sport and team sport. In ancient Greece, people only competed in individual sports for absolute advantage in terms of speed, strength, power. However, in modern society, team sports are highly valued (at least in American context) by parents and schools, as people firmly believe one of the best places to develop teamwork and comradeship is team sports. This sharp contrast reflects the sociocultural and even political evolution from ancient times to contemporary society.

7. Women's World Boxing Championships 2023 Management: an overview

Question 7: Plan your international sport event

Welcome to the 1st IOA Mini-Olympics. This exciting event is organised by students and will take place during the 64th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors (YOA). It will include a series of ancient Greek sports competitions and ceremonies all aimed at promoting the Olympic spirit and Olympic values among young ambassadors. In order to ensure everything runs smoothly, we have focused on eight key areas. You will find below the plan of the event and then a more detailed view of each functional area.

Plan of the 1st IOA Mini-Olympics taking place from 17 to 21 June 2025

17 March	Corporate design development, contact agencies for SPC, COM starts brand image design, FIN starts looking for financial support
17 April	SPC confirms VIPs, FIN confirms financial supports and plans budget

19 May	COM begins pre-launch campaign, SPC checks equipment, VOL starts training plan, TEC prepares website sections
20-30 May	AAA handles room reservations and subscriptions, TEC prepares hardware for media and event rooms
1 June	AAA finalizes lists of athletes, volunteers, VIPs, and media, COM reminds media about accreditation deadlines
2 June	AAA starts accreditation production
3 June	VOL conducts volunteer training, SPC sets up cameras, VEN assists
10-16 June	COM organises press conference, FIN manages resource allocation, SPC rehearses for Opening Ceremony
17 June	Day 1 : Opening Ceremony SPC manages Opening Ceremony, COM runs media center, VOL briefs volunteers, FIN calculates daily costs
18 June	Day 2 : Races and javelin events SPC runs half-time shows, COM holds press conference for medalists
19 June	Day 3 : Long jump and discus events SPC runs half-time shows, COM manages media center, VOL briefs volunteers
20 June	Day 4 : Wrestling event SPC runs half-time shows, COM manages media center, FIN calculates costs, VOL briefs volunteers
21 June	Day 5 : Closing Ceremony SPC rehearses for Closing Ceremony, COM manages media center, FIN calculates daily costs, VOL holds volunteer meeting
28 June	COM starts post-event social media campaign, VOL distributes volunteer survey and certificates
21 July	COM continues social media campaign, publishes legacy report, FIN delivers financial report

1. Administration, Accreditation & Accommodation (AAA)

First of all, the AAA team will handle accommodation for VIPs, media, and officials, making sure all rooms are reserved. Additionally, they will manage the accreditation process, which involves collecting information and preparing cards for athletes, volunteers, and VIPs.

2. Finance & Account (FIN)

Meanwhile, the finance team will be responsible for securing sponsorships and

financial support. Not only will they plan the budget, but they will also control costs and make sure resources are used wisely. After the event, they will prepare a report to show how the funds were managed, ensuring transparency and accountability.

3. Medical (MED)

In terms of health and safety, the medical team's role is essential. They will conduct pre-event health checks and set up emergency response protocols. Furthermore, they will provide on-site medical support during the event, being ready to handle any injuries or health concerns. Their preparation will ensure all participants can compete safely.

4. Venue (VEN)

As for the venues, the venue team will prepare all event locations by conducting safety checks, setting up signage, and ensuring everything is ready for the participants' arrival. In addition, they will assist the Sport Presentation team with rehearsals, making sure the venue is in top condition for the opening and closing ceremonies.

5. Sport Presentation & Ceremonies (SPC)

When it comes to the event's entertainment, the SPC team is responsible for organising the opening and closing ceremonies, as well as half-time shows and award presentations. They will work closely with VIPs and performers to ensure everything runs smoothly. Moreover, they will conduct rehearsals ahead of the event to guarantee a flawless execution during the ceremonies.

6. Technology (TEC)

On the technology side, the TEC team will create sections on the IOA website for athlete and volunteer registration. In addition, they will prepare all the necessary equipment for the media centre and ensure that all technological aspects are working smoothly throughout the event.

7. Volunteers (VOL)

Next, we have the volunteers, who are essential for the success of the event. The VOL team will recruit, train, and organise volunteers to assist in various roles, such as supporting the competition, guiding VIPs, and helping spectators. In addition to this, the team will ensure that all volunteers are fully briefed and prepared for their tasks.

8. Communications (COM)

Finally, the communications team will manage media and public relations. They will start by designing the event's brand and then launch a media campaign in May to build excitement. During the event, they will handle press releases and operate the media centre. After the event, they will continue the campaign on social media and publish a report to highlight the event's success.

8. Sport policies in post-socialist countries, the importance of Olympic success in the region

Question 8: What elements of socialist or post-socialist sport can you recognise in your own country's sport policy? Give examples, evaluate if it is positive (P) or negative (N).

The countries we used for comparison include Brazil, China, France, Germany, Italy, Spain, Switzerland, and the USA.

Positive Commonalities

1. Government Support and Infrastructure Investment: Across various countries, government involvement in sports development is a common theme. In countries like China, Brazil, and Germany, state support plays a key role in sports infrastructure and athlete training. In Switzerland and Spain, public entities also support elite and grassroots sports, with a focus on sport for all.

2. Balance between Mass Sport and Elite Sport: Countries like France, Spain, Switzerland, and Italy promote both mass participation in sports through physical education and support for elite athletes. They ensure broad access to

physical activity while also providing resources for high-performance athletes to excel internationally, which creates a well-rounded sports ecosystem.

3. Collaborative Public-Private Systems: Many countries have a mixture of public and private support for sports. In countries like Italy, France, and Spain, private clubs collaborate with public institutions to develop talent. In the USA, player unions and salary caps ensure a fair distribution of wealth, promoting equity within professional leagues.

Negative Commonalities

1. State Control and Pressure on Athletes: Socialist and post-socialist countries such as China and the former East Germany have faced criticism for prioritising international success over athletes' well-being. Harsh training regimens and centralised control create immense pressure on athletes, leading to issues such as physical and psychological burnout, as seen in China.

2. Doping and Performance Pressures: The legacy of doping, particularly in Eastern Germany, points to the darker side of state-run sports programmes, where success was sometimes achieved at the expense of athlete health. While this has led to advancements in training science, it is a negative consequence of ideological competition.

3. Paternalism in Coach-Athlete Relationships: Countries like Brazil exhibit a paternalistic culture in sports, where coaches wield significant authority over athletes, sometimes to their detriment. This can hinder athlete autonomy and development.

9. The Two Sides of the Olympic Medal: Internationalism and National Identity

Question 9: What was interesting for you in this lecture?

Because Olympic diplomacy involves both internationalism and national identity, we selected a topic about: How do the Olympics promote diplomacy?

While the Olympics are primarily a sports event, they hold a unique diplomatic function, helping to build relationships between countries and foster global cooperation. The Olympic Games promote diplomacy in several

significant ways, providing a platform for peaceful international interaction, cultural exchange, and conflict resolution.

1. Olympic Truce: Inspired by the ancient Greek tradition, the Olympic Truce is promoted by the International Olympic Committee (IOC) to encourage a cessation of hostilities and conflicts during the Games. Although symbolic, the truce highlights the potential for sports to inspire peace and reconciliation in conflict areas.

2. Encouraging Diplomatic Engagement: The process of preparing for and participating in the Olympics often involves diplomatic outreach, negotiations, and collaboration between countries, as nations work together to ensure successful events. Diplomatic channels are opened or strengthened as a result.

3. IOC & International Partnerships: The IOC works with various international organisations, including the United Nations, to promote values like peace, development, and sustainability.

10. Volunteer Management in South Asian Games

Question 10: Volunteer management.

- Make a road map of volunteer management based on SWOT analysis.

Event: 1st IOA Mini-Olympics during the 64th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors (8th - 21st June 2024)

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
The event benefits from highly motivated volunteers passionate about the Olympic Movement and IOA diverse communication channels and reputation . Pre-established teamwork among volunteers and athletes, high-quality facilities , and the potential for volunteers to enhance their resumes with certifications would strengthen the event. Additionally, training manuals and experienced trainers ensure a well-prepared volunteer team.	Maintaining volunteer's motivation during long or repetitive tasks, limited personal skill development, and challenges in managing unpaid volunteers pose significant weaknesses. The need for time to train volunteers and the lack of long-term follow-up also present challenges.

OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
The event offers opportunities for multicultural exchange, skill-building, and fostering global connections. Participants can gain valuable experience in cooperation across event departments, improve English skills, and create lasting memories and friendships. The event's Olympic context encourages further involvement and may inspire future voluntary work.	Potential threats include competition for volunteers from concurrent events, security risks such as terrorist attacks, and regulatory changes that might limit large-scale gatherings. Economic instability could affect sponsorship, and logistical challenges due to dispersed venues may complicate volunteer management. Cultural and language barriers, legal risks, and unexpected events like natural disasters or volunteer dropouts also pose significant risks.

Road map of volunteer management in our event:

19th May	VOL: Training planning; clothes
20th-30th May	AAA: Subscription for the athletes and <u>volunteers</u> .
1st June	AAA: Athletes, <u>volunteers</u> , VIPs, media and referees list.
2nd June	AAA: Accreditation production.
3rd June	VOL: Training, allocation of positions, schedule communication.
10th-16th June	VOL: Manager meeting.
17 June	SPC OPENING CEREMONY MANAGEMENT (FLAGBEARERS, ATHLETES AND VIP) VOL: Volunteer briefing (morning, accreditation, clothes,...); Post-meeting
18 June	RACES (MORNING) AND JAVELIN (AFTERNOON) VOL: Morning Briefing; Post-meeting
19 June	LONG JUMP AND DISCUS (PARALLEL) VOL: Morning Briefing; Post-meeting
20 June	WRESTLING VOL: Morning Briefing; Post-meeting
21st June	CLOSING CEREMONY VOL: • Morning Briefing; Post-meeting • Volunteer's party
28th June	VOL: • Survey to the volunteers to have their opinion. • Certificate delivery.

11. Volunteer Management in South Asian Games

Question 11. How Volunteer Management can foster unity and equality?

- Positive connotation of Olympic contexts.
- Lasting international friendships.
- The problem of unequal treatment during the games (exploit, different accommodation, insurance).
- Integration of volunteers into organising staff and athletes (exchange/contact with them) can foster unity.
- Fosters an inclusive and equal environment where there is no hierarchy regarding the volunteering tasks. All volunteer positions are treated equally.
- Except for certain physical requirements for certain positions, there should be no discrimination to gender, age, religion, country of origin, etc.
- Integrate volunteers into the entire event organising ecosystem, recognising and valuing their contributions as essential to the success of the event.
- Volunteer recognition and rewards: By recognising volunteers' contributions in a fair and transparent manner, ensuring that every volunteer's effort is equally acknowledged, it enhances their sense of belonging and participation.
- Improve the self-awareness of a community, become less selfish and turn to the group. Understanding the greater good comes from helping the community, and not just yourself. As a result, you become an example for the rest of society of how a member of the community should act.

12. “Family Olympic Games” An Innovative Approach to Olympic Movement

Question 12: Innovate your own games to promote Olympic Movement & Olympic Values. (Not with contemporary sports event)

1st IOA Mini-Olympics during the 64th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors (8th - 21st June 2024)

For the “Family Olympic Activities”, we plan to implement non-contemporary sports, engaging not only Young Olympic Ambassadors but also young people from the high school located in Olympia. The selection of these sports aims to promote and reinforce the Olympic Values: excellence, respect and friendship. Each sport proposed here will have a direct connection to one or more of these values, encouraging participants to embody them through the activities and their daily actions.

- Rope skipping (Excellence)
- Mölkky (Respect)
- The Game of Islands (Friendship)

13. The Athlete in Modern India: Inspiring and Fostering Unity in Diversity

Question 13:

- Identify the common points of National Sports Policy in your working group members.
 - Organisation of federations
 - National sport policy in each country
 - Scholarships and dual career programmes
 - Big influence from the National Government
 - Explicit recognition of the role of Sport and Physical Activity as essential activities
 - Cooperation between NOCs and National Federations
 - Multi-layered system that categorises sport participation into different levels
 - Encourage young people and mass participation

14. Understanding Olympism as a Philosophical Ideal

Question 14: What is special about an Olympic Athlete?

An Olympic athlete represents a unique combination of physical prowess, mental fortitude, and societal influence. Several factors set them apart from other athletes, and their distinction can be explored through the following five key points:

1. Elite Performance: Olympic athletes demonstrate exceptional levels of performance, consistently achieving superior results in their respective sports. Their participation in the Olympics signifies that they are among the best in the world, having qualified through rigorous national and international competitions. Their physical abilities, combined with advanced training techniques and strategies, allow them to push the boundaries of human performance.

2. Rituals and symbols: Athletes are essential participants and integral components of the Olympic Movement, particularly within the realm of sports competitions. When they appear in televised broadcasts or other public events, they embody the identity of Olympic athletes, serving not only as symbols of their nations but also as representatives of the values and ideologies inherent in the Olympic Movement. The cyclical nature of the Olympic Games is mirrored by the periodic visibility of these athletes, who function as both icons of the Olympic structure, national identity, and statehood, and as advocates for individual causes, such as gender equality.

3. Discipline: The path to becoming an Olympic athlete demands an extraordinary level of discipline. This encompasses strict adherence to training regimens, dietary restrictions, and mental conditioning. Their ability to maintain focus and commitment over many years, often in the face of adversity, is critical to their success. Discipline is also reflected in their capacity to balance their personal lives with the demands of their athletic careers, making sacrifices that are necessary to compete at the highest level.

4. Hard Work: Behind every Olympic performance is an immense amount of hard work. Olympic athletes undergo years of intensive training, often starting from a young age, and face continuous physical and mental challenges. Their dedication to constant improvement is essential in an environment where even the smallest of margins can determine the outcome of a competition. The work ethic they demonstrate serves as a foundation for their success, enabling them to overcome obstacles and perform under pressure.

5. Role Model: Olympic athletes often assume the role of role models in society. Their perseverance, dedication, and sportsmanship provide inspiration to people of all ages. They serve as embodiments of what can be achieved through commitment and determination. As public figures, they have a responsibility to uphold values of fairness, integrity, and respect, setting positive examples for future generations of athletes and the broader public.

6. Influence: The influence of Olympic athletes extends beyond the sports arena. As global icons, they can impact societal values, particularly in areas such as health, fitness, and teamwork. Many Olympic athletes use their platform to promote causes such as environmental sustainability, education, or social justice. Their visibility and success allow them to be powerful advocates for positive change, influencing cultural and social norms on a broad scale.

15. The “Olympic Athlete” as a Personal Ideal

Question 15: What is special about Olympic Sport?

- Take a phrase or word from FOP#4. Give a positive and/or negative example of an event that demonstrates this concept (or its opposite)

FOP#4. “The practice of sport is a human right. Every individual must have access to the practice of sport, without discrimination of any kind in respect of internationally recognised human rights within the remit of the Olympic Movement. The Olympic spirit requires mutual understanding with a spirit of friendship, solidarity and fair play” (International Olympic Committee, 2024, p. 8).

Useful words from the text:

- Human right
- Access to the practice
- Discrimination
- Friendship
- Solidarity
- Fairplay

Positive Example: The Olympic Games have been a platform for remarkable displays of solidarity, unity, and friendship, transcending competition. One of the

most memorable moments occurred at the Tokyo 2020 men's high jump final, where Gianmarco Tamberi and Mutaz Barshim shared a gold medal, symbolising a deep bond forged through mutual support. Similarly, the establishment of the Refugee Olympic Team at the 2016 Rio Games underscored the Olympic principle that sport is a human right, offering displaced athletes a chance to compete. The mutual encouragement between gymnasts from different nations at Paris 2024 further exemplify how Olympism fosters cooperation and solidarity across borders. These acts of friendship and support inspire young athletes, showcasing how values like resilience, unity, and empowerment can thrive in sports.

Negative Example: However, the Olympic Games have also been marred by controversies and tragic events that stand in stark contrast to their ideals. The 1980 Moscow Olympics saw a major boycott led by the United States, which prevented many athletes from competing due to political conflict. The exclusion of certain athletes due to hyperandrogenism regulations and the internal conflicts within South Korea's short track speed skating team reveal deeper issues of exclusion, bullying, and abuse that tarnish the Olympic spirit. These examples, underscore how the Games can become entangled in politics, conflict, and exclusion, challenging the core values of equality and mutual understanding.

16. The “Olympic Spirit” as an Ethical Ideal

Question 16: What is special about the Olympic logo?

- Symbolises the unity and solidarity of the five continents.
 - Symbolises the idea of bringing the world together through sport.
 - Colors reflect diversity and inclusivity, representing athletes from all backgrounds.
 - Symbolises the interconnectivity among diversity
 - It has not changed since its creation, it gives a good idea of the modernity of that logo
 - the 5 rings are of the same size, symbolising equality
 - One of the most valuable symbols as a brand in the business world
- How does the logo demonstrate FOP#2?

FOP#2. “The goal of Olympism is to place sport at the service

of the harmonious development of humankind, with a view to promoting a peaceful society concerned with the preservation of human dignity” (International Olympic Committee, 2024, p. 8).

Useful words from the text:

- Goal of Olympism
- Harmonious development of humankind
- Peaceful society
- Human dignity

Demonstration of FOP#2:

- The interconnectedness of the rings symbolises that different cultures can unite through athletic competition, promoting mutual respect and understanding.
- Harmony and peace would only be achieved through the joint efforts made through interconnectedness and solidarity among all five continents.
- The preservation of human dignity requires the whole humankind across all different nation-states, cultures, ethnicities, and ideologies.

17. Safeguarding versus winning at all cost: Vulnerabilities and responsibilities of the actors in youth sport

Question 17: Larry Nassar Documentary

The tension between safeguarding and the pursuit of winning at all costs in youth sports highlights a critical ethical dilemma. In some instances, athletes are vulnerable to emotional, verbal, physical, or even sexual abuse by coaches or authority figures who exploit their power, as shown in this documentary. The film recounts how Nassar, while working for the USA Gymnastics and Michigan State University, sexually abused hundreds of female gymnasts under the guise of medical treatment.

Importantly, young athletes are even more vulnerable because they have not yet become national heroes and lack the power to speak out. The “win-at-all-costs” culture can isolate athletes emotionally, making them feel that their worth is only tied to their performance or results. Young athletes may endure

gender-based abuse continuously out of fear of retaliation or losing opportunities to compete. At the same time, sports organisations and governing bodies may cover up and deny these illegal actions for the purpose of “gold medals”.

In conclusion, the relentless pressure to win can create a harmful environment, leading to the neglect of the physical and emotional well-being of young athletes. Sports organisations should place greater emphasis on the physical and mental well-being of youth athletes, not only for their own development but also for the integrity and sustainability of sports.

Closing Ceremony

10 OCTOBER 2024



ADDRESS
on behalf of the Seminar's Participants
by Zhihao JIANG (CHN)

Dear President, esteemed professors, fellow students, ladies and gentlemen,

Good morning! It's a great honor for Emily and me, to stand here today, as representatives of the 31st International Seminar in Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students at the International Olympic Academy. Over the past 20-plus days, we've had an incredible experience here in Olympia, one filled with learning, cultural exchange, and a deep connection to the Olympic spirit.

In our academic sessions, we have had the privilege of exploring the rich history and philosophy behind the Olympic Movement. We've seen how the ancient ideals of Olympism are tied to peace, education, and the improvement of society. Our studies also looked at how these principles continue to evolve, touching on important issues like gender equality, fair play, and sustainability in the modern world. Every lecture, every discussion, helped us gain a deeper understanding of how the Olympic values can influence not just sports, but the world around us.

Of course, **our time outside the classroom** has been just as meaningful. We've put the Olympic spirit into action through sports, whether running on the track, playing team games, or taking part in friendly competitions. These moments weren't just about physical activity – they were about building friendships and understanding each other better. We learned firsthand how sports bring people together, helping us overcome barriers of nationality, language, and culture, and reminding us of the core Olympic values of respect, unity, and excellence.

Life at the Academy has been equally enriching. Waking up each day in the historic setting of Olympia, surrounded by its natural beauty and deep cultural significance, has been a powerful experience. We've shared this journey with classmates from all over the world, forming a close-knit community where we've supported each other, learned from one another, and celebrated the diversity

that makes this experience so special. The friendships we've built here will last long after we leave, and they're a true reflection of the Olympic ideal of unity.

As we prepare to wrap up this incredible time, we feel a strong sense of responsibility. The lessons we've learned, the values we've embraced, and the connections we've made will guide us as we move forward in our academic and professional lives. We're committed to carrying the Olympic spirit with us, promoting its ideals of peace, equality, and cooperation wherever we go.

On behalf of all the students, I'd like to sincerely thank the professors, staff, and everyone who made this seminar such a success. Your dedication, wisdom, and passion have left a lasting impact on all of us.

Let's continue to let the Olympic spirit inspire us as we aim for excellence, foster friendships, and work towards a more peaceful, united world.

Thank you! Thank you very much!

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Seminar's Participants
by Emily KOHLER (BRA)

Good afternoon, everyone.

Honestly, it is difficult to say anything after Zhihao's speech. I saw myself, and I believe that every student felt represented by him. Thank you so much for your words, Zhihao!

For those who don't know me, I am Emily Kohler, from Brazil.

I am here, representing the Centre of Olympic and Paralympic Studies at the Federal University of Rio Grande do Sul. I would like to dedicate this speech to Professor Adroaldo Gaya, who passed away yesterday. He was one of the biggest references in Physical Education in Brazil and was responsible for enhancing the discipline of sports in Brazilian schools.

I am a former Brazilian athletics athlete and a sports survivor.

It isn't easy to find the words to describe these three weeks here and what they mean to me. I tried, and I hope to honour everyone who brought me here.

Unfortunately, during my time as an athlete, I didn't have the best sports experiences, but that doesn't mean I don't believe in how powerful sports can be. Quite the opposite. Despite every episode of violence, abuse, control, conflict of interest, and corruption, I still can see the world and my world being changed through the Olympic spirit.

(I can see) When my professor of physical education drove 70 kilometres once a week to let me attend a social athletics project in a neighbouring city while I was dealing with bullying at school. When I couldn't wear my shoes due to overtraining, burnout, and depression, and my professors at the university paid for me some therapy sessions and treatment at a university hospital due to my health condition.

My professors changed my life. Professors have the power to change lives. That's why, I want to express my deepest respect to all the professors, particularly

those we had the privilege of having in our Seminar. Dear professors, we see you. We can see the spirit of Olympism reflected in your lives and your dedication to enhancing the spot and creating a better world.

I'm very aware of my responsibility in this position. It involves representing not only my colleagues but also over forty former and current athletes who survived with me and are still suffering without any support or understanding. To the International Olympic Academy, I would like to say thank you for having me here. It means that my life, and those lives that I carry with me, matter.

I feel seen, not just for you but for the Olympic community. I no longer feel alone. As Tarik pointed out in one of our classes, I can see something solid here – coming from solidarity. Our diverse backgrounds, cultures, and experiences have expanded our perspectives, enriching our lives and fostering unity. I have recognised the Olympic values in every one of you!

I want to close my speech, leaving you with a message of hope and determination. Despite the challenges, the spirit of Olympism continues to inspire change, not just in the world of sports but in the hearts and minds of those who believe in its values. I am confident that every postgraduate student here embodies the spirit of this remarkable and mythical place. Motivated by its magic, we are prepared to champion fairness, inclusion, and respect for everyone. Together, we can forge a future where Olympism is available to all.

ADDRESS
by the Coordinator
Dimitris CHARALAMBIDIS (GRE)

Good morning! My name is Dimitris Charalampidis and I am a volunteer in the Postgraduate programme as a coordinator. It has been a pleasure participating and offering my assistance to this cause. These 20 days have been very productive and substantial both for the students and for the Olympic idea. During this time, we set our goals and worked in order to achieve them. Researching and studying the everlasting spirit of Olympism, discussing the present and planning for the future of the Olympic Games were some of our main objectives, and from my perspective, they have been successfully completed.

From the 20th of September, we visited various archaeological sites from Greek antiquity of tremendous historical value. Athens, with the Acropolis, Epidaurus with its theater, an architectural masterpiece, Nemea, where one of the four Panhellenic games took place, and of course Olympia, the birthplace of the Olympic Games, one of the most important and sacred sport, religious and cultural events not only of antiquity but of our days as well.

In our group, we had a total of nine different nationalities. What could have been thought as a problem for communication and synchronisation, we used it as an advantage. Multiculturalism helped us come in contact with the unknown and discover new aspects of the world and of ourselves. New ideas, and different ways of thinking in combination with the breathtaking facilities and climate of the International Olympic Academy, were key points for our progress and achievement of our tasks and goals. These were the reasons we managed to keep going higher, faster, stronger, together, each and every day.

Our professors did an excellent job of sharing their knowledge and experience. With their lectures always on point and themselves willing to help at any time, they successfully managed to make clear and transmit what Olympism is about and most importantly, how to be a living part of it. We learned about the origins

of the Olympic Games and their transition until the present day. We learned how to question, to explore and navigate through culture, history and society. We discussed ethics, ideals, values and their importance in today's world as a basis for the future of Olympism.

As the last day has reached us, the feelings are mixed. On the one hand, I am sad that this journey has come to an end. On the other hand, I am more than happy and thankful to acquire this knowledge, be here, work with people who share the same values and experience Olympism in person, who flows all over the sacred place of Olympia.

The eternal values of the Olympic spirit will live on as long as we acknowledge their importance, promote and apply them, not only in an elite and professional level, but most importantly in our daily lives, each and everyone of us. Being privileged to participate in this programme and having assimilated all this knowledge, it is now our responsibility to share the Olympic values with the rest of the world, as the International Olympic Academy taught us, as they truly are.

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Supervising Professors
by Prof. Heather L. REID (ITA/USA)

Dear Olympic Friends,

Imagine it is the year 480 BCE and we are here in Olympia, sitting on the slope of the stadium watching the final of the *stadion* race. We see Astylos of Syracuse (my adopted hometown) pull ahead on the track. He has already won this race in the previous two Olympic Games and prevailed in the *diavlos* and *hoplitodromos* this year. His bronzed body shining with oil, he runs with such speed and beauty that, just for a moment, we think we are witnessing a god. It feels as if Achilles or Hermes somehow materialises before our eyes. It is an epiphany, and just what we had hoped to experience in this religious context. In that moment, the immeasurable distance between our imperfect human reality and the divine ideal collapses. We feel a special kind of connection to the others around us who share that experience, and we gain hope as a community that if we do our best, we too can bring ourselves and our world closer to the ideal. We absorb Olympia's energy into our souls and return to our homes inspired.

Today, more than 2,500 years later, the 2024 Postgraduate Seminar has done much the same thing in the same place with the same energy. We no longer share the same language or religion, we have shown nothing close to the athletic excellence of Astylos, and we no longer compete in the nude. But Olympia has stripped us of our cultural prejudices, our assumptions about sport, and the meaning of the Games. Somehow, we too have witnessed a kind of epiphany: an epiphany of ideas. By coming here and struggling together to better understand Olympic ideas, by facing the challenges posed by our diverse languages, experiences, and perspectives, we have formed an Olympic community committed to the constant improvement of ourselves and our world.

Academia is really not so different from sport. As scholars, we voluntarily engage with difficult challenges, we commit ourselves to knowledge and try to

stay focused, we wrestle with our own ideas and those of dissenting colleagues, we get discouraged, frustrated, confused, exhausted, and yet we keep going because the pursuit of truth ennobles us and our world – even if we never reach the final goal, maybe *because* we may never reach the final goal. What matters is to keep struggling, to keep trying to understand, together.

For nearly three millennia people have come together here in Olympia to get closer to ideals. This seminar has given us students and lecturers the privilege of participating in that tradition. But the tradition itself is being kept alive by the International Olympic Academy, whose existence depends on the hard work and sacrifice of many more people within and outside of academia and the Olympic Movement – from those who drive us here, to those who water the plants, clean the rooms, fix the computers, prepare our meals, serve us coffee, administer our programs, and especially Kostas Georgiadis, its Dean, who has stubbornly kept this great ship afloat and directed toward Olympism in frequently stormy weather.

So we warmly thank all of these people and promise them that their efforts – like those of the runner Astylos – to help collapse the gap between imperfect reality and Olympic ideals, will be repaid. For we too have absorbed Olympia's energy into our souls, formed a lasting community, and will return to our homes inspired.

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Supervising Professors
by Prof. Dr Em. Jan TOLLENEER (BEL)

Dear students, dear colleagues, dear Academy staff members,

I would like to begin my brief speech at this Closing Ceremony of Thursday 10 October 2024 with... the ending. The traditional conclusion is a word of thanks. Let me start with that now. We thank the International Olympic Academy for its hospitality. The Academy's programmes, especially the postgraduate seminars, have a lasting impact.

We thank Prof. Kostas Georgiadis for his tireless dedication and continuous inspiration. We thank Gina and Anastasia, and all the administrative and technical staff members (including the bar, kitchen, and maintenance staff, and let's not forget the IT personnel). They have shown their helpfulness on a daily basis and, even more so, their resourcefulness. What a beautiful word that is: full of resources, full of skills to help. And, of course, we thank you, the students, for being here in Olympia, for giving the best of yourselves. Thank you for taking care of one another.

Taking care of each other, respecting each other, and respecting each other's integrity – these have all been presented as ideals to strive for during the various lessons and working groups in these autumn weeks of 2024. Sport, and especially Olympic and Paralympic sport, can serve as a showcase for presenting these ideals to the world. We are stating the obvious or "kicking in an open door" when we say that they can be an instrument for bringing peace and brotherhood.

The Olympic Village and the entire event in Paris during the summer of 2024 radiated these ideals. Top athletes from very diverse cultural backgrounds came together and learned from one another. That also happened here, in this smaller village just a stone's throw away from the archaeological site of Olympia. However, in this educational setting, there was also enough space and time to distance ourselves from Paris and the superlatives expressed there.

The 2024 Games, and modern sport in general, with their pursuit of excellence and hunt for medals, remain a captivating spectacle. They function as a magnet for commercial companies and nation-states. Strong forces are at work to preserve this remarkable cultural phenomenon, and to protect the integrity of this phenomenon, symbol, product, and brand. As you know, this is called “the integrity of sport”. It is heartening to see that the postgraduate students deeply understand that there is also something else, perhaps even more important: paying attention to “integrity in sport”. Not so much the integrity *of* sport, but integrity *within* sport: the integrity of all those involved in sport.

You are familiar with the concepts of moral integrity on the one hand, and mental, physical, and sexual integrity on the other hand. And how these are connected when we closely examine the various actors. Closely examine – what a fitting expression when talking about a postgraduate programme! We expect you to continue to apply the critical thinking you have demonstrated here, and do this in your further studies, in your job, and in your life.

Let me give you one more point of attention. Please, do not only focus on the rights and sensitivities of the athletes who made it to Paris 2024. That remains a small and privileged group. Also pay attention to the countless others who didn’t make it, who had to drop out along the way. Interview them too, give them a voice, and try to learn from them as well – about vulnerabilities and responsibilities, and how we can make sport better and safer.

The Olympic Movement and the students of the Olympic Academy are well-positioned to make a difference in these areas in the future and to strive for a better world in and through sport. Keep up the good work, try to realise your dreams, make concrete plans, and stay in touch if you want – you have our contact details. And remember: a plan is a dream with a deadline ;-)

By means of conclusion, and in line with our discussion on artificial intelligence and its opportunities and threats: This morning we were in a kind of musical mood, and we asked ChatGPT how Bob Dylan would convert this little speech into a new song. To give you an idea, here is verse 1 and also the chorus.

*Well, they gather in the village, under the sun’s fading light
Olympic dreams hang heavy, in the quiet of the night
From Paris to Olympia, they traveled hand in hand
Searching for the answers, in the dust of ancient lands*

*A plan is a dream with a deadline, so keep pushing on
The road isn't easy, and the climb's never done
Take care of each other, don't forget who you are
'Cause the brightest of lights, sometimes burn from afar*

CLOSING ADDRESS
by the Dean of the International Olympic Academy
Prof. Dr Konstantinos GEORGIADIS

Dear colleagues,

For the last 31 years I address the students at the Closing Ceremony of the works of the International Seminar on Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students, reviewing the work done.

The Professors who were selected to contribute to the works of this Seminar through academic lectures and discussions, helped all of you to embrace the philosophy and the humanistic approach of the Olympic Movement but also look for the deeper meaning of sports action and Olympism.

And you, the young researchers coming from eight different countries, who applied to participate in this Seminar, eager to acquire further and deeper knowledge on Olympic issues, also enriched with your ideas the structure, philosophy and content of this programme.

I believe that through your active participation you have become aware of the potentials and the educational opportunities that Olympism offers us and that we close the works of the Seminar today leaving a positive legacy for it.

The IOA expects you to become active ambassadors of the Olympic Ideal in your countries, transferring the knowledge you acquired here in Olympia by becoming active members in your NOAs through the creation of innovative programmes of Olympic education.

I would like to thank Professor Reid, Professor Tolleneer and Mr Wallechinsky who are here with us today as well as all the other Supervising Professors, Prof. Xydopoulos, Prof. Laemmer, Prof. Gupta and Dr Bukta for their contribution to the 31st International Seminar. And of course, I would like to thank all of you wholeheartedly for participating actively in the Seminar, showing responsibility and respect to each other. I am sure you will be leaving from the IOA full of educational memories, new ideas, experiences and friendships.

Finally, I would like to thank Gina for all the administrative work she has done throughout the year, the coordinator of the Seminar, Dimitris, and Vaggelis, who is responsible for the premises.

We wish all of you wholeheartedly all the best for the future.

A grayscale photograph of a long row of flags on tall poles, receding into the distance along a paved path. The flags are of various designs, including some with stars. The path is bordered by trees and bushes. The text "List of Participants" is overlaid in the center.

List of Participants

EPHORIA OF THE INTERNATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY

Mr Isidoros KOUVELOΣ

President, International Olympic Academy

Member, Hellenic Olympic Committee

Member, IOC Commission for Olympic Education

1st Vice-President, Hellenic Equestrian Federation

Board Member, International Olympic Truce Foundation

Prof. Dr Konstantinos GEORGIADIS

IOA Dean

Professor, Department of Sports Organisation and Management, University of Peloponnese

Member, IOC Commission for Olympic Education

Vice-President, Executive Committee of the International Society of Olympic Historians (ISOH)

Director, International Master's degree programme in "Olympic studies, Olympic education, organisation and management of Olympic events"

MAiSI Management Board Member

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European Olympic Academies' President

Prof. Dr Konstantinos GEORGIADIS (GRE)

University of Peloponnese

IOA Dean

Prof. Dr Benu GUPTA (IND)

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College University of Delhi, India*

Prof. Dr Heather REID (ITA/USA)

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Professor of Philosophy Emerita at Morningside University in Sioux City, Iowa*

Prof. Dr Jan TOLLENEER (BEL)

Professor in Sports History, Comparative Studies and Applied Ethics, KU Leuven

Mr David WALLECHINSKY (USA)

Former President of ISOH

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Ms Iliana FERRER (ESP)

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Ms Xuefei HAN (CHN)

Ms Emily KOHLER (BRA)

Ms Zikun LI (USA)

Ms Jingjing LIAO (CHN)

Mr Maximilian Tarik ORLICZEK (AUT)

Mr Ali RAMDANE (FRA)

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